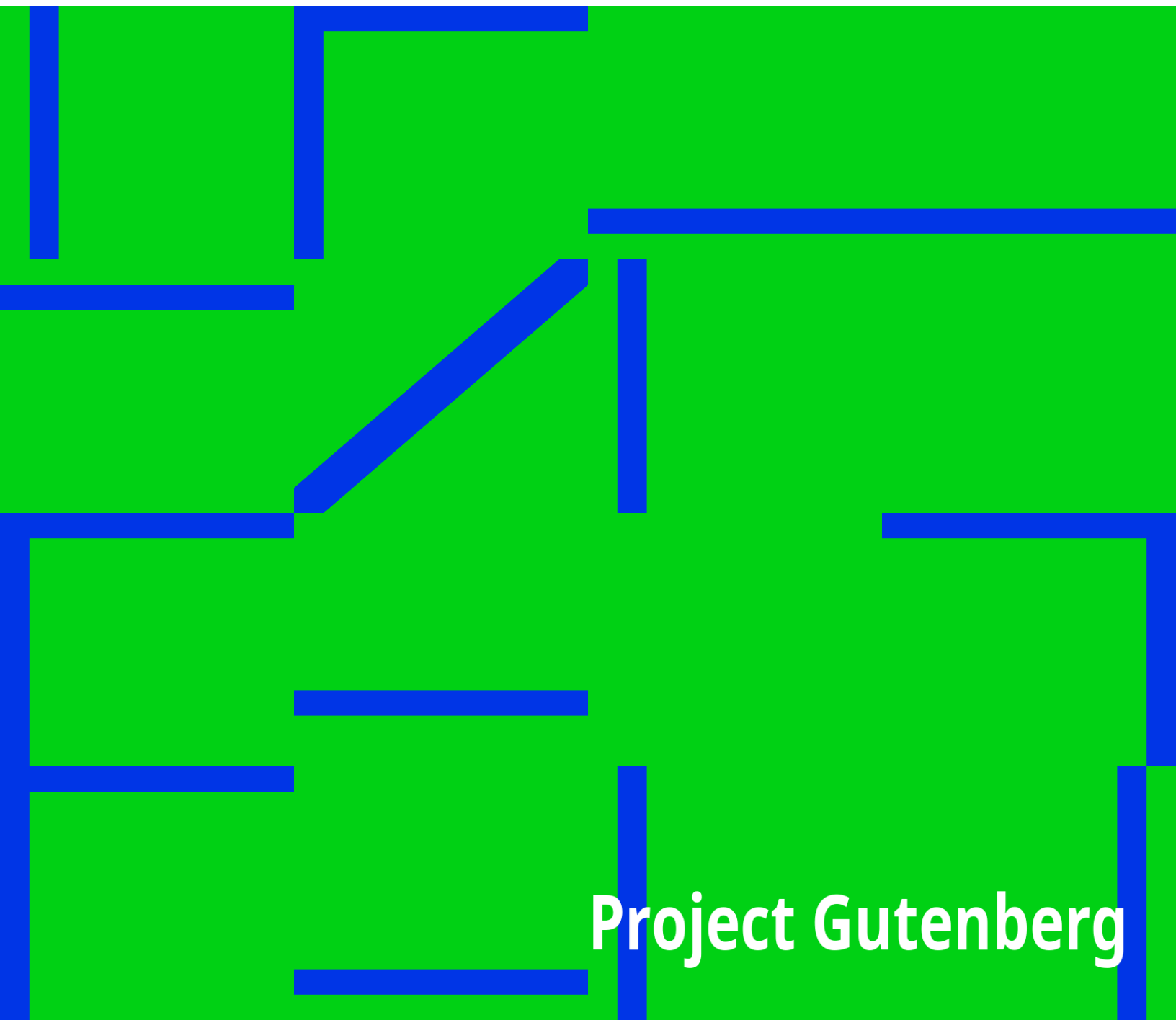


Torrent of Portyngale

E. Adam



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ȝ *yogh*

ll̥ *double l with joining line, here shown as tilde*

ÿ æ *vowels with less common diacritics (rare)*

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The main text is shown stanza by stanza. Sidenotes are shown in their original position; linenotes and numbered footnotes (rare) are grouped at the end of each stanza. Headnotes that originally came at mid-stanza have been moved to the following stanza break.

Errors and anomalies are marked in the text with mouse-hover popups. Typographic details are given at the [end of the e-text](#). The word "invisible" means that there is an appropriately sized blank space or extra indentation, but the character (usually an open single quote) is missing. Unusual spellings in the Sidenotes are probably attributable to Frederick Furnivall; they are not individually noted.

All brackets are in the original. Line numbers in brackets are explained in the Introduction.

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Links: Throughout the book, links to line numbers generally lead to the nearest multiple of 5 (printed number). Stanza numbers in the Notes were added by the transcriber to aid in cross-linking. In Sections 2 and 3 of the Introduction, *all* line numbers are active links. To reduce visual chaos, link highlighting has been turned off. This may be overridden by your personal browser settings.

Tor̥rent of Portyngale.

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TORRENT OF PORTYNGALE.

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TO MY TEACHER AND HELPER,

PROF. E. KÖLBING, PH.D.

Extra Series.

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RICHARD CLAY & SONS, LIMITED, LONDON & BUNGAY.

Torrent of Portyngale.

INTRODUCTION.

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§ 1. THE manuscript from which the following romance of *Sir Torrent of Portugal* is taken, is a folio volume on paper, of the fifteenth century, preserved in the Chetham Library at Manchester.

A description of this volume is given by Halliwell in his *Account of the European MSS. in the Chetham Library at Manchester*, Manchester, 1842, page 16, and by Prof. Koelbing in his *Englische Studien*, vii. 195. The only edition of this romance that we have hitherto had was done by Halliwell. As he had, besides his own transcript, another copy made by Madden, his text is a pretty accurate one, and therefore the results of Prof. Koelbing's collation, printed in his *Englische Studien*, vii. 344 ff., concern, for the most part, things of little importance, except one very curious passage, l. 88, where Halliwell renders the quite correct reading of the MS., *p la more de dewe* = *par l'amour de dieu*, by *Pericula more bedew[n]e*. Also, from l. 1720, the counting of the lines is wrong by 100 lines.

A few short fragments of a printed edition were found by Halliwell in the Douce Collection, Bodleian Library, Oxford, and added to his work as an Appendix. They contain the following passages of the MS.:

Fragment III. = lines 462–489.			
„	II. =	„	492–520.
„	VI. =	„	820–851.
„	V. =	„	917–948.
„	IV. =	„	949–970.
„	I. =	„	1807–1866.

A seventh fragment, of which not much more than the rhyming words are preserved, was omitted by Halliwell, and was printed for the first time in Prof. Koelbing's collation.

This Chetham MS. contains the romance in a very debased and corrupt form, so that the original reading in many passages can hardly be recognized. ¹ The scribe, who copied the poem from an older MS., lived (no doubt) at a far later period than the poet; he did not therefore understand a great many old expressions, and these he used to supplant by words of his own; he also transposed and even omitted many lines, and spoiled the rhyme, because he had not the slightest idea of the nature of the stanza in

which the poem is composed. Halliwell did not trouble himself about the restoration of the true readings; he merely reproduced the traditional text, even where it would have been very easy to do more, though many passages are hopelessly corrupt; still worse is the fact, that he did not recognize the metre as the tail-rhymed twelve-line stanza, for he prints six-line stanzas.

In consequence, the whole of the philological work on the text had still to be done, and a new edition was plainly necessary; the more that this poem, though not written in the best period of romance poetry, treats of a legendary subject widely spread in the Middle Ages, and is nearly related to another poem, *Syr Eglamour of Artois*.

§ 2. METRE AND VERSIFICATION.

In this and the following section, all line numbers are active links. To reduce visual chaos, link highlighting has been turned off. This may be overridden by your personal browser settings.

As I mentioned before, the romance of *Sir Torrent* is composed in the well-known tail-rhymed twelve-line stanza, and belongs to that class of it in which the first and the second couplets have different rhyme-sounds (cf. Koelbing, *Amis and Amiloun*, p. xiv ff.). Only the incompleteness of many stanzas, and the many defects in reference to the rhyme, can excuse Halliwell for not apprehending the character of the metre. As to the structure of the eight lines of the four couplets, each contains (or at least ought to contain) four accents, the *caudæ* three; but as we, unfortunately, possess only one MS., a conclusive statement on this point is impossible. There is no doubt about the fact that neither the really incorrect rhymes nor the wanting of them can be due to the author of the poem: even when romance poetry was decaying, the poets were fairly perfect rhymers: with all deficiencies in this department, the copyists are to be charged.

Consonant rhymes (s. *Schipper Altengl. Metrik*, p. 299) are found in *Torrent* in the following passages: l. 141 *rode*—*rode* ags. *rôd*—*râd*. 450 *the*—*the* ags. *þeón*—*þe*. 1558 *indede*—*dede*. 2205 *lay*—*lay*, *sg.*—*plr. prt.*

Identical rhymes are frequent, especially in the *caudæ*: 81 *stond—stond*. 177 *there—there*. 500 *he—he*. 1887 *there—there*. 2538 *blithe—blithe*. 39 *take—take*. 342 *bold—bold*, a. s. o.

Assonances: 195 *bon'—Rome*. 518 *undyrstond—strong*. 537 *name—alone*. 699 *yod—fotte*. 758 *name—tane*. 896 *bryng—wynd*. 1257 *overcom'—Aragon'*. 1768 *man'—cam'*. 2164 *anon'—fome*. 2544 *sithe—hide*.

Besides the rhymes we find abundant alliteration, as in most of the Middle English Romances. On alliteration, cf. Regel, *Die alliteration in Lazamon, Germ. Stud.* I. 171; F. Lindner, *The alliteration in Chaucer's Canterbury Tales, Essays on Chaucer*, Pt. III., p. 197 ff. Koelbing, *Sir Tristrem*, p. xxxvii, and *Amis and Amiloun*, p. lxvi. Lindner as well as Koelbing has adopted Regel's classification, and so shall I. The most frequent is two alliterative words in one verse; they can be classed in the following way:—

I. A. The same word is repeated in two succeeding lines; v. 456 f.: *Forthesche browght a **why**t sted, As **why**t as the flowyr in' med*; v. 618 f.: *In IV **quarters** he hym drowe, And euery **quarter** vppon a bowe*. v. 2026 f.: *But ran into a **wildernes** Amongist beests that **wyld** wes*. v. 2465 f.: *They axid **hors** and armes bryght, to **horsbak** went thay in ffere*.

B. Alliterative combinations, one part of which is a proper name. Torrent is several times combined with the verb *take*; 26: *Towarde hym he **taky**the Torrayne*; 224: *Torrent thether **toke** the way*; 519: *Torrent **toke** a dulf wey*; 2269: *Whan sir Torent was **takyn'** than'*; 91: *Now, be my **trow**the, seyde Torent than'*; 1161: *Alas, said **Desonell** the **dere***; 2523: *As was **dame Desonell***; 1906 = 1946 = 1969: *Mary **myld**. To send unto her **Sathanas***. v. 1091: *The **castell** of Cardon'*.

II. A. Words of the same root are alliterative. 133: *Torrent, on **kne knelyd** he*; 671: *That on hys **kne** he **kneld***; 2502: *And **kneld** on her **kne***; 205: *Torrent **knelyd** on hys **kne** = v. 528*; 881: *And **knelyd** vppon ys **kne***; 1883: *She **kneld** down' vppon' her **kne***; 2563: *Down' they **kneld** on' her **kne***; 512: *By **dymmynge** of the **day***; 1158: *For her love **did** I never no **dede***; 1801: *That ylke **dede**, that she hath **done***; 1943: *How she **flew** in a **fflight***; 2384: ***Liffe** and **lyvelode**, whil-I **lyve***; 233: *A **lyon'** & a **lyonasse***; 1671: *For to **se***

that selly sight; 407: For the talles thou hast me told; 1466: And fals talis hym' told; 2578: Euer we will-be at youre will.

B. Relations in which alliterative words stand to each other according to their meaning.

a. Concrete ideas are joined together because they belong to the same sphere of life. 2017: *Byrdus and bestis*, aye woo ye be; 113: *bone and blod*; 21: *kyng and knyght*; 83: *And ryche castelles in that contre*; 251: *In lond with a fyndes fere*; 102: *That fyndes fare for aye*; 1094: *Both at knyght and knave*; 584: *Bothe in' frethe and in feld*; 660: *Stomlyng thurrow frythe and fen'*; 1378: *Both be hold and be hylk*; 2398: *lym' and lith*; 750: *Lytylk-and mykylk*; *lese and more*; 1899: *That was lord of al-that lond*; 2152: *Loo, lordys of euery lond*; 2375: *With al-maner of mynstralsye*; 149: *He reynynd hys sted vnto a stake*; 1065: *Waytes on the walk-gan blowe*; 13: *water and wynde*.

b. In the same way abstract ideas are connected, so far as they belong to the same sphere of life. 460: *That dethe ys dynt schalt pou not thole*; 1600: *Of deth yaue he no dout*; 782 = 2062: *feyer and fre*; 2153: *Falshode wylt-haue a foule end*; 1988: *Helpe and hold I shalt-hym yeve*; 1492: *They sat and song*; 683: *Cryst hym saue and see*; 1303: *That he was sad and sore*; 1612: *set sadly and sore*; 335: *God that sofryd wonddes sore*; 322: *styff and strong* = 1491 = 2590; 1205: *That wekyd was and wight*; 1584: *wekyd and wight*; 1849: *Her one child woke and be-gan to wepe*; 1559: *And wot ye wel-and not wene*; 246: *Sche weppte, as sche were wod*.

C. The grammatical relations in which the alliterative words stand to each other.

a. Subst. and adj. in attributive or predicative combinations. As *bold as eny bore*; *With browes brod and wyde*; 142: *hys bugelt-bold*; 307: *In a dongon' that ys dym*; 82: *My fayer' forestes fellythe downe he*; 209: *The feyer' fyld*; 426: *glemerryng ase the glase*; 1592: *good gate*; 171 = 596: *the holtes hore*; 1484: *To an hye hylk*; 1183: *sydes sare*; 154: *Thowe the wey nevyr so wykkyd were*; 2054: *wekyd weders*; 506: *In the wyld-some way*; 535: *Wyldsom weyes haue I went*; 2030: *She went on that wilsom' way*.

b. Verbs or adjectives combined with the adverb or substantive which contains their secondary adverbial meaning. 1478: To **be** here at his **bane**, cf. 1678: That there his **bane** hath **be**; 1944: To her **birdus** was she **boun**; 2016: With **blis** on euery **bowze**; 135: That **bowght** hym with hys **blod**; 1045: Thurrow the **body** he gan hym **bere**; 1404: To the **bote** they **bare**; 334: Thus he covyrd owt of **care**; 27: That **dowghtty** ys in **dedde**, cf. 1725; 98: With-owt **fere** that he schold **fare**; 603 = 977: Also **fast** ase he myght **fare**; 536: With **fyndes** for to **fyght**; 802: To **fyght** with that **fyndes fere**; 1262: That was **grow** both **grene** and **gay**; 1060 = 2330: Torent be the **hond** he **hent**; 270: That **meche** ys of **myght**; 713: That **meche** wase of **myght**; 24: For God ys **most** of **myght**, cf. 1112: To a **man** off **myght**; 1879: Vp she **rose** ageyn' the **rough**; 2100: Go **sech** her in' the **see**; 2129: And **sett** hym' oute in to the **see**; 2469: That **semely** to se were; 126: And **symly** was to **sene**; 415: That dare I sothely **sey**; 1170: Torrent **sett** on hym' so sore; 139: Serttes, yf I hym **slepyng slone**; 181: Torrent vndyr hys **spryt** he **sprent**; 179: But **stond stylk**; 2410: He is so **stiff** at euery **stoure**; 987: Torrent in' the **storrope stod**; 1912: For no **stroke** wold she **stynt**; 2060: By a **tokyn** I shall the **telk**; 2397: Or walkyd in **wede**; 383: In hys **walke** ther ase he **went**; 725: And **went** forthe on hys **wey**; 107: And on hys **wey** gan he **wynd**; 2030: She **went** on that **wilsom** way; 989: ale **wyld** at **wyle**; 2088: In no **wise** he **wold**; 1206: To **wed** her to my **wyffe**; 749: That **wyt** ys vndyr **wede**; 1315: All-men wonderid on that **wight**; 33: **worthyest** in **wede**.

c. Substantives and verbs are combined in the relation of subject and predicate. 2221: Down **knelid** that **knyght**; 854: Whether the **fynd** can **fyght**; 2390: There that his **lady lent**; 2064: My **love** was on the **lent**; 1219: Gret **lordys** to churche her **led**; 170: The **fyndes spere** **sparrythe** hyme nothyng; 84: No **ston** lettythe he **stond**.

d. Verbs and substantives are combined as predicate and object. 2490: his **bak** to **bend**; 2532: That couth moche **curtesye**; 273: Thy **dethe** than wylt-he **dyght**, cf. 1043: Hys **dethe** to hyme ys **dyght**; 1648: Thy **deth** now is **dight**; 2123: What **deth** they wold hym **do**; 161: My lordes **frethe** thus to **felk**; 2235: Found hym his **fill-off** **ffygth**; 1743: The **fforward** ye to **fulleffylle**; 651: He **gathyred** svm of hys **gere**; 210: Vpp both his **handes** he **held**; 1799: For Iesu is love, that **harood** **helk**; 1820: Whan they **led** that **lady** **ffre**; 2080: **Leve** we now that **lady** **gent**; 1663: Ech on other **laid** good **lode**; 1495: To god that

made man; 435: A gret *maynerey* let he *make* ryght; 264: To hym sche *mad* here *mone*; 645: He *rawght* Torrent soche a *rowght*; 1172: And *all-to* *sheverd* his *sheld*; 502: Tho he be *strod* *anoble stede*; 2482: Torent be *strode* a stede *strong*; 281: I schalk-the *telt-soche a tokyn'*; 2013: Ne *wanted* she no *woo*; 115: He that schalk-wend soche a *wey*; 439: Hom-ward to *wend* ther *wey*; 2448: And than' to *wend* her *way*; 2457: And to her logyng *went* her *way*; 1544: Other *wayes* yf I *wend*; 207: That hathe thys *world* to *wyld*.

§ 3. THE DIALECT.

The stanza of twelve lines was probably first employed in the north of England; at least it would be difficult to prove the existence of a poem composed in this metre in the southern part of the country; therefore it is beforehand probable that the romance of *Torrent* was composed either in some part of the Midlands or in the North. In order to determine the dialect more precisely, we restrict ourselves to a careful consideration of the rhymes.

1. SHORT VOWELS.

Old English *ǣ* is (1) preserved before *n* and *m*: 744 and 788 *Iame*—*name*. 927 *Adryan*—*jentylmane*. 13 *londe*—*wonande*. 352 *stond*—*lygand*. 1128 *stond*—*shynand*. No part. pres. *on-ond* rhyming with an unvariable *-ond* has been traced out until now, but 1824 *wepand*—*wonde* (ags. *wunden*) seems to be the first. 2. Changed into *o*. 516 *rome*—*frome* ags. *rûm*—*fram*. 2446 *mon'*—*done*. 1190 *none*—*shone*—*anon*—*done*. 1257 *ouercom*—*Aragon'*. 1989 *son*—*can* (= *con*). 2040 *anon'*—*bone*. A curious exception is 1929 *grame* (= *greme*)—*teme*—*Ierusalem*; cf. *Gaw.* l. 312.

O.E. *e*, the *i*-umlaut of *a*, is preserved: 373 *end*—*wend*. 476 *went*—*jent*. 924 *telt*—*hell*. 1702 *hell*—*Desonelte*. 1798 *felt*—*hell*. The past partic. of *seón*, *segen*, has been contracted into *sen*. 1562 *sene*—*wene*.

O.E. *æ* has become *a*: 45 *spake*—*take*. 363 *ffare*—*bare*. 726 and 876 *sale*—*Portynggalle*. 1074 *passe*—*was*. 1131 *sale*—*tale*. 1233 *thare*—*fare*. 1236 *was*—*Sathanas*. 1399 *care*—*thare*. 2287 *was*—*alas*.

æ has become e: 2026 *wildernes—was*. 764 *derre—clere—ware* (ags. *wær*). 1951 *there—bere*. 328 *glad* (= *gled*)—*redd*.

æ has become ay by the vocalization of the following *g*: 25 *fayne—Torryne*. 1025 *may—day, wey—laye*. 1071 *say—day*. 2029 *day—way*.

O.E. *ea* becomes *o* before *ld*: 303 *hold—bold, fold* (ags. *folde*)—*cold*. 422 *gold—mold, hold—told*.

ea has become *a*: 399 *Portyngalk—bale* (ags. *bealu*). 531 *care—far*¹ (ags. *cearu*). 1891 *ffare—care*.

ea has become *e*: 1166 *beheld—feld—sheld—weld* (ags. *wealdan*). 2359 *preste—breste* (ags. *bearst*).

O.E. *eo* has turned into *e*: 1166 *beheld—ffeld—sheld—weld*.

O.E. *ī* is preserved as *i* and *y*: 51 *knyght—nyght*. 307 *dym—hym*. 1783 *myld—child*. Only once this vowel has changed into *e*: 714 *wret—get*. *i* rhymes with *e*: 3 *wynde—ende—lende—ffynde*.

O.E. *ō* is unaltered: 422 *gold—mold*. 1122 *gold—mold*.

O.E. *ū* has become *o*: 367 *dore* (ags. *duru*)—*befor*¹. 765 *Aragon—son*¹. 1257 *ouer com—Aragon*¹. 1762 *com*¹—*kyngdome*. 1801 *done—sonne* (ags. *sunu*). 2320 *sonne—dungeon*.

O.E. *ȳ*, the *i*-umlaut of *ū*, has the value of *i*, written *i* or *y*: 390 *kysse—iwyss*. 1564 *tilk—fullefylk, ylk—wylk*. 1740 *evylk—fulle fylle*. Only once it rhymes with *e*: 1484 *hyll* (= *hell*)—*yell—befelk—welk*, never with *u*.

2. LONG VOWELS.

O.E. *â* is preserved in the following rhymes: ² *a*. 39 *take—stroke* (= *strake*, ags. *strâc*), *spake—take*. 97 *sore—fare*. 103 *goos—takythe* (= *gas—tas*). 280 *wakyn—tokyn*¹ (ags. *tâcen*). 334 *care—sore*. 590 *fare—wher, hore—care*. 705 *fare—gere* (ags. *gâr*). 788 *Iame—name, bone—schame*. 834 *ga—ma*. 977 *fare—bare, sare—chaffare*. 1143 *glade—rade*. 1238 *Cate—gate, bad—wott* (ags. *wât*). 1251 *brod—made*; cf. 1303, 1306, 1501, 1526, 1604, 1612, 1663, 1669, 1825, 1911, 2178, 2356, 2617.

b. O.E. *â* has changed into *o*: 16 *sone* (ags. *sunu*)—**gon**. 141 *rode*—**rode** (ags. *rôd*—*râd*). 195 **bon** (ags. *bân*)—*Rome*. 238 **wote** (ags. *wât*)—*fote*. 654 *browz*—**goo**. 1062 **tho**—*do*. Cf. 1196, 1226, 1295, 1381, 1809, 1812, 1815, 2013, 2025, 2028, 2037, 2046, 2295, 2298, 2301, 2542. The result is, that in 26 cases old *â* is preserved, in 22 cases changed into *ô*.

O.E. *æ* is turned into (1) *a*: 154 **were**—*fare*. 603 *fare*—**were**. 1020 **were**—*fare*. 2074 *care*—**ware**.

Into (2) *e*. 379 **dede** (ags. *dêd*)—*hed*. 1047 **were**—*chere*. 1053 *sped*—**lede** (ags. *lêdan*). 1263 *stede*—**wede** (ags. *wêd*).

Into (3) *o*. 1113 **mone** (ags. *mênan*)—*Aragon*. 1384 *beffore*—*there*—**were**.

O.E. *ô* is preserved throughout: 73 **wode**—*good*. 112 **rode**—*blod*. 118 *Rome*—**kyrstendome**. 313 **done**—*sone*.

Before *g* the vowel *u* resp. *w* is inserted: 145 **browght**—*nowght*. 279 **browght**—*thowght*. 2053 **sought**—*brought*.

O.E. *ê* is preserved: 123 **kene**—*sene*. 743 *dede*—**sped**, *wede*. 1849 **wepe**—*slepe*. 2055 *grene*—**kene**. 2458 *be dene*—**wene**.

O.E. *î* is preserved as *y*: 196 **tyd**—*syd*. 325 **fyve**—*lyve*. 777 **wyse**—*deuyce*. 900 **ryde**—*syde*.

O.E. *û* is written *ou* resp. *ow* in the French way: 921 *renowne*—**towyn'**. 978 **downe**—*renowne*. 1425 **nowe**—*rowe*. 2634 **mouth**—*couth*. It has become *o*: 516 **rome**—*frome* (ags. *rûm*—*from*). Cf. 2641 *renown*—**son**.

O.E. *eá* has become *e*: 1929 *grame*—**streme**, *Jerusalem*. 2554 *Jerusalem'*—**streme** (ags. *streám*).

O.E. *eó* has changed into *e*: 153 **be**—*hee*: 782 **fre**—*he*. 888 **tre**—*crystyanté*. 1643 **be**—*charité*. 1861 **ffree**—*cité*.

O.E. *ÿ* remains *y*: 1361 *pride*—**bedsyde**. 1433 *pryde*—**ryde**. 1473 **wyde**—*pride*. *ÿ* or *ê*, the *i*-umlaut of *eá* or *e*, is found as *e*: 63 *were*—**here** (ags. *hÿran*). 235 **here**—*were*. 327 *sted*—*yed*, **nede**—*sped*. 408 *yede*—**ned**. 1552 *stede*—**nede**, *indede*.

3. THE INFLEXIONS.

The plural of the substantives terminates in (1) *s* resp. *ys*: 837 *ryghtys*—*knyghtes*. 1298 *stonys*—*nonys*.

(2) in *n*: 458 *slon*—*appon*. 1116 *done*—*shone*. 1193 *shone*—*anon*, *done*.

(3) is formed by *i*-umlaut: *men* 1784, 2282, but 2197 *wan*—*men* (= *man*).

(4) has no inflexion: 651 *gere*—*spere*. 705 *far*—*gere*. 836 *hend*—*frende*, *sende*. 1173 *ffere*—*yere*. 1405 *hend*—*frend*. 1556 *stone*—*gone*. 2188 *were*—*yere*. 2194 *here*—*yere*. The inflexions of the adjectives have totally disappeared.

The *infinitive* ends in *-ne* or *n*, or has no termination at all. (1) with *n*: 123 *kene*—*see* (= *sene*). 217 *ageyne*—*sayne*. 262 *fayne*—*slayne*. 489 *Mavdeleyn*—*seyne*; 16 *sone*—*gon*.

(2) without *n*: 67 *sake*—*take*. 93 *kynd*—*fynd*. 148 *wake*—*stake*. 184 *so*—*goo*. 434 *Adolake*—*take*. 1062 *tho*—*do*. 1762 *me*—*se*.

The 2nd person sing. of the pres. ind. occurs only once in the rhyme, 1333 *tase*—*thou hase*, *tas*—*gas*.

The 3rd person sing. of the present indicative ends in *s*: 187 *tellys*—*ellys*. 2317 *rose*—*gose*. 558 *tellythe*—*elles* (The rhyme shows that *tellys* must be inserted; cf. 103 *gos*—*takythe*, and 858 *gothe*—*toke* = *gas*—*tas*.) Only once *th* occurs: 2047 *Nazareth*—*gethe* (ags. *gæð*). On this remarkable form see Zupitza, *Guy of Warwick*, note on l. 11075. The plural has no termination: 3 *wynde*—*ende*—*lende*.

The *subjunctive* mood has no inflexions: 70 *sped*—*stede*, 3rd pers. 87 *blynd*—*wynde*, 3rd pers. 213 *fyld*—*schyld*, 3rd pers. 416 *sey*—*may*, 2nd pers. sg. 584 *feld*—*schyld*, 3rd pers. sg. 1978 *saue*—*haue*; but observe 139 *slone*—*none* and 1839 *sene*—*grene*.

The *present participle* ends usually in *-ande* (*onde*): 13 *londe*—*wonande*. 127 *fonde*—*growonde*. 315 *levand*—*bond*. 352 *stand*—*lygand*. 358 *vndyrstond*—*levand*. 1128 *stond*—*shynand*. 1280 *fayland*—*lond*. 1445 *fleand*—*waraunt*. 1452 *ffand*—*goand*. 1821 *lond*—*wepand*. 1899 *lond*—

pleyand. 2104 *hond*—**levand**. Thrice -yng is found: 268 *kyng*—**dwellyng**, 1638 and 2568.

The *gerund* terminates always in *ing* (*yng*): 1479 *kyng*—**ryding**. 1503 **comyng**—*kyng*. 1933 *ryng*—**lettyng**. 2509 *kyng*—**lesyng**.

Observe the 2nd pers. sing. of a past tense, 1589 **thou cam'**—*slan'*, of a praeterito-praesens, 410 *they*—*sey*, **thow may**. 1543 *away*—*aye*, **may**. 2001 **may**—*welaway*.

The *past participle* of strong verbs terminates in *n*: 482 **syne**—*schene*, *wene*—*clene*. 675 **slayne**—*rayne*. 800 **slayne**—*trayne*. 1292 *fygn'*—**slayn'**. 1562 **sene**—*wene*. 2323 *alone*—**slone**. We don't find one certain instance for the dropping of this *n*, besides 1678 and 2063 *be*.

The *past tense plural* of strong verbs has the same vowel as the singular: 1452 They **ffound** (r. *ffand*)—*goand*. 1458 **began**—*gentilman*. 1753 *tong*—**dong**.

The 3rd pers. of the present indic. of *to be* = *ys* or *es*: cf. 738 *blyse*—**ys**. 2413 **ys**—*Raynes*. Once **ys** is found as plural: 2524 **ys**—*iwys*. The *present subjunctive* is *be* through all persons: 208 **be**—*me*, 2nd pers. 614 **be**—*se*, 3rd pers. 884 *the*—**bee**, 3rd pers. 2017 **be**—*me*, 2nd pers. plr. The infinitive **be** and *bene*: 49 *the*—**bee**. 483 **be**—*see*. 1643 **be**—*charite*. 903 *the*—**bee**. 1833 *clene*—**bene**. 2161 *quene*—**bene**. 2613 **bene**—*kene*. The *past tense singular number* is *was* or *wes*: 247 *alas*—**wase**. 426 *glase*—**was**. 771 *pase*—**wase**. 1873 *wyldernes*—**was** (= *wes*). The plural *were*, *ware*, *wore*, as well as *was*, *wes*: (1) l. 402 **wer'**—*cher*. 1047 **were**—*chere*. 1845 **were**—*ffere*. 2586 *squiere*—**were**, *here*—*clere*. (2) 603 *fare*—**were**. 2494 **ware**—*bare*. 1384 *beffore*—*there*, **were** (= *wore*). (3) 384 *pase*—**wase**. 1388 *passe*—**was**. (4) 2026 *wildernes*—**was** (= *wes*). 2545 *wildernes*—**was**; cf. l. 2584. The subjunctive mood of the past tense is *were* and *ware*, in sgl. and plr.: 225 **were**—*clere*. 235 *here*—**were**. 1696 *chere*—**were**. 2476 **were**—*bere*. 154 **were** (= *ware*)—*fare*. 1020 **wer** (= *ware*)—*fare*. 2074 *care*—**ware**. The *past participle*: 7 *bedene*—**ben**. 172 **byne**—*seyn*. 2344 **ibene**—*kene*. 1678 **be**—*crystiaunte*.

From this inquiry into the sounds and inflexions, the following conclusions can be drawn:

The development of *ǣ* is of no use in fixing the dialect. Nor is *ea*, which has become *a*, *o*, and *e*, to be deemed a characteristic either of the Midland or Northern dialect. Ags. *ea* occurs as *o* as early as 1250 in the *Northumbrian Psalter*, and 50 years afterwards in *Sir Tristrem* and *Sir Perceval*; even Richard Rolle in his *Pricke of Conscience* offers one instance of this change (cf. *Sir Tristrem*, p. lxix f.).

The development of the ags. *â*, which we find in 26 passages as *a*, in 22 as *o*, is remarkable. There are only a very few instances of this change in *Sir Tristrem*, p. lxxi, and in the *Psalter*; and this almost equal number of *a*- and *o*-rhymes proves evidently that the poem cannot belong to a Northern country. At the same time, a proportion like that would be impossible in a text of Southern origin. The same negative result is to be derived from the fact that Ags. *y* is always written *y*.

As to the inflexions, the plurals of the substantives are formed by adding *-s* or *-n* (*en*), or by vowel change, or they have no inflexions at all. As for the inflexion *-n*, it only occurs in *slon* and *shon*, and of this very word the plural in *n* is to be met with even in Northern writers.

The infinitives both preserve or drop the final *n*, as is the rule with the Midland dialect; the form of the past participle with *n* accords with the use of the Northern writers.

The present partic. ending in *-and* and the past tense plurals of strong verbs having adopted the vowel of the singular, agree with the North as well as with the northern districts of the Midland, in the same way as some forms of *to be*: plr. prs. *ys* and plr. prt. *was*, besides the usual forms *be* and *are*, resp. *were* and *ware*, and the contracted forms of *take*: 758 *name—tane*. 1095 *gane—itanē*. 1825 *ta—twa* (cf. 231, 286, 859, 1333, 1475, 1722, 1733, 2617).

The forms *thou has* and *thou may* point to the West.

The inflexions of the 3rd pers. prs. sg. are *-th* and *-s*. In the western part of the Midland we never meet with the ending *th*, but only with *s*. In *Amis and Amiloun*, the Eastern origin of which seems to be sure, only the inflexion *-ep* is found in the rhyme (*Amis*, p. xxx ff.).

The romance of *Sir Torrent* seems to be the first document hitherto considered where both these forms occur, one by the side of the other. Perhaps this fact justifies us in concluding that this poem was composed in the east, but on the borders of the west, Midland.

§ 4. THE CONTENTS OF THE ROMANCE.

Before entering on an inquiry into the sources of the romance, it may be expedient to give a short account of its contents.

In Portugal once reigned a mighty king, whose name was Calamond. He had an only daughter, the fair and gentle Desonelle, who was loved by a young knight called Torrent, son of a Portuguese count. As he could not win her, save by distinguishing himself by valiant exploits, he undertook several adventurous expeditions. First he set out, by the order of the king, against a mischievous and dangerous giant, whom he found lying fast asleep on a hill. He roused the giant by sounding his bugle, and challenged him to fight. Instantly a fierce combat ensued, in which the awkward giant lost his life. In the giant's castle the young hero delivered a maiden, Eleonore, daughter of the king of Gales, from captivity, and rescued at the same time four princes, whom the giant had taken some time before and imprisoned in an iron cage.

After a short rest Torrent returned into Portugal. He was kindly received by King Calamond, and splendid festivities were celebrated in his honour. The kings of Gales and of Provence showed their gratitude by bestowing on him rich presents, among them a precious sword wrought by Wayland Smith. Desonelle gave him one of her fine palfreys. Calamond, however, shrewd as he was, and envious of the hero's fame, plotted his ruin. He caused him, by a counterfeit letter of Desonelle, to catch her a falcon in the forest of Maudlen, which was the haunt of a dangerous giant, Rochense, and of many wild beasts. Torrent and his squire set out immediately, but separated on entering the forest, to hunt in the thicket each by himself. Torrent soon encountered a huge dragon, and killed it by vehement strokes. The squire, having meanwhile fallen in with the giant, had been slain by him. The hero, called to the place by the tumult of battle, attacked the giant, and overcame him after a hard struggle. He cut off his head to bear with him as a trophy. He then went into the giant's castle, where he found a great many jewels, and a bright sword called Mownpolyard. Having returned to the royal court, he ordered five priests to say masses for his squire's soul. At this very time it happened that the king of Arragon sent messengers to the king of Portugal, in order to bring about a marriage between Desonelle and his youngest son. Calamond would not listen to the advice of his spouse, that he should no longer refuse Desonelle to Torrent, but he promised her to the prince of Arragon, and at the same time sent the hero once more against a giant, Slogus of Foulles in Calabre.

Torrent departed well armed, and after a prosperous voyage arrived in Calabre. There he soon met the giant, who was one-eyed like the Cyclops, and bore a huge cudgel as his only weapon. Torrent threw his spear into the fiend's eye, and thus overcame him without any long struggle. The king of Calabre graciously welcomed the hero, and largely rewarded

him for the service he had rendered his country. Having returned into Portugal, Torrent heard that in a few weeks Desonelle was to be married to the prince of Arragon. Arrayed in knightly dress, he rode right off to Calamond's court, and challenged his rival to fight. After a short struggle he completely vanquished his antagonist, stretching him on the ground. The next day, as the king, surrounded by his noble guests, banqueted in the great hall of the castle, Torrent entered with the giant's head in his hand, and harshly demanded the king's daughter; he called all the lords to witness of Calamond's perfidy.

The Emperor of Rome now interceded, and it was agreed at his suggestion that Torrent should fight once more against a giant named Cate; if he vanquished that adversary, he should obtain Desonelle and half Arragon. On an isle near the sea-shore the struggle began in presence of the assembled knights. Torrent struck the club out of the giant's hand, put him to flight, and killed him as he ran away, casting stones at him. Then the Emperor decided, with the approbation of all his knights, that the hero had won both the land and the maiden.

Torrent obtained Desonelle, and rejoiced in the possession of her, but no solemn marriage was performed.

Twelve weeks after, he left his spouse, impelled by his venturous and ambitious mind; for the king of Norway asked him to fight against a wild giant who had carried off his daughter and was destroying his castles. Torrent bade his mistress farewell, leaving her two golden rings as talismans, and set off with fifty companions. Arrived at the coast of Norway, he and his companions entered a dense forest, in which a great many wild beasts lived. His companions, seized with fear, parted from him, and continued their voyage at sea. They told the king of Norway the false tale that Torrent had perished on shore. The king then set out himself to rescue his daughter. Torrent meanwhile encountered a giant named Weraunt, Cate's brother, and slew him in a hard struggle, but was himself wounded. In the giant's castle he saved Gendres, daughter of the Norwegian king, and conducted her to her father. On the road they were met by a large train of gallant knights, and were then convoyed in triumph to the king's court. There Torrent soon recovered from his wounds, and was amply rewarded with honours and presents. He stayed above twelve months at the Norwegian court. The false companions of Torrent were drowned in the sea by the king's command, but one squire escaped to Portugal, and reported the tidings that Torrent yet remained in Norway. Soon after, as Desonelle was delivered of twins, the hatred of Calamond suddenly broke out against her. By his order, Desonelle and her two children were put to sea in a small boat; but a favourable wind saved them from ruin, and drove the boat upon the coast of Palestine. As she, helpless, wandered about the downs, a huge dragon (griffin or gripe) appeared, and seized one of her children, and immediately after a wild leopard dragged away the other. With submission she suffered her miserable fate, relying on the help of the Holy Virgin.

The king of Jerusalem, just returning from a voyage, happened to find the leopard with the child, which he ordered to be saved and delivered to him. Seeing from the foundling's golden ring that the child was of noble descent, and pitying its helpless state, he took it into his palace, and brought him up as his own son (as it were) at his court. The child was named Leobertus.

The dragon or gripe with the other child was seen by a pious hermit, St. Antony, who, though son of the king of Greece, had in his youth forsaken the world. Through his prayer

St. Mary made the dragon put down the infant; Antony carried him to his father, who adopted him and ordered him to be baptized. He was named Antony fice Greffoun (Antony, son of the griffin or gripe).

Desonelle wandered up and down, after the loss of her children, till she happened to meet the king of Nazareth hunting. He, recognizing her as the king of Portugal's daughter, gave her a kind welcome and assistance. At his court she lived several years in happy retirement. Torrent returned at length into Portugal, notwithstanding all the entreaties of the Norwegian king that he would dwell in Norway somewhat longer. At his arrival, King Calamond took refuge in his stronghold, and greeted him from thence with scornful words. Torrent, after having summoned his friends from Arragon, Provence, and Calabre, conquered the castle, and took Calamond prisoner. The traitor was sent out to sea in a leaky boat, and perished.

In his stead, Torrent was elected king by all the noblemen of the empire, and took the crown. But forty days after this, he quitted his realm, having intrusted two knights with its government, and passed to the Holy Land at the head of a large force. There he fought fifteen years against the infidels, conquered several towns, and got immeasurable treasures as booty. The king of Jerusalem, hearing about Torrent's deeds, and anxious for his own security, sent his son Leobertus, with an army of 50,000 men, against Torrent. A pitched battle began, but it was for a long time doubtful to which side victory would incline, till at last the two chiefs encountered. The son vanquishing his father decided the fate of the battle. Torrent was conveyed as a prisoner to Jerusalem, and thrown into a dungeon. There he lay above a year, till he was once overheard complaining his misfortunes by his son, who, touched with pity, prevailed upon the king to set Torrent at liberty. In this new state Torrent soon found an opportunity to show his valour and skill in arms, when a grand tournament was held at Jerusalem. There he proved sole victor over all the knights, and got the chief prize. The king of Nazareth, who had assisted at this joust, telling his folk at home who had won the prize, described the arms and escutcheon of the valiant knight. By these Desonelle recognized her beloved spouse. At her request the king called princes and knights from all parts of the world to a great tournament. The kings of Jerusalem, Greece, Leobertus, Antony fice Greffoun, and Torrent answered the call. Before an illustrious assembly of mighty princes and noble ladies, all of whom were surpassed by Desonelle in beauty and grace, the tournament began. Leobertus and Antony excelled in it, but the chief was Torrent, who performed wonders in the joust, vanquishing all valiant adversaries. The next morning Desonelle could no longer brook reserve, and was about to discover herself to Torrent; but overwhelmed with joy she fainted, when she had scarcely uttered the first words of greeting. It was not till midday that she was able to tell Torrent and the other knights her fates and those of her children. Then parents and children passionately embraced on recognizing each other. At Torrent's request, all of them, with the kings of Nazareth, Jerusalem, and Greece, and many attendants, sailed for Portugal. There the nuptials of Torrent with Desonelle were celebrated with a great round of splendid festivities. Torrent was finally elected Emperor of Rome, and reigned a long time gloriously. He lies there buried in a fair abbey.

A benediction finishes the romance.

If we take a survey of the poem, we shall recognize in its conception a harmonious plan and a certain unity of action, which, as in most of the romances, is founded on the hero and the interest he affects us with (See

Ten Brink, *Engl. Literat.*, I. p. 317). In the centre of the action is placed Torrent's love of Desonelle; for all the various combats that he undertakes against dragons and giants, against the prince of Arragon and King Calamond, are undertaken solely to gain him Desonelle. Even his expedition against the infidels and the fighting with his son are designed by Providence to make him find again his lost love. Halliwell (Preface, p. vii), therefore, is not right in deeming the romance 'a rambling poem of adventures without much plot.' The length and tediousness of the episodes may have prevented him from recognizing the unity of the whole. At the same time, however, it must be admitted that the poem cannot rank with the masterpieces of romantic poetry written in the same metre, like *Amis and Amiloun*, *Ipomadon*, *Kyng of Tars*, *Octavian*, either in the invention of plot or in the dissection of passions. The diction is so swelled with stereotyped phrases, and so surfeited with trivialities, that we may justly suppose the poem to have been composed at a period when romantic poetry had passed its best time, and had begun to decay. As to the authorship of the poem, it was probably composed by a monk. It is an easy thing to show peculiarities in the course of the story which are essentially monkish. As the romance begins and ends with a benediction, in the same way each deed and each adventure of the hero is introduced and finished by long prayers. Moreover, the poet points frequently to a direct interposition of Heaven (ll. 675, 1568, 1948); he describes the anguish and sorrow that Desonelle feels about her children's baptism (ll. 1892-1896 and 2074-76); he mentions emphatically Communion and Confession (1272 and 2139), Masses (756 and 813); he finally praises the Emperor for founding churches and abbeys (l. 2658). On the other side, we find very few of those marks which characterize the works of minstrels: the poet seldom predicts the fates of his heroes to excite the attention of his auditors; he mentions only by the way the performances of the gleemen, and nowhere speaks of the rewards that they get.

Passing to a special inquiry into the origin of the story of Torrent, I cannot persuade myself that it is of the poet's own invention, as that would be the only instance of a Middle-English romance not being taken from foreign originals (except, of course, Chaucer's *Sir Thopas*, which was written to ridicule this whole branch of poetry), whilst slight alterations or additions were frequently introduced by the translators. A French original of the

romance is supposed by Halliwell to have existed (Preface, vi). He says, 'It is probably, like the second copy of the romance of Horn, a modernized version of an older English romance, which was itself translated from the French. I have not been able to discover any traces of the French original, but there are some singular allusions to its origin in the poem itself. I allude to the frequent references to the *Book of Rome*.³ This term was applied to the French language, in which most of the old romances were originally written.' As for me, I don't think that we can much rely upon references of this kind, because they are common to all of these Middle-English romances. Of a somewhat greater weight is perhaps the fact that one or two of the proper names are French; and even the oath, 'par l'amour de dieu,' is worth mentioning. After all, there is no evident proof as to the French origin. But there is no doubt that the story of Torrent in its principal features—the adversities of a family separated by misfortunes, the mother robbed of her children by wild beasts, at last united again—proceeded from the old Eustache legend.⁴⁻⁵ Therewith another motive is combined, that of the woman innocently condemned, on which motive a large stock of legends is founded; for instance, those of Crescentia, Sibilla, Oliva, Genovefa, Griseldis and Octavian legends. Upon this motive and its old origin from India, see Streve, 'The Octavian legend,' *Erlangen Dissert.*, 84.

I will consider first the legend of Eustache in its original version. According to the Greek Martyr Acts, which were probably composed in the eighth century, this saint was before his baptism a captain of Trajan, named Placidus. As he one day hunted in the forest, the Saviour appeared to him between the antlers of a hart, and converted him. Placidus changed his name into Eustache, when he was baptized with his wife and sons. God announced to him by an angel his future martyrdom. Eustache was afflicted by dreadful calamities, lost all his estate, and was compelled to go abroad as a beggar with his wife and his children. As he went on board a ship bound for Egypt, his wife was seized by the shipmaster and carried off. Soon after, when Eustache was travelling along the shore, his two children were borne away by a lion and a leopard. Eustache then worked for a long time as a journeyman, till he was discovered by the Emperor Trajan, who had sent out messengers for him, and called him to his court. Reappointed captain, Eustache undertook an expedition against the Dacians. During this war he

found his wife in a cottage as a gardener,—the shipmaster had fallen dead to the ground as he ventured to touch her,—and in the same cottage he found again his two sons as soldiers: herdsmen had rescued them from the wild beasts, and brought them up. Glad was their meeting again! But as they returned to Rome, they were all burnt in a glowing bull of brass by the Emperor's order, because they refused to sacrifice to the heathen gods.

This legend, which reminds us at once of the story of Job, has been incorporated in almost all mediæval collections of legends, and upon it are founded some mediæval poems, which are enumerated by H. Knust in his splendid work *Dos Obras Didácticas y dos Leyendas*, Madrid, 1878; cf. R. Köhler, *Zeitschrift für rom. phil.* III, p. 272 ff., Varnhagen, *Anglia*, III, p. 399 ff.; two latin versions are edited by the same, *Zeitschrift für deutsches Alterthum* XXIV, p. 241 ff., and XXV, p. 1 ff.

English legends of Eustache are to be found

- (1) In Ælfric's *Passiones Martyrum*; see Horstmann, *Altenglische Legenden*, Second series, Heilbronn, 1881, p. xli.
- (2) In the South-English collection, *l.c.* p. xlvi.
- (3) In the Northern collection, pp. lxi and lxiv. Herrig's *Archiv* 57, p. 262 ff.
- (4) In the Scottish collection of legends, said to be Barbour's. Cf. Barbour's *Legendensammlung*, ed. C. Horstmann, Heilbronn, 82, ii. p. 12.
- (5) In the old Engl. translation of the *Legenda aurea*, see Horstm., *l.c.*, p. cxxxv. Caxton's edition of the legend, No. 196.
- (6) The complete text of the legend printed in Horstmann's above-mentioned collection, *Altengl. Legendensamml.*, p. 211 ff.
- (7) *St. Eustas*, by I. Partridge, see Gibbs' above-mentioned edition, and Horstm., *l.c.* p. 472 ff.

With this legend are connected, more or less, the following poems, which it is necessary to speak of in turn:

- (1) The Pseudo-Chrestien epic poem, *Guillaume d'Engleterre*. [6](#)
- (2) The two Middle High German poems, *Die gute Frau*, [7](#) and (3) *Der Graf von Savoyen*. [8](#)

(4) The romances of *Isumbras*; (5) of *Octavian*; (6) last, *Syr Eglamour of Artois*, and (7) *Sir Torrent of Portugal*.

The first five have been treated by Holland in his book, *Chrestien de Troies*, Tübingen, 1854.

According to Holland's opinion, all of these are derived from the legend of Eustache. He has not exactly inquired into each of them, but restricts himself to a detailed account of their contents. A critical inquiry into these poems, except the romance of *Octavian*, has been recently published by J. Steinbach: *Der einfluss des Crestien de Troies auf die altenglische literatur*. Leipzig, 1886, p. 41 ff. As to the French and the two German poems, it may be sufficient to refer to this exhaustive essay, since it is only by the same legendary origin that they are connected with *Sir Torrent*; otherwise they are quite different.

But of the English romances of *Sir Isumbras* and of *Octavian* it is necessary to treat more minutely. *Isumbras* was edited first by Utterson in his *Select Pieces of Early Popular Poetry*, London, 1817; secondly by Halliwell in *The Thornton Romances*, from the Lincoln MS. A. i. 17. A critical edition of this poem has long been promised by Prof. Zupitza.

In this romance the legend of Eustache can be most clearly recognized. Its contents are, indeed, somewhat transformed according to the taste of the later Middle Ages: the Roman captain is changed into a Christian knight, who performs wonders in fighting against the infidels; he finds his wife as queen of a heathen country; they end their lives as mighty princes, and so on. The legendary style has been supplanted by the romantic diction,⁹ but the leading features remain the same. In his above-mentioned essay, pp. 46-48, Steinbach concludes, from a detailed comparison of the contents, that the author of *Isumbras* did not derive his story from the epic poem, *Guillaume d'Engleterre*, but from an original which bore a still greater resemblance to the legend of Eustache, and, at the same time, contained many of those additions which are to be found in all versions of the legend. Whether this original was composed in Latin, French, or Anglo-Norman, Steinbach does not pretend to determine.

To *Isumbras* I join a few remarks on the romance of *Octavian*, which was edited by Halliwell for the Percy Society, *The Romance of the Emperor Octavian*, London, 1844; and by Sarrazin, *Zwei mittelhochd. Versionen der Octaviansage*, in Koelbing's *Altengl. Bibliothek*, Band III. As for its contents, cf. Sarrazin, as above, p. xviii ff. Concerning the origin of the story, he agrees in general with Holland, only he shows a still nearer connection between *Isumbras* and *Octavian*, taking the former for a mere imitation of the latter. This opinion, however, cannot be proved. As I cannot enter into detail, I only observe that the contents of *Octavian* are a great deal more complicated and copious than those of *Isumbras*, which is simple in its plot and style, and shows the nearest resemblance to the old Eustache legend, whilst *Octavian* is a refined and adorned version of the legendary tale with considerable change in the plan. *Isumbras*, of course, bears a strict resemblance to Eustache, but not to the Emperor Octavian, who has but little of the character of a suffering saint, as he does not become an outlaw himself, nor is to lose his earthly goods. Even those of his adventures which are conformable to the original—the separation from his family, the rape of the children, the final reunion—are exhibited in a different manner.

The principal contents of the romance of *Octavian* bear internal evidence of its later origin, as it treats chiefly of the adventures and exploits of Florent, Octavian's son; especially in the second half of the story, exploits of Florent so prevail that the romance might justly bear his name on the title instead of his father's. I therefore believe that Sarrazin's opinion, that *Isumbras* is nothing but a bad imitation of *Octavian*, is wrong; and I am rather inclined to think the two poems were composed independently from each other, after French originals, as is evidently the case with *Octavian*, and probably with *Isumbras*. See Halliwell, *Thornt. Rom.*, p. xviii. Sarrazin, moreover, supposes, p. xlv, both poems to be due to the same author, in consequence of the conformity of the dialect and style, and of some literal coincidences. But the fact that both of these romances are written in the same dialect is not sufficient to prove the identity of the authors, nor is the style, which is nearly stereotyped in all of these romances. As to the literal coincidences, only three of the nine passages quoted by Sarrazin seem to me to be of any importance. See *Octavian*, notes on ll. 382, 397, 481. But even these only show that the writer of *Octavian* knew *Isumbras*, or *vice versâ*.

As to the relation between *Octavian* and our poem, these two romances have no other affinity than the same legendary origin, and the motive of the woman innocently persecuted, which may very well have been introduced independently by two different authors. In all other particulars they are quite different.

The heroes bear little resemblance to their legendary models; in *Octavian* the Emperor of Rome; in *Torrent* the young, hardy knight who encounters marvellous struggles to win the hand of his spouse. Also in the treatment of the other motive, each romance has taken its own course. In *Octavian*, Florence is calumniated by her mother-in-law; in *Torrent*, Desonelle is persecuted by her father. The causes are consequently quite different: there the jealousy of the mother-in-law against the mighty Empress; here Calamond's hatred against Torrent. These differences, now only alluded to, cause a great number of others, and produce a general difference of the two poems, which renders the opinion of a nearer connection between them altogether illusory.

Of all the poems mentioned above, the last, *Syr Eglamour of Artois*, is most nearly related to *Sir Torrent*, a fact found out by Halliwell, [10](#) who, however, thought that there was no necessity for him to prove a similarity which would be at once detected by the reader; still, he takes it for certain that the romance of *Torrent* is younger than and partly founded on *Sir Eglamour*. As he gives no proof for this opinion, it will be worth while to enter once more into this question, in order to see whether he is right or not.

Upon it, the MSS. do not help us. The earliest MS. that can have contained *Sir Eglamour* is the parchment one of the Duke of Sutherland, [11](#) written about the end of the 14th century. The other four MSS. of it [12](#) are still later. The only MS. of *Sir Torrent* belongs to the 15th century, so that neither of these romances can be traced very far back.

Sir Eglamour was printed several times in the beginning of the 16th century, and edited anew by Halliwell from the Cambridge MS. in his well-known collection. To judge from the numerous readings of the Lincoln, Cotton, and Cambridge MSS. which he has quoted, the Lincoln MS. shows best the original dialect, and offers in several passages a reading preferable

as to rhyme and meaning. ¹³ Even slight differences in the contents occur now and then. ¹⁴

The metre and probably the dialect are the same in both romances; they are composed in the tail-rhymed twelve-line stanzas, and written in a North Midland dialect. In both of them the style is alike swelled with the habitual phrases; only the long prayers and pious reflections so frequent in *Torrent* are not to be met with in *Eglamour*. On the other hand, the poet is wont to predict the fates of his heroes (ll. 204, 951); he often demands attention (ll. 15, 39, 343, 634, 904); he never omits, in describing the festivals, to mention the performances of the minstrels, and to praise the liberality of the lords. These characteristics render it probable that the author of *Eglamour* was a minstrel, not a clerk or monk, as I suppose the author of *Sir Torrent* to be.

I now pass on to compare the contents of the two poems. The principal features of the plot are the same in both. A young knight who seeks the hand of a princess engages to win her by valiant exploits. The princess's father opposes his wooing, jealous as he is of the hero's renown. The knight vanquishes all the giants and other monsters against which he is told to fight, and at length gains his spouse. A few weeks after their marriage, he sets out again on adventurous expeditions. While he stays abroad, his wife is delivered of twins. Her father sends her to sea in a leaky boat; she lands on a foreign shore, where her children are carried off by wild beasts; but they are saved in a marvellous manner, and brought up at royal courts, whilst she herself lives for a long time at a foreign court. As the hero, when he comes home again, doesn't find her, he goes into the Holy Land to fight with the infidels. After various adventures he finds his wife and children after a tournament at a foreign court. They return home gladly, and celebrate their nuptials by great festivals. The cruel father is duly punished.

On entering into details, however, we find considerable discrepancies between the two romances. First, the names are altogether different. (*Eglamour* = *Torrent*. *Crystyabelle* = *Desonelle*. *Prynsamour* = *Calamond*. *Organata* = *Gendres*. *Degrabelle* = *Antony fice Greffoun*.) The stage of the plot is in *Eglamour* Artois, Rome, and Egypt; in *Torrent* Portugal, Norway, and Calabre. Only the Holy Land is mentioned in both. There the children

are carried off by wild beasts, saved by princes and brought up; there the hero fights against the infidels.

The differences of the plot itself are the following:

1. Eglamour confesses his love to Crystyabelle before his deeds; a squire is the go-between in his suit; Eglamour finds love in return. In *Torrent* Desonelle does not know that she is adored by the hero till after his first exploit. See [ll. 109, 448](#).
2. Accordingly, Eglamour, setting out on adventures, receives two greyhounds and a sword of St. Paul from Crystyabelle as presents, whereas Torrent gets an ambler from his lady love, but not till after his first deed.
3. Prynsamour charges Eglamour with three deeds by which he is to gain Crystyabelle. Torrent is obliged to undertake not less than five combats.
4. In *Torrent* the combats of the hero are enlarged and adorned by additions not to be found in *Eglamour*. The latter does not release the daughters and sons of kings, nor does he find precious swords in the castles of the giants, nor is he deceived by a king's counterfeit letter, which causes Torrent a dangerous struggle and the rivalry of a foreign prince. Only in *Eglamour* (ll. 40-48) some knights are mentioned who came to win Crystyabelle by jousting, but were all vanquished by Eglamour.

The greatest differences are found in the second halves of the stories.

5. Crystyabelle has one child by Eglamour; Desonelle has two by Torrent.
6. Crystyabelle is driven away into Egypt, where she is graciously received by the king. Desonelle finds refuge in the court of the king of Nazareth.
7. Degrabelle, the son of Crystyabelle, is saved and brought up by the king of Israel; the sons of Desonelle by the kings of Greece and Jerusalem.
8. The father of Crystyabelle is not punished like Calamond in *Torrent*, immediately after the hero's return, but he dies at the end of the poem, throwing himself down from the battlements.
9. Degrabelle is sent, when fifteen years old, into Egypt by his adoptive father to sue for a spouse. In a joust he gains the hand of his mother and marries her. On the very wedding-day the mother recognizes her son by his

escutcheon, and the marriage is instantly dissolved. Quite differently does the story run in *Sir Torrent*. Leobertus, fifteen years old, marches by order of the king of Jerusalem against his father, and takes him prisoner, but at length solicits his release.

10. The tournament, which in both poems compasses the reunion of the separated family, is brought on in a different manner. In *Eglamour* Degrabelle himself proposes the hand of his mother as the prize in the next tournament, to which his father comes. In *Torrent* Desonelle, hearing of the victories of the strange knight, supposes him to be her spouse from his arms, and at her request a tournament is arranged. (Her hand seems to have been likewise the prize, as may be gleaned from l. 2440.)

11. At the very end of the poems two slight differences are to be noted: in *Eglamour*, Degrabelle marries Organata, daughter of the king of Sidon, whereas the sons of *Torrent* return into Greece and Jerusalem. *Eglamour* is crowned prince of Artois; *Torrent* is elected Emperor of Rome.

From this comparison we may conclude that *Torrent* is not directly founded upon *Eglamour*, or *vice versâ*; the differences are too great to justify the supposition that either is drawn from the other. Especially is the opinion of Halliwell, which I mentioned above, to be rejected: *Sir Torrent* cannot be founded on *Sir Eglamour*, simply because it agrees more closely with the old legendary tale than *Syr Eglamour* does, and has preserved some essential features not to be found in *Eglamour*, in which these are supplanted by others. Desonelle, for instance, has two children according to the old legend, Crystyabelle one; *Torrent* must fight and suffer in heathen lands like Eustache, whereas *Eglamour* appears as a mere knight-errant. Further, neither in the Eustache legend nor in *Torrent* do we find the history of the son who marries his mother, which motive the poet may have taken from the legend of Pope Gregory, or perhaps from the tale of *Syr Degaré*.

But how can the resemblance of the leading features and the discrepancies in particulars be explained? I think the most probable conjecture is, that an old poem, now lost, existed, with which the authors of *Sir Eglamour* and of *Sir Torrent* were acquainted; but not having a MS. of it, or knowing it by heart, both of them made up their minds to rewrite the story in a well-known metre, changing, omitting, adding whatever they liked, even filling

up the gaps in their memories by invention. Both of them recollected the first half of the story better than the second.

That this poem was an English one seems to be shown by a good many verbal coincidences in both poems; these I accordingly suppose to have belonged to the lost original. They are, indeed, too frequent to be counted simply amongst the large stock of conventional phrases which are to be met with in every poem of this kind. Here they are:—

<i>Eglamour.</i>		<i>Torrent.</i>	
The boke of Rome thus can telle.		As the boke of Rome tellys.	
	408, 561, 886		187, 924, 1450, 1924
Ther ys a jeaunt here besyde,	478	There ys a gyante here besyde,	
That sorowe doyth ferre and wyde.		In ale thys covntre fare and wyde,	
On us and odur moo.		No man on lyve levythe hee.	960
And alle prayed for that knyght.	573	For hym all they pray.	108
Alle that in the cyté ware.	598	All that in the sytte were.	1047
Alle that cuntrey was fulle fayne,	640	Gentilmen were blith and ffayn,	1098
That he homeward was comyn ageyne.		That he in helth was comyn agayn.	
Aftur sopur, as y yow telle,		After mete, as I you tell,	
He wendyd to chaumber with Crystyabelle.		To speke with mayden Desonell	
	670, 671	To her chamber he went.	1358-60
That lady was not for to hyde,	673-75	The damysell-so moche of pride,	
She sett hym on hur beddys syde,		Set hym on her bed-syde,	
And welcomyd home that knyght.		And said 'welcom' verament.'	1363
So graciously he come hur tylle,	679	Such gestenyng he a-right,	
Of poyntes of armys he schewyd hur		That there he dwellid all nyzt	
hys fylle,	680	With that lady gent.	1364-66
That there they dwellyd alle nyzt.			
A golde rynge y schalle geve the,	715	Thes gold rynges I shall yeve the,	
Kepe yt wele my lady free,		Kepe them well; my lady ffre,	
Yf Cryste sende the a chylde!	717	Yf god a child vs send!	1396-1398
Doghtur, into the see schalt thou,	803	There fore thou shalt in to the see	
Yn a schypp alone,		And that bastard with-in the!	1793
And that bastard that to the ys dere!			
Sche prayed hur gentylwomen so free,		She said 'knyghtis and ladyes gent,	
Grete wele my lord, whon ye hym see!		Grete well my lord sir Torrent,	
	826, 827	Yeff ye hym euer sene!	1837-39
Hur yonge sone away he bare.	842	A way he bare her yong son.	1871
Thys chylde ys comyn of gentylle blode,		This chylde is come of gentill teme,	

Where that ever that he was tane.	863	Where euer this beest hym ¹ ffond.	1923
Kepe we thys lady whyte as flowre, And speke we of syr Egyllamowre.	950	Leve we now that lady gent, And speke we of sir Torrent.	2080-81
The knyght swownyd in that tyde.	975	Swith on sownyng there he fell.	2093
Be the XV yerys were comyn and gone, The chylde that the grype hath tane, Waxe bothe bold and stronge.	1018-20	And be the VII yere were gone, The child that the liberd had tane, Found hym his fill-off ffyght.	2233-35
Yn yustyng ne in turnament	1021	With heve tymbyr and ovyrryde	40
Ther myght no man withsytt hys dynte,		Ther myght no man ¹ hys dent abyde,	
But to the erthe them thronge.	1023	But to the erthe he them strake.	42
Be thre wekys were comyn to 3ende, Yn the londe of Egypt can they lende.	1057	But ore thre wekes were comyn ¹ to end, To Portynggall-gan he wend.	373
Gentilmen that herde of thys crye, Thedur come they redylye.	1195-96	Gret lordys that herith this crye, Theder come richely.	2431-32
Syr Egyllamour knelyd on his kne, 'A Lorde God 3ylde hyt the!	1288-89	Torent knelid vppon ¹ his knee And said 'God yeld you, lordys ffree!	2575
In swounyng than felle that lady free, 'Welcome, syr Eglamour, to me!		She said 'welcom ¹ , my lord sir Torent! And so be ye, my lady gent! In sownyng than fell-she.	2505
<u>Eglamour</u> , Linc. MS. Note on 1267:			
Grete lordis thane told scho sone.		Gret lordys told she sone.	2539

Perhaps some more light will be thrown on this question when we get the much-wanted critical edition of *Sir Eglamour*; but I fear that the 'secret history attached to the source of these romances' will even then remain to be unravelled. What I have proposed has no title to a better name than a conjecture.

§ 5. THE ARRANGEMENT OF THE EDITION.

As to the only MS. in which this romance has come down to us, I have mentioned before that it is exceedingly corrupt; many conjectures, more or less sure, were necessary in order to restore metre, rhyme, and meaning; the greater part of them seemed worthy to be entered in the text, the rest being offered in the notes. No attempt has been made to introduce a uniform

character of dialect, considering the quite unsettled state of orthography in early times. The only exceptions are where the sounds are fully determined by the rhyme. In general the orthography of the MS. has been reproduced as accurately as possible. The contractions used by the scribe are expanded and printed in italics. At the beginning of a new period, or a proper name within the line, capitals have been introduced. From l. 1200, where the numeration of my text no longer coincides with that of Halliwell's edition, the line-numbers of the latter are added in brackets.

The fragments which I have added as an appendix to the text have been consulted in all cases of difficulty, and proved of no little service in correcting the blunders of the manuscript; they contain indeed a somewhat better text than the MS., though they are by no means free from clerical errors. A detailed comparison gives the following result:

In fifty-one lines the text of the fragments is evidently correcter than the MS.:

<i>Fragments.</i>		<i>Manuscript.</i>
The kyng of Nazareth sent hym me, Torent, I wot-saue hym on the.	466	The kyng of Portynggall-seyd, 'So mot I the! Torrent, I wet-saffe of the.
The kyng wolde fayne that he ded were, And he wyst nat on what manere.	472	The kyng wolde fayne that he wer ded, And hym wyst in what maner.
To Torent that was true as stele,	477	To Torrent trew ase styl;
In what londe that they brede.	487	In what lond they ne bred.
He bestrode a noble stede.	502	Tho he bestrod another stede.

Cf. 489, 498, 507-10, 512-15, 822, 825, 831, 833, 834, 837, 845, 848, 851, 929, 932, 933, 935, 947, 948, 951, 952, 958, 965, 968-70, 1807, 1808, 1810, 1827, 1828, 1831, 1834-36, 1844, 1854, 1866.

Forty-eight lines are coincident: 468, 470, 474, 479, 480, 486, 487, 495, 499, 501, 504, 505, 520, 823, 832, 842, 844, 846, 917, 918, 921, 922, 927, 928, 936, 938, 953, 957, 962, 1809, 1813-17, 1819-21, 1823, 1830, 1832, 1838, 1847, 1850, 1851-52, 1863, 1865.

In ninety-one lines it is doubtful which reading is to be considered as the original one:

<i>Fragments.</i>		<i>Manuscript.</i>
As they walkyd by the ryvers syde.	469	Ase the went be the watyres syd.
Howe he myght hym shent.	473	How he schuld be schent.
The kyng sayde 'what may this be? Lorde, it is sent to me For a faucon shene.	483-85	Syr, he seyde, what may thys be? Loo, lord, come ner and see Abowght a facon schene.
Than sayde the kyng vntrue, 'And ye fynde hawes of great value, Brynge me one with the!	492-94	And than seyde the kyng ontrew, 'Yf thow get hawkys of great valew, Bryng on of them to me!
Of thy dowghter hende.	836	Of yowr dowghttyr hend.

Cf. 467, 475, 476, 478, 481, 482, 488, 496, 497, 500, 506, 511, 516-20, 821, 824, 826, 827, 829, 830, 835, 838-41, 843, 847, 850, 919, 920, 923, 925-26, 930-31, 934, 937, 939, 940-43, 945, 946, 949, 950, 954, 955, 959, 960-61, 963, 964, 966, 967, 1811, 1812, 1818, 1822, 1825, 1826, 1829, 1837, 1840, 1842, 1843, 1845-46, 1848-49, 1853, 1855-62, 1864.

In eleven lines the text of the MS. is superior to that of the fragment:

<i>Fragments.</i>		<i>Manuscript.</i>
'Ye, by my trouthe!' sayd Torente.	828	'Ye, be trouthe!' seyde Torrent than.
Delycyous notes on hyghe.	944	Delycyous nottis on hyght.
Frowarde the se.	956	Froward the sytte.

Cf. 488, 503, 820, 849, 924, 1824, 1833, 1839.

As to the sixth fragment, 1014-36, and the beginning of the first (in Halliwell's edition the third), 462-64, in which, as above mentioned, not much more than the rhyming words are preserved, they have nearly the same relation to the MS. as the other ones.

In the following passages they correct the rhymes of the MS.: 1017, 1018, 1028, 1033. Coincident rhymes: 1014, 1015, 1019, 1026, 1027, 1032, 1034-36. Undecided: 1020, 1021, 1023-24, 1029-30, 462-64. The rhymes of the MS. are preferable in ll. 1016, 1022, 1025, 1031.

I need only add, that all the discrepancies between the MS. and the fragments, however numerous they may be, concern, for the most part,

things of little importance; they are caused especially by the frequent change of synonymous terms, by the difference of expletive words and phrases, the transposition of words, the change of tenses, and so on. But as there is nowhere any essential difference to be traced, we may conjecture with great probability that the early printed edition of the romance was taken from a manuscript which was pretty nearly related to the Manchester MS., though somewhat more correctly written.

I gladly take the present opportunity of acknowledging my very great obligation to Prof. Koelbing, from whom I have received ample assistance throughout the whole of this work. It would be absolutely impossible to me entirely to discriminate his part from mine. He carefully revised the introduction, notes, and the glossary, before they went to press, and after they came from it, and he looked several times through the proofs of the text. Nor am I less indebted to Mr. Joseph Hall at Manchester, who not only kindly read the proofs of the text with the MS. in the Chetham Library, but also contributed some valuable notes, which are marked by his name. The Director has added the head-lines and side-notes.

Footnotes to Introduction

[1.](#) Halliwell says, Preface v f.: ‘It is very incorrectly written, and the copy of the romance of Torrent of Portugal, which occupies 88 pages of the book, contains so many obvious blunders and omissions, that it may be conjectured with great probability to have been written down from oral recitation.’

[2.](#) The rhymes with *tane* and with *John* are not quoted, as these words occur also as *tone* and *Johan*; they are, therefore, of no use in fixing the sound of the *â*.

[3.](#) On this term see *Octavian*, ed. Sarrazin, p. xxxviii.

[4.](#) See Warton’s opinion upon the legendary origin of many romances, *History of Engl. Poetry*, London, 1824, I. p. ccxliv: ‘Many romances were at first little more than legends of devotion, containing the pilgrimage of an old warrior. At length, as chivalry came into vogue, the youthful and active part of the pilgrim’s life was also written. The penitent changed into the knight-errant.’ Sometimes, of course, the opposite change may have taken place, as for instance is probably the case with the story of the two faithful friends, Amis and Amiloun (cf. Koelbing, *Amis*, p. lxxxi), and with the story of Robert the Devil (cf. *Sir Gowther*, ed. Breul, p. 74).

[5.](#) See the edition of *The worthie Hystorie of Plasidas*, 1566, by H. H. Gibbs, for the Roxburghe Club, 1873.

[6.](#) *Guill. d'Engleterre*, ed. Fr. Michel, *Chron. Anglo-Norm.*, III. 39-172. On the authorship of this poem see C. Hofmann, *Sitzungsberichte der Münch. Akad.*, 1870, II. p. 51, and P. Meyer, *Romania*, VIII. p. 815 f.

[7.](#) *Die gute Frau*, ed. E. Sommer in Haupt's *Zeitschrift für deutsches Alterthum*, II. 389.

[8.](#) *Der Graf v. Savoyen*, ed. F. H. v. d. Hagen, *Minnesinger*, IV. 640, and Eschenburg, *Denkmäler altdeutscher Dichtkunst*, Bremen, 1799.

[9.](#) On this text see Sarrazin, *Octav.*, p. xlv; he speaks of "die entstellte, spielmannsmässig zersungene Form, in der die Thornton Ms uns die legende überliefert. . . . dasselbe Pathos, dieselbe Sentimentalität und Frömmerei, aber auch dieselbe anschauliche und lebhaftige Erzählungsweise (sc. as in Oct.)."

[10.](#) *The Thornton Romances*, p. xxii f. 'The romance of *Torrent* is partly founded upon the story related in *Sir Eglamour*. The names are changed, but the resemblance is too striking to have been the result of chance. The treachery of the sovereign, the prowess of the knight, the indiscretions and misfortunes of the lady, and the happy conclusion of her misfortunes, these form the leading incidents of each romance . . . there is, perhaps, a secret history attached to the source of these romances that remains to be unravelled.'

[11.](#) Cf. Koelbing's *Englische Studien*, vii. p. 191 ff.

[12.](#) Cf. *The Thornton Romances*, p. xxv ff., and p. xxxvi.

[13.](#) See the following passages which Halliwell has quoted in the notes: *Eglam.* 54, 96, 107, 111, 122, 128, 139, 153, 177, 195, 213, 247, 337, 347, 399, 445, 572, 605, 614, 737, 740, 765, 858, 883, 945, 985, 1081, 1143, 1206, 1216.

[14.](#) See *Eglamour*, notes on ll. 1064, 1082, 1267.

Torrent of Portyngale.

Here bygynneth a good tale
Of Torrente of Portyngale.

f. 76a.

(1)

God, that ys worthy and Bold,
Heuen' and Erthe haue In hold,
 Fyld, watyr, and wynde,
Yeve vse *grace* hevyn' to wyne,
And brynge vs owt off Dedly synne 5
 And In thy *seruyse* to Ende!
A stounde and ye wolþ-lyst be-Dene,
Ale dowghtty men' þat Euyr hathe ben',
 Wher So that they lende,
I Schallþ-yow telþ; ore I hense pase, 10
Off a knyght, þat Dowghtty wase,
 In Rome ase clarkys ffynde.

leaf 1

May God give

us grace to win Heaven

I'll tell you of a doughty
knight.

8. *byn* MS.

(2)

In Portynggallþ; that Ryche londe,
An Erellþ-that wase wonande,
 That curtese wase and *wyght*; 15
Sone aftyr he had a sone,
The feyerest þat on fot myght gon,
 Tyrrant, men seyð, he hyght.
Be tyme he wase XVIII yer' old,
Of deddes of armys he wase bold, 20

He dwelt in Portugal,

and fought well when
18.

To felle bothe kyng and knyght;
And now commythe dethe appon a day
And takythe hys father^o, ase I yow sey,
For God ys most of myght.

15. *wyght*] *Dowghtty* MS.

21. *felle*] first *l* above the line MS.

ENT LOVES DESONELL.

(3)

The kyng of Portynggall wase fayne, 25
To-warde hym he takythe Torrayne,
That Dowghtty ys in^o dedde;
And ther he fesomnyd in^o hys hond
A good Eyrldom in^o that lond,
Bothe forest and *fede*. 30
The kyng hathe a dowghttyr *whyte* ase *fame*,
Dysonell wase her name,
Worthyest in wede.
When Torrent had of her^o a syght,
More he lovyd that swete *wyght* 35
Than^o all-ys fathyr's lede.

The King

gives Torrent an
earldom,

f. 76b.

and he falls in love with
the King's daughter
Desonell,

30. *fede*] *Downe* MS.

31. *whyte ase fame*] *feyer ase flowyr* MS.

32. *Dyscenys*, MS.

35. *swete*] *swet*, MS.

wyght] *wyte* MS.

36. *lede*] *londe* MS.

(4)

For love of thys lady Deyr^o
In dede of armys far and nere
Aventorres gan he take
With heve tymbyr and ovyr-Ryde, 40
Ther myght no man^o hys dent a-bydde,

and for her,

But to the Erthe he them strake.
Her father and other knyghttes mo
Had farly, how he Ryd soo,
And on a day to hyme spake, 45
He Seyd: 'Torrent, howe may thys byne,
That thow Dyspysyst thes knyghttes kene
And ordurres non wolȝtake?'

39. *A ventorres* MS.

42. *stroke* MS.

47. *dysplesyst* MS.

unhorses many knights.

(5)

Torrent sayd: 'So mvt I the,
An other sayment wolȝ I see, 50
Ore I take ordor of knyght.'
Tho he sware be hevyn kyng,
Ther wase told hym a wondyr-thing'
In hys chambyr to nyght:
'For' the love of my doughter dere 55
Thow makyst good far and nere
In' Dedde of armys bryght;
And wyt thow wylȝ, so god me saue,
Thow schalt her' wyne, yf thow her haue,
Be thow neuyr so wyght!' 60

50. *And* MS.

see] bee MS.

60. *wyght] wyttht* MS.

The King

knows that Torrent
loves his daughter,

ING ASKS TORRENT TO FIGHT A GREEK GIANT.

(6)

Torrent sayd: 'Be Marry dere,
And I were off armyse clere,
Yowr Dowghttyr me leve were.'
The kyng seyde: 'Yf yt be soo,

f. 77a.

Ore VII yere be a-go, 65

More schall we here:

Durst thow, for my dowghttyr sake,

A poynt of armys for to take

With-owt helpe of fere?’

Than seyð Torrant: ‘So god me sped, 70

With anny man’ that syttythe on stede

Other far ore nere!’

and asks him if, for her
sake, he’ll fight

61. *Marry*] *e* corrected into *y*.

65. *a-go*] *a gone*, *ne* struck out, MS.

(7)

Ther-of the kyng’ for tene wax wode:

‘Yf thow wylt make thy body good,

Be trew and hold thy contenance

. 75

Tho seyð Torrant: ‘So god me sped ere!

And I wyst, in’ what sted they were,

Fore no man’ wold I chaunce.’

75. *contnnce* MS.

78. *chaunce*] corrected out of *change* MS.

(8)

‘In to the Grekes see a mylle

Ther lyvythe a gyant *in an yle*, 80

Full Euyll-thow dourst hyme stond.

My fayer’ forestes fellythe downe he

And Ryche castelles in’ that contre,

No ston lettythe he stond.’

a Giant in the Greek
sea.

80. *lyvythe*] *lyghttythe* MS.

in an yle] *mauyle* MS.

ENT IS TO FIGHT THE GIANT BEGONMESE.

Terrent sayd: ‘Be Marre bryght, 85
Yt ys gret sorrow that he hathe syght,
The devyll of hell hym blynd!’
The *kyng* sayd: ‘Par la-more de dewe,
Thow darryst full evyll *with* thy Ey hym sewe,
He wold fel the *with* hys wynde.’ 90
‘Now, be my trowthe,’ seyde Torrent than’, agrees to fight
‘Ase I ame a jentylman’,
Yf I may hym fynd,
Won fot wol I not fro hym pase,
Thow he be stronger than Samson’ wase, 95 f. 77b.
Or anny man’ of *hys* kynd!’

96. *hys*] om. MS.

Hys squyerys, they mornyd sare,
With-owt fere that he schold fare
 To that gret iorney,
With the gyant heygh for to fyght. 100 the Giant Begonmese,
 Be-gon'-mese that gyant hyght,
 That fynddes fere for aye.
 To arme hyme Torrant gas,
 Hys good stede *with* hym he tas,
With owt squyer' that Day. 105
 He takythe leve at lord dys hend,
 And on hys wey gan he wynd, and sets out.
 For hym all they pray.

108. *pray*] *prayd* MS.

(11)

Lytyll̥wyst Desonell̥that jente,
For whos love that he went 110
 To fyght *with* that knave.
Now god, that Dyed appon a Rode,
Strengithe hym bothe bone and blod,
 The fyld for to haue!
He that schall̥wend soche a wey, 115
Yt were nede for hym to pray,
 That Iesu hym schuld saue.
Yt ys in̥ the boke of Rome,
Ther was no knyght of kyrstendome,
 That jorney Durst crave. 120

Desonell knows not tha
it is for love of her.

God give Torrent
victory!

ENT SEES THE GIANT SLEEPING.

(12)

VI days Rydythe he
By the cost of the feyer̥ see,
 To seke the gyant kene.
By the cost as he Rode,
In a forest longe and brode 125
 And symly wase to sene,
Hey sperrys ther he fonde
And gret olyvys growonde
 Coverd in̥ levys *grene*.
Sone wase he ware, ase y yow say, 130
Vppon a movnteyn̥ ther he laye
 On slepe, ase I wene.

After 6 days' ride

f. 78a.

he sees the Giant asleep

123. *seke*] *ches*, struck out, *seke* written over with paler ink.

126. *see* MS.

129. *grene*] *smale* MS.

(13)

Torrent, on kne knelyd he
 And be-sowght Jesu so fre,
 That bowght hym *with* hys blod: 135
 ‘Lord, ase thow dyd ryght for Mary,
 Let me never take velony
 And gef me of thy fode!
 Serttes, yf I hym slepyng¹ slone,
 Manfull¹ Ded were yt none 140
 For my body, be the Rode.’
 Tho Terrant blewe hys bugel¹ bold,
 To loke that he a-wake wold,
 And sythe ner¹ hyme Rode.

He prays for Christ’s
 help.

136. *ryght*] *lyght* written above the line with paler ink.
mare MS.

ENT WAKES THE GIANT BEGONMESE.

(14)

So fast a-slepe he wase browght, 145
 Hys hornys blast a-woke hyme nowght,
 He swellyd ase dothe the see.
 Torrent saw, he wold not wake,
 He Reynyd hys sted vnto a stake,
 Ase a jentyll¹ man¹ *so fre*. 150
 So hy, he say, wase the movnteyne,
 Ther myght no horse wynd hym¹ a-geyn¹
 But yf he nowyd wold be;
 Thowe the wey neuyr¹ so wykkyd ware,
 On hys wey gan he fare, 155
 In¹ gret perayll¹ went hee.

As Torrent can’t wake
 the Giant with his bugle

f. 78b.

150. *so fre*] *in fere* MS.

151. *say*] *sayd* MS.

152. *mygh* (!) MS.

154. *were* MS.

(15)

Torent went to that movnteyn',
He put hys spere hyme a-geyne,
 'A-Ryse, fellow!' gan he saye;
'Who made the so bold here to dwell; 160
My lordes frethe thus to fell?
 A-mendes the be-hovythe to pay.'
The gyant Rysythe, ase he had byn' wod,
And Redyly by hyme stode,
 Be-syd hyme on a lay, 165
And seyde: 'Sertes, yf I leve,
Soche a wed I wolke the geff,
 To meve the Euyr' and ay.'

157. *movnten* MS.

he stirs him up with his
spear,

and makes him wild.

(16)

Thow the chyld were neuyr' so yinge,
The fyndes spere sparrythe hyme no-tyng' 170
 In the holttes haree;
Who had fare and nere byne,
And neuer had of fityng syn',
 He myght a lernyd thare.
The gyant, the fyrst stroke to hym he cast, 175
His good schyld all-to-brast,
 In schevyres spred wase yare;
Tho covd he no bettur Red,
But stond stylk; tylk one were ded;
 The gyant lefte hym thar. 180

The fight begins.

169. *yonge* MS.

171. *In] Ihū (!)* MS.

horee MS.

173. *seyn* MS.

174. *there* MS.

175. *to hym]* written above the line.

177. *there* MS.

178. *he no]* *not he* MS.
 Ryd MS.
180. *ther* MS.

GIANT BURSTS HIMSELF ON A ROCK.

(17)

Torrent vndyr hys spryt he sprent
And a-bowght the body he hyme hente,
 As far as he myght last.
‘A! fellow, wylt thow so?’
And to the grownd gan they goo, 185
 Of the movnteyn’ bothe downe they past.
Ase the boke of Rome tellys,
They tornyd XXXII *ellys*,
 In armys walloyng fast.
Yt tellythe in’ the boke of Rome, 190
Euyr’ ase the gyant a-boue come,
 Hys guttes owt of hys body *brast*.

Torrent grips the Giant;
f. 79a.

they both fall, and roll
down the mountain.

The Giant bursts

181. *sprent]* *spred* MS.
186. *they past]* *gan they pase* MS.
188. *ellys]* *tymys* MS.
192. *brast]* *Rane* MS.

(18)

At the fot of the movnteyn’
Ther lay a gret Ragyd ston’, *serteyn*’,
 Yt nyhed ys schuldyr bon’ 195
And also hys Ryght syd,
Ther to that gyant felþ that tyd,
 Ase *I* herd in’ Rome . . .

open against a big stone

197 put before 196. MS.
198. *I]* *he* MS.

HE THANKS GOD FOR HIS VICTORY.

(19)

Thorow hyme, that mad man',
Torrent sone a-bovyn' wane 200
And fast he gan *him quelle*
With a knyffe feyer' and bryght;
Torrent, *with* all-hys myght
Ther-*with* he gard hyme dwell.

Torrent stabs the Giant,

199. after *Thorow*, *of* has been scraped out.

201. *him quelle*] *warke* MS.

203. *hys*] *h* corrected out of *m* MS.

(20)

Torent knelyd on hys kne, 205
To Iesu Cryst prayd he,
That hathe thys world to wyld:
'Lord, lovyd, evyr lovyd thowe be,
The feyer' fyld thow hast lent Me,'
—Vpp bothe hys handes *he* held— 210
'All-onely *with*-owt any knaue
Of the fynd the maystry to haue,
Of hym to wyn the fyld.'
Now ys ther none other to say,
Of hyme he wane the fyld þat day; 215
I pray God hyme schyld.

and then thanks Christ.

f. 79b.

210. *he*] om. MS.

213. *wyn*] *wynd*, *d* erased MS.

214. *to* written above the line, MS.

215.

Now ys ther non other say

Of hyme to wyne the fyld þat day add. (!) MS.

(21)

Torrent went vppe a-geyne
To the movnt, ase I gan sayne,
The londes to se far and nere;

In the see a myle, hyme tho3t, 220
An hold wase Rychyly wrowt,
In that lond wase not here perre.
The see wase Ebbyd, I yow sey,
Torrent thether toke the way,
Werry alþthow he were; 225
And ther he fownd Ryche wonys,
Towrres Endentyd *with* presyos stonys,
Schynnyng ase crystall clere.

219. *to se* written above the line.

ENT GOES TO THE GIANT'S CASTLE.

(22)

Two gattys off yron' ther he fond,
Ther in' Torrent gan wonde, 230
A nyghtes Rest there in' *to* ta;
And at the hale dore ther wase
A lyon' & a lyonasse,
Ther men be-twene them twa
Fast Etyng', ase ye may here; 235
Crystyñ *man* thow *he* were,
Hys browys *wexe* bla,
And wit yow wilþ; lord god yt wote,
He durst goo no fote,
Lest they wold hyme sla. 240

(23)

Torrant stod and be-held,
And prayd to god, that ale may wyld,
To send hyme harborrow good.
Sone hard he *within* a whalle
The syghyng of a lady smalle, 245
Sche weppte, as sche were wod;

He sees the sea,

and goes to it.

Torrent finds the Giant's
castle,

guarded by a lion and
lioness.

f. 80a.

He hears a lady sighing
within.

Sche mornyd sore and sayd: ‘Alas,
 That Euyr’ kynges dowghttyr wase
 Ouer-come of so jentyll blod,
 For now ame I holdyn’ here 250
 In lond *with* a fyndes fere!’
 Torrent hard, wher he stod.

226. *wonys]* *wayes* MS.
 229. *Two]* *The* MS.
 231. *to ta]* *he take* MS.
 234. *twa]* *twayne* MS.
 236. *man]* *thow (!)* MS.
 he] *they* MS.
 237. *wexe bla]* *be gan to blowe* MS.
 240. *sle* MS.
 244. *whalle]* with paler ink corrected from *whyle*.
 245. *syghyng]* with paler ink corrected from *syngyng*.

ENT WANTS TO ENTER THE GIANT’S CASTLE.

(24)

‘Dere god,’ seyð Torrant than’,
 ‘Yff ther be anny crystyn’ man’
 In thys hold of ston’, 255
 That wolþ, for the love of god of myght,
 Harbourrow a jentylman’ thys nyght,
 For I ame but on!’
 ‘Seynt Marry,’ seyð that lady clere,
 ‘What crystyn’ man’ axithe harburrow here?’ 260
 Nere hym sche gothe a-non.
 ‘I wold harburrow the full fayne,
 But a gyant wylþ the slayne.’
 To hym sche mad here mone.

Torrent asks for a
 night’s lodging in the
 Castle.

259. *clere]* *e* corrected out of *r* MS.
 261. *sche gothe anon]* *a non sche gothe* MS.

(25)

'Say me now, fayer' lady, *belyve*, 265
 Who owte *of* thys plase schalt *me dryve*,
 Thes tourres, that are so bryght?'
 Ther sche Seyd: 'Be hevyn' kyng',
 Here ys a gyant Dwellyng,
 That meche ys of myght. 270
 Be my trowthe, and he the see,
 Were ther' XX lyvys in' the,
 Thy dethe than wylt he dyght.
 Iesu cryst yef me *grace*
 To hyd the in' some preve plase 275
 Owt of the fyndes syght!

f. 80b.

The Lady says

the Giant will kill him.

265. *bel.*] om. MS.

266. *of*] om. MS.

me dryve] *hyght* MS.

267. *so*] *feyer and* add. MS.

271. *the*] *thow*, w erased and *e* changed into *o*, MS.

273. *They* (!) MS.

275. *hyd*] corrected from *hyde*.

(26)

'Euyr' me thynkythe be thy tale,
 The song of the burdes smale
 On slepe hathe hyme browght.'
 'Ye,' seyde Torrent, 'ore he be wakyn', 280
 I schalt the tell soche a tokyn',
 Of hym thow haue no thowght!
 But wolddes thow for thy gentry
 Do the lyonnys downe lye,
 That they nyee me nowght?' 285
 By the hande sche ganne hym ta
 And led hyme in' betwe them twa;
 Ryght ase sche wold, they wrowght.

The Lady takes Torrent
past the Lions, into the
Castle.

277. *thy*] *my* erased and *thy* written above the line.

283. *thy*] *th* corrected from *m*.

gentry] *gentre*, *e* corrected from *y*.

285. *nyee*] first *e* above the line.

286. *hande*] *d* corrected from *e*.
tane MS.
287. *bewte* MS.
twayne MS.

ENT IS TAKEN INTO THE GIANT'S CASTLE.

(27)

The lady wase neuyr^o so a-drad,
In to the hale sche hym lad, 290
That lemyred ase gold bryght;
Sche byrlyd whyt wyne and Rede:
'Make vse myrre a-geyne owre Dedd,
I wot will, yt ys so dyght!'
'Be my trowthe!' seyde Torrent, 295
'I wole be thy warrant,
He comythe not here thys nyght.
On soche a slepe he ys browght,
All men of lyve wakythe hym nowght,
But onely godes *myght*.' 300

300. *godes myght*] *gode a lone* MS.

f. 81a.

He tells her he has kild
the Giant.

(28)

Blythe then wase that lady jent,
For to on-harnes Torrent,
That dowghtty wase and bold;
'For sothe,' sche seyde, 'I wot wher ys
The kynges sone *Verdownys*, 305
Fast put in hold
In a dongon^o, that ys dym;
Fowyre good Erylles sonnys be *with* hyme
Ys fet in^o fere and fold.
The gyant wan theme in^o a tyde, 310
Ase they Rane be the watyr syd,
And put them in^o preson^o cold.

She tells him of Prince
Verdownys,

and 4 Earls' sons in the
Giant's prison.

ENT FREES A PRINCE AND 4 EARLS' SONS.

(29)

'In an yron' cage he hathe them done.'

Torrent went thether' sone:

'Are ye yet levand?' 315

The kynges sone askyd than',

Yf ther were anny crysten man',

'Wold bryng vse owt of bond?'

'Lord,' he seyde, 'god allmyght,

I had levyr on a Day to fyght, 320

Than all my fathyrys lond.'

With an ilyn' mall-styff and strong'

He brake vpe an yron' dore or longe,

And sone the keyes he fond.

f. 81b.

Torrent breaks open the
prison,

318. *owt*] *ow* (!) MS.

323. *or longe*] added in paler ink.

(30)

Owt he toke thys chyldyryn' fyve, 325

The feyrest that were on lyve,

I-hold in' anny sted.

The lady wase full-gled,

Sche byrlyd whyt wyn' and Redd,

And sethyn' to soper sone they yed. 330

'Lordes,' he seyde, 'syn yow are her',

I Red yow make Ryght good cher',

For now ys all thy nede.'

Thus he covyrd owt of care.

God, that sofryd wonddes sare, 335

Grante vse well-to sped!

and frees the 5 youths.

They sup.

325. *chylde*.] a v struck out, follows.

328. *glad* MS.

335. *sore* MS.

336. *welle to sped*] *to sped welle* MS.

ALL CHOOSE THEIR HORSES TO RIDE AWAY.

(31)

Lorddes, and ye wol lythe,
The chyldyr namys I wol telt blythe,
Here kyn, how they were me told;
The kynges sone, that dowghtty ys, 340
Wase clepyd Verdownys,
That dowghtty wase and bold,
And an Erylles son, that hyght Torren',
A nother Iakys of Berweyne,
The forthe was Amyas bold. 345
The kynges dowghttyr of Gales lond,
Elyoner', I vndyrstond,
That worthy wase in hold,

Torrent freed Prince
Verdownys, Lords

Torren, Jakys, and
Amyas,

f. 82a.

and Princess Eleanor.

337. after *wol*, *be* struck out MS.

340. *ys*] *wase* MS.

346-348 put before 343-345, MS.

(32)

In to hys chambyr sche hyme led,
Ther gold and syluyr wase spred, 350
And asur', that wase blo;
In yron ther he gan stond,
Body and armys *al schynand*,
In' powynt to trusse and goo.
In to a stabyl sche hym led, 355
Eche toke a full feyer' sted,
They were *redy* to goo;
And wote ye wel and vndyrstond,
Had the gyant be levand,
They had not partyd soo. 360

She takes Torrent to his
chamber,

and then all of them to
the stable, where each
chooses a horse.

351. *blo*] *blewe* MS.
 353. *al sch.*] *lygand* (!) MS.
 354. *trusse*] corrected from *truste*.
 357. *redy*] om. MS.
 358. *wote*] with paler ink corrected from *what*.
 359. *Had*] corrected out of *han*.
 byn follows, almost entirely erased.
 gyant] *t* corrected from *d*.

(33)

They wolȝ not to bed gange,
 Tyll on the morrow the Day spronge,
 Thus a wey to ffare.
 Torrant sperryd the gattys, i-wyse,
 All that he lyst he clepyd hys, 365
 The keys and thyng he bare.
 The lyons *that was* at the dore
 Wase led to her^o mayster that wase befor^o,
 On hym thay fed them yare,
 Vpp won of the horse, that wase ther^o levyd, 370
 On hym thei trussyd the gyanttes heved.
 Thus helpt hym god thar^o.

Torrent feeds the lions
 on the Giant's body,

and puts his head on a
 horse.

361. *gange*] *gan* MS.
 lle on the struck out, follows.
 366. *keys*] *e* written with paler ink above the line.
 367. *lyons that was*] *lyone* MS.
 369. *Vn* (!) MS.
 hym] *y* corrected out of *e* MS.
 thay] corrected from *that*.
 yare] *ther* MS.
 371. *Vn* (!) MS.
 thei] *i* written above the line.
 hed MS.
 372. *ther* MS.

ENT RETURNS TO PORTUGAL.

(34)

But ore III wekes wer^o commyn^o to End,

To Portynggall̃ gan he wend,
 Ther^ʳ ase the kyng gan *lend*; 375
 The porter^ʳ sawe *hym* ther he stood,
 He fled a wey, ase he were wod,
 Flyngyng ase a fynd.
 ‘Syr kyng,’ he seyde, ‘be goddes dede,
 Torrant bryngythe a devyl̃ys hed, 380
 Ther *with* he wol̃yow present.’
 Desonell̃seyd: ‘Porter^ʳ, be styl̃!’ . . .
 In hys walke ther ase he went.

He goes back to
 Portugal.

f. 82b.

373. *were*] *ther*, struck out, and *were* written over.

375. *lend*] *lye* MS.

376. *sawe h. th.*] *ther sawe he* MS.

(35)

The kyng to the gatys gan pase,
 Gret lordes that ther wase, 385
 Bothe knyghtes and squyerre,
 Lordes wase full̃sore a-dred
 Fore the lyonys, þat he had,
 They durst not come hyme ner^ʳ.
 The kyng seyde: ‘I wyl̃*the* kysse, 390
 Durst I for^ʳ thy bestes, Iwysse.’
 Torrant dyd them ly ther^ʳ,
 And kyssyd the kyng *with* joy and blyse;
 And aftyr, other lordes of hys,
 And aftyr, ladys *clere*. 395

The King and his Lords
 are afraid of the lions.

Torrent kisses the King
 of Portugal.

386. *squyerres* MS.

390. *the*] *hym* MS.

395. *aftyr*] *other* add. (!) MS.

clere] *jent* MS.

OWNYS’S FATHER IS TOLD OF HIS SAFETY.

(36)

Messengyres *went* the weye,
 To the kyng of Provyns to sey,
 Hys sone ys owt of hold:
 ‘Yyng Torrent of Portynggall
 Hathe browght hym owt of balle 400
 And slayne the jeyant bold.’
 Lytyll and mykyl þat ther wer’,
 All they mad good cher
 Her’ prynse fayne se wold.
 The kyng *seyd*: ‘So mot I the, 405
 I woll geff the towynnys thre
 For’ the talles thow hast me told.’

The King of Provyns is
glad

f. 83a.

of his son Verdownys’s
safety

396. *went*] *to* (!) MS.
 397. after *Provyns* I MS.
 399. *Yoyng* MS.
 405. *kyng seyð*] *kynges messengere* MS.
 405-7 put before 402-4.

(37)

Than *seyd* they, that to Gales yede,
 Yeftys to *take* were hem no ned,
 Then Verdownys had they. 410
 Ase they seylyd on a tyde,
 At Perrown’ on the see syd

 The kyng of Provynse *seyd*: ‘So mot I the,
 Yftles schall they not be, 415
 That dare I sothely sey.’
 The kyng of Gales proferd hym feyer’:
 ‘Wed my dowghttyr and myn Eyer’,
 When so euyr’ thow may!

and promises Torrent
gifts.

The King of Gales
offers Torrent his
daughter.

408. *Than—that*] *That they than* MS.
Gales] with paler ink corrected from *Calles*.
yede] corrected from *went*.
 409. *take*] om. MS.
hym MS.
 410. *Then Downys* MS.

417. *gales*] *g* with paler ink corrected from *c*.

ENT GETS WELAND'S SWORD ADOLAKE.

(38)

The kyng of Pervense seyð: 'So mot I the, 420
Thys seson' yeftles schalt thou not be,
 Haue here my Ryng of gold,
My sword, that so wyll'ys wrowyt;
A better than' yt know I nowght
 With in' crystyn' mold; 425
Yt ys ase glemyrryng ase the glase,
Thorrow Velond wrought yt wase,
 Bettyr ys non' to hold.
I have syne sum tyme in' lond,
Whoso had yt of myn' hond, 430
 Fawe they *were* I-told.'

The King of Provyns
gives Torrent his Sword

made by Weland,

429. *Loke thou hold yt with fulle hond*, add. MS.

431. *I fawght therfore I told* MS.

(39)

Tho wase Torrent blythe and glad,
The good swerd ther he had,
 The name wase Adolake.
A gret maynerey let he make *ryght* 435
That lest all a fortnyght,
 Who so wil'thys met take.
Euyry man toke ys leve, ase *I* yow say,
Hom-ward to wend ther wey,
 Euery man ys Rest to take. 440
Tyl't yt be-fel't vppon a day,
Ase they went be the wey,
 The kyng to hys dowghttyr spake:

and named Adolake.

A fortnight's Feast is
held.

f. 83b.

435. *mayn.*] *mayne let*, with paler ink corrected into *mayney*.
ryght] om. MS.

438. I] om. MS.

440. *to take ys Rest* MS.

NELL GIVES TORRENT A WHITE CHARGER.

(40)

‘Ye schall take hed of a jeentyll man’,
A feyer poynt for yow he wane, 445

Desonell, at the last.’

‘Syr,’ sche seyd, ‘be hevyn kyng,
Tyll ye me told, I knewe no thyng,

For who ys love yt wase.’

‘Desonell, so mvt I the, 450

Yt wase for the lowe of the,

That he trovyllid so fast.

I warne yow, dowghttyr, be the Rode,

Yt ys for yow bothe good,

Ther to I Red yow trast.’ 455

455. *trust* MS.

The King of Portugal
tells Desonell

that Torrent kild the
Giant for love of her.

(41)

Forthe sche browght a whyt sted,

As whyt as the flowyr in med,

Ys fytte blac ase slon.

‘Leman’, haue here thys fole,

That dethe ys dynt schalt pou not *thole*, 460

Whyllthow settyste hyme appon’,

And yf thow had *persewyd* be

And hadyst ned fore to fle,

Fast for to gone.

The kyng of Nazareth sent hym me, 465

Torrent, I wet-saffe hym on the,

For better love may I none.’

458. *slo* MS.

460. *thole*] *haue* MS.

She gives Torrent a
white steed

which the King of
Nazareth had sent her.

f. 84a.

461. *settythe* MS.

462. *p'revyd* (!) MS.

465. So *Fragm. I* ([F.I](#)); *The kyng of Portynggalle seyde*: 'So mot I the MS.

466. *hym on*] so [F.I](#); *of* MS.

(42)

Aftyr-ward vppon a tyd,
Ase the went be the watyres syd,
The kyng and yong Torrent, 470
The kyng wold fayne, that he ded wer',
And he wyst, in' what maner',
How he schuld be schent;
A false lettyr mad the kyng
And dyd messengyres forthe yt bryng, 475
On the Rever', ase they went,
To Torrent, that was trew ase styl',
Yf he love Desonell-wyl',
Get her a facon' jent.

The King

treacherously

asks Torrent to get
Desonell a Falcon

471. *ded were*] so [F.I](#); *were ded* MS.

472. *he*] so [F.I](#); *hym* MS.

477. *that was*] so [F.I](#); *om.* MS.

ALSO KING OF PORTUGAL DECEIVES TORRENT.

(43)

Torrent the letter be-gan' to Red, 480
The kyng lestyned & nere yed,
Ase he yt nevyr ad sene.
'Syr,' he seyde, 'what may thys be,
Loo, lord, come ner' and see,
A-bowght a facon' schene? 485
I ne wot, so god me sped,
In what lond that they bred.'
The kyng answerd: 'I wene,
In the forrest of Mavdeleyn',
Ther be hawkes, ase I herd seyne, 490

from the Forest of
Magdalen.

That byn of lenage clen’.

482. *syne* MS.

487. *that*] so [F. I](#); om. MS.

they] *ne* add. (!) MS.

489. *Mavd.*] so [F. I](#); *Mavdlen* MS.

491. *clen*] *gene* MS.

(44)

And than seyde the kyng on-trew:
‘Yf thou get hawkys of gret valew,
Bryng on of them to me!’

Torrent Seyde: ‘So god me saue, 495

f. 84b.

Yf yt be-tyde, that I may haue,

He agrees to do it.

At yowr wyll they schal be.’

Hys squyere bode he thar’,

Aftyr hys armor’ for to far’,

In the fyld byddythe he. 500

They armyd hym in’ hys wed,

Torrent rides

Tho he be-strode a noble sted,

And forthe than Rod hee.

498. *squyere*] so [F. II](#); *squyeres* MS.

there MS.

ENT FINDS A DRAGON IN THE FOREST.

(45)

Torrent toke the wey a-geyn’

In to the forest of Mawdleyne’, 505

to the Forest of
Magdalen,

In the wyld-some way;

Berys and apes there founde he,

And wylde bestys great plente,

And lyons where they lay.

In a wod that wase tyght, 510

Yt Drew nere-hand nyght

By dymmynge of the Day,

Harkyn, lordes, *to* them came wo,
He and hys squyer^o partyd in two,
Carfull men then were they. 515

gets separated from his
Squire,

502. *noble*] so [F. II](#); *nothere* MS.

507-509: so [F. II](#):

*Berrys he sawe stondyng
And wyld bestes ther goyng,
Gret lyonys ther he fond.* MS.

510. *tyght*] so [F. II](#); *thyke* MS.

512. *By d.*] so [F. II](#); *And ine the Dawnyng* MS.

513. *to—wo*] so [F. II](#);

to] of [F. II](#).

what I schalle sey MS.

514. *in two*] so [F. II](#); *they* MS.

515. *men—they*] so [F. II](#); *they were that Day* MS.

(46)

At the schedyng of a Rome
Eche partyd other frome,
For sothe, ase I vndyrstond.
Torrent toke a dulful wey
Downe in^o a depe valey 520
Be-syd a well strong.
A lytyl be fore mydnyght
Of a dragon he had syght,
That grysly wase to *fond*;
He had hym nowght to were, 525
But hys schyld and hys spere,
That wase in^o hys squyeres hond.

and comes on a Dragon

f. 85a.

524. *fond*] *syght* MS.

GON ATTACKS TORRENT.

(47)

Torrent knelyd on hys kne,
To Iesu Cryst prayd he:

Torrent prays to Christ

‘Lord, mykylt of myght, 530
Syne I wase in’ meche care,
Let me nevuyr’ owt of thys world far’,
Tylt I haue take *order* of knyght.
Ase I ame falsely hether’ sent,
Wyld-som weyes haue I went, 535
With fyndes for to fyght.
Now, Iesu, for thy holy name,
Ase I ame but man’ a-lone,
Than’ be my helpe to nyght!’

to be his help.

532. *thys*] *hys* (!) MS.

533. *haue*] *or add.* (!) MS.

order] *othere* (!) MS.

[\(48\)](#)

Ase Torrent Iesu gan’ pray, 540
He herd the dragon’, ther he lay
Vndyr-nethe a clow;
Of and on he wase stronge,
Hys tayle wase VII yerdes long,
That aftyr hyme he drowe; 545
Hys wyngges wase long and wyght,
To the chyld he toke a flyght
With an howge swowe;
Had he nether’ schyld ne spere,
But prayd to god, he schold hyme were, 550
For he wase in dred i-nowe.

The Dragon’s tail is 7
yards long,

542. *clow*] *colod* or *colvd*, *l* corrected from *d*, MS.

543. *and*] *an* MS.

545. *drowe* MS.

548. *swowe*] *swayne* (!) MS.

551. *inowthe* MS.

[\(49\)](#)

On the tayle an hed ther’ wase,
That byrnyd Bryght as anny glase,

and has a fiery head on
it.

In fyer whan yt was dyght;
 A-bowght the schyld he lappyd yt ther', 555
 Torrent the bowght a-sondyr schere
 Thurrow the *grace* of god almyght.
 As the boke of Rome tellys,
 Of hys taylle he cut IIII elles
 With hys swerd so bryght. 560
 Than cryed the lothely thyng,
 That all the dalȝbe-gan to Ryng,
 That hard the gyant wyght.

f. 85b.

Torrent cuts 4 ells off
 the Dragon's tail;

554. *yt]* *he* MS.

558. *Tellys]* *tellythe* MS.

563. *That the gyant hard wyght* MS.

ENT KILLS THE DRAGON.

(50)

The gyant seyde: 'I vndyrstond,
 There ys sum crystyn' man' nere hond, 565
 My dragon here I cry.
 By hym, that schope bothe watyr' and lond,
 All that I can se be-fore me stond,
 Dere schalȝthey a-bye!
 Me thynkythe, I here my dragon' schowt, 570
 I deme, ther be svme dowghtty man' hym a-bowght,
 I trow, to long I ly.
 Yf I dwellȝin my pylȝof ston',
 And my cheff-foster were gone,
 A false mayster were I!' 575

and while its Giant-
 owner is getting ready
 to help it,

574. *foster]* *st* corr. out of *t*.

(51)

Be the gyant wase Redy dyght,
 Torrent had slayne the dragon' Ryght;

Torrent kills it.

Thus gan god hyme scheld.
 To the mownteyne he toke the wey
 To Rest hyme, all that day, 580
 He had myster, to be kyld.
 Tyll the day be-gan to spryng,
 Fowllys gan myrre to syng
 Bothe in' frethe and in feld.
 Leve we now of Torrent thore 585
 And speke we of thys squyer' more:
 Iesu hys sole fro hell shyld!

f. 87a. [T1](#)

Torrent's Squire

581. *kyllyd* MS.

585. *there* MS.

[T1](#). There is no f. 86 in the paging of the MS.

ENT'S SQUIRE IS MET BY A GIANT.

(52)

Hys squyer' Rod all nyght
 In a wod, that wase full tyght,
 With meche care and gret fare, 590
 For to seke hys lord Torrent,
 That wyghtly wase frome hyme sent,
 And he wyst nevyr' whethyr ne whar'.
 He Durst neuyr' cry ne schuot,
 For wyld bestes were hym a-bowght 595
 In' the holttes hare;
 A lytyl whyll be-fore the day
 He toke in' to a Ryde-wey
 Hyme self to meche care.

rides all night in a
 wood,

592. *wysly* MS.

593. *wher* MS.

595. *wyld] wyd* MS.

596. *hore* MS.

597. *lyty* MS.

(53)

Forthe he Rod, I vndyrstond, 600
 Tyll he an hey wey fond,
 *With-owtyn*⁹ any *Delite*,
 Also fast ase he myght fare,
 Fore berrys and apys, þat ther ware,
 Lest they wold hym byght. 605
 The sone a-Rose and schone bryght,
 Of a castyll he had a syght,
 That wase bothe feyer⁹ and whyte

till he finds a highway,

602. *Delite*] *delay* MS.

604. *were* MS.

(54)

The gyant him se, & ny yed,
 And seyde: ‘Fellow, so god me sped, 610
 Thow art welcom to me:
 What dost thow here in my forest?’
 ‘Lord, to seke an hawkys nest,
 Yff yt yowr wyl be.’
 ‘The be-hovythe to ley a wede.’ 615
 To an oke he hym led:
 Gret Ruthe yt wase to se.
 In IIII *quarteres* he hym drowe,
 And euery quarter vppon a bowe;
 Lord, soche weys toke hee! 620

and is met by a Giant.

f. 87b.

The Giant cuts Torrent’s
Squire into 4 quarters.

609. *hem* MS.

618. *drewe* MS.

ENT IS ATTACKT BY THE GIANT ROCHENSE.

(55)

Ase Torrent in⁹ the movnteyn⁹ dyd ly,
 Hym thowght, he hard a Reufull cry;
 Gret fere ther hyme thowght.

‘Seynt Marre,’ seyð the chyld so fre,
‘Wher euyr’ my jentyll-squyer’ myght be, 625
That I *with* me to wod browght?
On he dyd hys harnes a-geyne
And worthe on hys sted, serteyne,
And thetherward he sowght.
And wot yow wylþ; I vndyrstond, 630
In fowre quartyres he hym fownd,
For other wyse wase yt nowght.

Torrent finds these,

624. *fre*] *fer* MS.

630. *wot*] *w* add. (!) MS.

(56)

The gyant lenyd to a tre
And be-hyld Torrent so free,
For sothe, ase *I* yow seye. 635
Thys fend wase ferly to fyght,
Rochense, seythe the boke, he hyght,
Ther wase a dredfull-fraye.
To the chyld than’ gan he smyght:
‘A theff, yeld the asttyt, 640
As fast as thow may!’
‘What,’ seyð Torrent, ‘art thow wood?
God, that Dyed on the Rood,
Geff the evyll-happe thys day!’

and is attackt by this
giant Rochense.

f. 88a.

635. *I*] om. MS.

ENT FIGHTS THE GIANT ROCHENSE.

(57)

He Rawght Torrent soche a Rowght, 645
Hys steddes brayne he smot owte,
So mykylþ he be-gan’.
Torrent tho a good sped

Torrent’s steed is kild.

Ase fast a-bowte an eche *yede*;
Ase swefte ase he myght, *he Ran*. 650
He gathyred svm of hys gere,
Bothe hys schyld and hys spere;
Nere hym yod he than'.
Bacward than be a brow3
Twenty fote he gard hyme goo, 655
Thus erthe on hym he wane.

He drives the Giant
back

649. *yede*] *went* MS.
650. *he Ran*] *Ryne* MS.

(58)

Yt solasyd Torrant then',
When he sawe hyme bacward ren
Downe be a movnteyn' of Perowne,
Stomlyng thurrow frythe and fen', 660
Tyll he com to a depe *glen*,
Ther myght non hym stere.
Torrent wase glad and folowyd fast,
And hys spere on hyme he brast,
Good Adyloke yed hyme nere. 665
The fynd in' the watyr stod,
He fawte a-geyn, ase he were wod,
Alþe day in' fere.

into a deep glen,

where he stands in
water.

657. *than* MS.
658. *ren*] *Rond* (!) MS.
661. *glen*] *thorne* MS.
662. *stere*] *schere* MS.
668. *þe*] *the* add. (!) MS.

(59)

Tho nere hond wase the day gone,
Torrent wase so werry than' 670
That on hys kne he kneld:
'Helpe, god, that all may!

f. 88b.

Torrent prays God for
help.

Desonellȝ haue good day!’
Fro hym he cest hys schyld.
Iesu wold not, he were slayne, 675
To hym he sent a schowyr^o of Rayne,
Torrent fullȝ wylȝyt keld.
The fynd saw, he wase ny mate,
Owt of the watyr he toke the gate,
He thowght to wyne the fyld. 680

671. *knelyd he* MS.

677. *kelyd* MS.

Jesus freshens up
Torrent.

ENT SLAYS THE GIANT ROCHENSE.

[\(60\)](#)

Thoo wase Torrent ffresse and good;
Nere the fynd sore he stod,
Cryst hym saue and see!
The fynd fawt *with* an yron^o staff,
The fyrst stroke, to hym he gaffe, 685
He brast hys schyld on thre.
Torrent vndyr hys staff Rane,
To the hart he baryd hym than^o,
And lothely cry gane he.
To the grownd he feltȝ ase tyght, 690
And Torrent gan hys hed of-smyght,
And thus he wynnythe the gre.

690. *gownd* MS.

The Giant attacks again

Torrent runs him thro’
the heart,

cuts his head off,

[\(61\)](#)

Torrent knelyd on the grownd
And thankyd god þat ylke stownd,
That soche *grace* hyme send. 695
Thus II journeyes in thys woo
With hys handes slow *he* gyantys too,

That meny a man' hathe schent.
Torrent forthe frome hyme þan yod,
And met hyme XXIII fotte, 700
Ther he lay on the bent.
Hedles he left hym there,
Howt of the fyld the hed he bare
And to the castell he went.]

697. *he*] II MS.

f. 89a.

finds him 24 ft.

long, and goes to his
Castle.

WORD AND STEED OF GIANT ROCHENSE.

(62)

To thys castell he gan far'; 705
Ther fond he armor' and other' gare,
A swerd, that wase bryght.
To the towre he toke the wey,
Ther the gyantes bed lay,
That Rychyly wase dyght. 710
At the beddes hed he fond
A swerd, worthe an Erllys lond,
That meche wase of myght.
On the pomell yt wase wret,
Fro a prynce yt wase get, 715
Mownpolyardnus he hyght.

706. *gere* MS.

Torrent goes to the
Giant's

Castle, and finds a
splendid sword,

(63)

The sarten *to sey with*-owt lese,
A scheff-chambyr' he hym ches,
Tyll on the morrow day.
To the stabull tho he yed, 720
There he fond a nobyll sted,
Wase comely whyt and grey.
The gyanttes hed gan he take,

and a noble white steed.

And the dragonnys wold he not forsake,
 And went forthe on hys wey. 725
 He left mor^o good in that sale
 Than wase *with* in^o all Portynggall,
 Ther ase the gyant laye.

With the heads of the
 Giant and Dragon,
 Torrent

f. 89b.

717. *to sey*] om. MS.
 718. *he*] *sche* MS.
chesys (!) MS.
 720. *yod* MS.

(64)

Tho he Rod bothe Day and nyght,
 Tyll he come to a castell bryght, 730
 Ther ys lord gan dwell.
 The kyng ys gone to the gate,
 Torrent on kne he fond ther at,
 Schort talk for to tell.
 ‘Haue thow thys in^o thyn^o hond: 735
 No nother hawkys ther I fond
 At Mawdlenys well.’
 The kyng *quod*: ‘Ase so haue I blyse,
 Torrent, I trow, sybbe ys
 To the dewell of hell! 740

rides back to Portugal.

Torrent gives the King
 the Giant’s and
 Dragon’s heads instead
 of a Falcon,

738. *quod*] om. (!) MS.
 739. *sybbe*] *sylke* MS.

ENT IS LOVED BY DESONELL.

(65)

‘Here be syd dwellythe won on lond,
 Ther ys no knyght, *hys* dynt may stond,
 So stronge he ys *in dede*!’
 ‘Syr,’ he sayd, ‘fore sen Iame,
 What ys the gyantes name, 745
 So Euyr good me sped?’

‘Syr’, he seyð, ‘so mvt I the,
Slogus of Fuolles, thus hyte hee,
That wyt ys vndyr wede.’

and says the Giant
Rochense was Slogus o
Fuolles.

742. *knyght hys*] *knyghtes* MS.

743. *in d.*] *on grond* MS.

(66)

Lytylþ and mykylþ, lese and more, 750
Wondyr on the heddes thore,
That Torrent had browght whome.

The Lordes seyð ‘Be sen Myhellþ!
Syr kyng, but ye love hyme wylþ,
To yow yt ys gret schame!’ 755

Torent ordeynyd prystes fyve,
To syng for hys squyerys lyve,
And menythe hym by name.

f. 90a.

Therfor^þ the lady whyt ase swane
To Tarrant, here lord, sche went than^þ, 760
Here hert wase to hyme tane.

Desonell gives her hear
to Tarrant.

752. *browght*] *ho* add. (!) MS.

753. *The*] om. MS.

seyd] *he* add. MS.

Myhelle] *my her, r* corrected to *lle* with paler ink.

756. *prystes*] *V* add. (!) MS.

ANCE OF ARAGON WANTS TO WED DESONELL.

(67)

Lettyrres come ther *withalle*
To the kyng of Portynggallþ,
To ax hys dowghttyr Derre,
Fro the kyng of Eragon^þ, 765
To wed her^þ to hys yongeest son^þ,
The lady, that ys so clere.
For Tarrant schuld not her^þ haue,

The King of Aragon
asks for Desonell for hi
youngest Son.

For hyme fyrst he here gafe,
To the messenger⁷, 770
And hys way fast ageyn dyd pase,
Whyle Torrent an huntyng wase,
Ther of schuld he not be were.

762. *ther withalle]* *hetherward* MS.

769. *For]* *To* MS.

771. *way]* *om.* MS.

773. *ware* MS.

(68)

On a mornynge, ther ase he lay,
The kyng to the quene gan sey: 775
‘Madame, for cheryte,
Thow art oftyn⁸ hold wyse;
Now wolte ye tel me yowr deuyce,
How I may governe me:
The Ryche kyng hathe to me sent, 780
For to aske my dowghttyr gente
That ys so feyer⁹ and fre.’
‘Syr,’ sche Seyd, ‘so god me saue,
I Red yow let Torent her haue,
For best worthy ys he.’ 785

The Queen of Portugal
wishes

Torrent to have her.

f. 90b.

775. *The (quene to the) kyng to the quene gan sey* MS.

779. *That how* MS.

781. *aske]* *aseke* MS.

(69)

He sayd: ‘Madame, were that feyer¹⁰,
To make an erlles sone myn Eyer’?
I wilte not, by sen Iame!
There he hathe done maystres thre,
Yt ys hys swerd, yt ys not he, 790
For Hatheloke ys ys name.’
‘Lord, he myght fullte wyte sped,

The King refuses.

A knyghtes dowghttyr wase hyme bed,
Ase whyt ase walles bane;
And yf ye warne hyme Desonell, 795
All that ther of here tell;
Ther of wyll-speke schame.'

790. *hys*] om. MS.

794. *swalles* (!) MS.

bone MS.

796. *All*] *And* MS.

ING OF PORTUGAL'S TREACHERY TO TORRENT.

(70)

'Madam, vnto thys tyd
There lythe a gyant here be-syd,
That many a man' hathe slayne. 800
I schall-hyght hym my dowghttyr' dere,
To fyght *with* that fyndes fere,
Thus he holdythe hyme in' trayne.
But I schall-make myn *commnant* so,
That there schall-non *with* hyme go, 805
Neyther squyer' ne swayne.'
'Syr', 'sche seyd, 'so mvt I the,
So sore be-stad hathe he be,
And wyll-commyn' a-geyne!'

806. *Neyther*] om. MS.

The false King of
Portugal

plots to have Torrent
kild by another Giant.

(71)

Tho the belles be-gan to Ryng, 810
Vpe Rose that Ryche kyng,
And the lady *so fre*,
And aftyr-ward they went to mase,
Ase the law of holy chyrge wase,
With notes and solemnyte. 815
Trompettys on the wall-gan blowe,

f. 91a.

He and his Queen go to
Mass.

Knyghtes semlyd on a Rowe,
 Gret joy wase to see.
 Torrent a syd bord began',
 The squyeres nexte hym than, 820
 That good knyghtes schuld be.

Torrent sits at the head
 of a side table.

812. *so fre]* in *feree* MS.

815. *nettes* (!) MS.

ENT AGREES TO FIGHT FOR DESONELL.

(72)

Ase they sat a-myddes the mete,
 The kyng wold not foreget;
 To Torrent the kyng gan sey,
 He seyde: 'Torrent, so god me saue, 825
 Thow woldes fayne my dowghttyr haue
 And hast lovyd her' many a day.'
 'Ye, be trouthe,' seyde Torrent than',
 'And yf þat I were a Ryche man',
 Ryght gladly, *par* ma fay!' 830
 'Yf thow durst for her sake
 A poynt of armys vndyrtake,
 Thow broke her' well fore ay!'

The King asks Torrent i
 he'll

do a deed of arms for
 Desonell.

822. *a]* so [F. III](#); *the* MS.

825. *saue]* so [F. III](#); *sped* MS.

830. *gladly]* so [F. III](#); *glad* MS.

831. *for h. s.]* so [F. III](#); *par ma fay* MS.

833. *broke]* so [F. III](#); *breke* MS.

[\(73\)](#)

'Ye,' seyde Torrent, 'ar I ga,
 Sekyrnes ye schall me ma 835
 Of yowr dowghttyr hend,
 And afterward my ryghtys,
 Be-fore XXVII knyghtes.'

'Yes,' says Torrent.

And all were Torrentes frende.
 ‘Now, good seris,’ gan Torrant sey, 840 f. 91b.
 ‘Bere wittnes her of som Daye,
 A-geyne yf god me send!’

834. *go* [F. III](#); *gan Rage* MS.

835. *make* MS.

839. *frenddes* MS.

(74)

Torrent seyde: ‘So mvt I the
 Wyst I, where my jorney schold *be*,
 Thether I wolde me dyght.’ 845
 The kyng gaff hyme an answer:
 ‘In the lond of Calabur ther’ ‘Then go to Calabria,
 Wonnythe a gyant wyhte,
 And he ys bothe strong and bold,
 Slochys he hyght, I the told, 850
 God send the that waye Ryght!’ and fight the Giant
 Than quod Torrent: ‘Haue good day, Slochys.’
 And, or I come a-geyn’, I schall asay,
 Whether the fynd can fyght.’

844. *be*] om. MS.

845. *wolde*] so [F. III](#); om. MS.

848. *wyhte*] so [F. III](#); *whyte* MS.

851. *that w.*] so [F. III](#); *ways* MS.

852. *good*] *goo* MS.

853. Space left here for an initial letter of the largest size in MS.

ENT STARTS TO FIGHT THE GIANT SLOCHYS.

(75)

Tho wold he no lenger’ a-byde, 855
 He toke ys wey for to Ryde
 On a sted of gret valewe.
 In to a chambyr’ he gas,
 Hys leue of Desonell’ he tas,

Sche wepte, alȝ men myght Rewe; 860
He seyde: ‘Lady, be stylȝ!
I schall come a-geyn the tylȝ,
Thurrow helpe of Marry trewe.’
Thus he worthe on a stede.
In hys wey Cryst hyme sped, 865
Fore he yt no thyng knewe!

856. *Ryde*] *ryght* MS.

858. *gas*] *gothe* MS.

859. *tas*] *toke* MS.

862. *the*] *than* MS.

(76)

He toke hym a Redy wey,
Thurrow Pervyns he toke the wey,
As hys Iorney felȝ.
Tylȝ the castellȝ Be the See, 870
An hy stret heldy the hee,
Ther the kyng *dyd* dwelle.
To the porter he gan seye:
‘Wynd inȝ, fellow, I the pray,
And thy lord than telȝ, 875
Pray hym, on won nyght inȝ hys sale
To harburrow Torrent of Portynggallȝ,
Yf yt Bee ys willȝ!’

868. *pvys* MS.

871. *And* MS.

872. *dyd dw.*] *dwellyd* MS.

875. *tyll* MS.

878. *Yf ys wille to Bee* MS.

[T2](#). There are two folios 91 in the MS.

Torrent takes leave of
Desonell,

starts,

f. 91a. [T2](#)

and rides to the Castle
of the King of Provyns.

ENT A GUEST OF THE KING OF PROVYNS.

(77)

The porterȝ Dyde hys commandment,

To the kyng he ys wente 880
And knelyd vppon' ys kne:
'God blyse þe, lord, In thy sale!
Torrent of Portynggale
Thus sendythe me to the;
He praythe yow, yf ye myght, 885
To harburrow hym thys won' nyght,
Yf yowr will yt bee.'
The kyng swere be hym, þat dyed on tre:
'There ys no man' in' crystyante
More welcome to me!' 890

The King of Provyns

welcomes Torrent, and

(78)

The kyng a-Rose and to the gat yod,
Lordes and other' knyghtes good,
That were glad of hys commyng.
In to the hale he hyme browght,
Ryche met spare they nowght, 895
Be-fore Torrent fore to bryng.
'Syr,' sayd the kyng, 'I pray the,
Where be thy men off armys free,
That *with* the schuld *leng*?'
'Syr, to a lord I mvst Ryde, 900
My squyer hongythe be my syde,
No man schall *with* me wend.'

feeds him.

f. 91b.

Torrent's sword is his
only Squire.

892. *knyges* MS.

899. *leng*] *wynd* MS.

(79)

'Syr,' seyde the kyng, 'I pray the,
Where schall thy ded of armys bee,
Yf yt be thy wyll?' 905
'Syr,' he seyde, 'vttirly,
At Calabur, sekyrly,
I ame all Redy ther tyl'

Torrent says he has to
fight in Calabria.

With a squyer, þat wilþ can Ryde;
 Fast be the see Sydde 910
 Schuld we pley owur fyle;
 And wot ye wylþ and vndyrstond,
 Ther schall no knyght come nere hond
 Fore dred of denttes ylþ.'

ENT IS OFFERD A PRINCESS OF PROVYNS.

(80)

The kyng seyd: 'Be goddes ore, 915
 I Rede, þat þou come not thore,
 Fore why, I wylþ the seye:
 Meche folke of that contre
 Come hether⁹ for⁹ sokor⁹ of me,
 Bothe be nyght and day; 920
 There ys a gyant of gret Renowne,
 He dystrowythe bothe sete and towyn⁹
 And all þat euyr⁹ he may;
 And ase the boke of Rome dothe telþ;
 He wase get of the dewellþ of hellþ; 925
 As hys moder on slepe lay.'

The King of Provyns
 warns

him against the terrible
 Giant there,

915. *kynges* (!) MS.

916. *there* MS.

922. *sete*] second *e* corr. out of *a* MS.

(81)

The kyng Seyd: 'Be seynt Adryan',
 I Rede, a nother Jentyll mane
 Be there and haue the gre:
 I haue a dowghttyr, þat ys me dere, 930
 Thow schalt here wed to thy fere,
 And, yf yt thy wyll be,
 Two duchyes in londe
 I wille geve here in⁹ hande.'

f. 92a.

and offers him his
 Daughter and 2 Duchies
 instead.

‘Gramarcy, syr,’ sayd he, 935
‘With my tonge so haue I wrowght,
To breke my day than will I nowght,
Nedys me behovythe ther to bee.’

Torrent says he must
keep his troth.

929. *the*] so [F. IV](#); om. MS.

degre MS.

932. So [F. IV](#); om. (!) MS.

933. *londe*] *honde* [F. IV](#); om. MS.

935. *syr s. h.*] so [F. IV](#); *seyd he thane* MS.

ENT ARRIVES IN CALABRIA.

(82)

‘In goddes name,’ the kyng gane sayne,
‘Iesu send the will a-geyne, 940
Lord so mekylt of myghte!’
Menstrelles was them a-monge,
Trompettes, harpys, and myrre songe,
Delycyous nottis on hyght.
When tyme was, to bed they wente; 945
On the morrow Rose Torrente
And toke leve of kyng and knyght
And toke a Redy weyye,
Be a see syd as yt laye,
God send hym gattes Ryght! 950

He starts,

947. *of*] so [F. IV](#); *on* MS.

948. *toke*] so [F. IV](#); *to* MS.

[\(83\)](#)

A hye stret hathe he nome,
In to Calabur he ys come
With in^o to days ore III;
Soo come ther^o folkes hym a-geyne,
Fast folloyng *with* cart and wayne, 955
Fro-ward the sytte.

reaches Calabria,

‘Dere god!’ seyð Torrent nowē,
 ‘Leve folkes, what Eylllythe yow,
 Soo fast fore to flee?’
 ‘There ys a gyante here be-syde, 960
 In ale thys covntre fare and wyde
 No mane on lyve levythe hee.’

and hears of the Giant.

f. 92b.

951. *nome*] so [F.V](#); *none* MS.

952. *come*] so [F.V](#); *gone* MS.

958. *yow*] *nowe* add. (!) MS.

(84)

‘Dere god,’ sayð Torrant thane,
 ‘Where schall I fynd that lothly man?’
 Ther they answerd hym anone: 965
 ‘In a castyl be-syd the see,
 Slongus, soo hyght hee,
 Many a man had he slone.
 We wot will wher he doth ly:
 Be-fore the cyte of Hungry; 970
 He will not thens gone,
 Tyll he haue the Ryche kyng
 To hys presone for to bryngg,
 To be lord of hyme self a-lone.’

The Giant Slongus is in
Hungary;

964. *lothly*] so Hall.; *lovely* MS.

965. *anone*] so [F.V](#); *a geyne* MS.

968. *slone*] so [F.V](#); *slaylne* (!) MS.

969. *doth ly*] so [F.V](#); *ys* MS.

970. *cyte*] so [F.V](#); *knyghthod* MS.

Hungry] so [F.V](#); *Hongrys* MS.

971. *thens*] *thus* MS.

ENT FINDS THE GIANT SLONGUS IN HUNGARY.

(85)

Tho wold he no lenger a-byd, 975
 But to the sytte gan he Ryde,

As fast as he myght fare;
 Here barys felþ and broke downe,
 And the gattes of gret Renowne
 Stondyng⁹ allþ baree. 980
 Men of armys stond hyme a-geyne,
 Mo than fyfty had he slayne
 With gryme wounddes and sare.
 When Torrent of hym had a syght,
 Thowe Desonellþe neuyr⁹ so bryght, 985
 He will Reue hym hys chaffar⁹.

he has broken the City
gates,

and slain 50 men.

986. *hym*] *m* corr. out of *s*. MS.
chaffer MS.

(86)

Torrent in⁹ the storrope stod
 And prayd to god, þat dyed on Rode:
 ‘Lord, ase thow schalt ale wyld at wyle,
 Gyff me *grace* to wyn the fyld, 990
 That thys *lothly* fynd hym yeld
 A-non to me tylþ
 A man schallþ But onnys Dyee,
 I willþ fyght, whillþ I may Dryee.’
 He mad cher⁹ nobylþ. 995
 When he had Iesu prayd of *grace*,
 He wyscheyd hyme a battellþplase,
 Ther as hym lyst *welle*.

Torrent prays to Christ
for help.

f. 93a.

990. *wynd* (!) MS. *vndyr nethe spere and schyld* add. (!) MS.
 991. *lothly*] om. MS.
 995. *nobill chere* MS.
 998. *welle*] *were* MS.

ENT CHALLENGES THE GIANT SLONGUS.

(87)

Torrent hys spere a-say be-gane,

Bothe schyld and spere than¹, 1000
 That they were sekyl and good.
 Aftyr þat, *with* in a throwe,
 Hys good horne gane he blowe.
 The gyant sawe, wher¹ he stodde:
 Slonges of Flonthus staryd than¹; 1005
 Quod Torrent: ‘Yf thow be a gentyl¹ man¹
 Or come of gentyl¹ blod,
 Let thy beytyng and thy Ermyght be,
 And come prove thy strenghe on me,
 Therfor I sowght the, be the Rodde.’ 1010

Torrent blows his horn.

The Giant Slongus, of
 Flonthus,

1008. *Let be thy b. a. t. erm.* MS.

(88)

The gyant sayd: ‘Be the Roode,
 Dewell of hell send the fode,
 Hether to seche me:
 By the nose I schall the wryng,
 Thow berdles gadlyng¹, 1015
 That all hell schall thow see!’
 The wey than to hym he toke
 And on hys bake he bare a croke,
 Wase X fot long and thre;
 And thow he neuer so gret war¹, 1020
 Torrent thought not fare to fare,
 Tylt wone of them ded bee.

says he’ll wring
 Torrent’s nose.

His Crook is 13 ft. long

f. 93b.

1011. *sayd*] written above the line.

1017. *he*] so [F. VI](#); om. MS.

1018. *he*] *her* MS.

croke] so [F. VI](#); *creke* (!) MS.

1020. *were* MS.

ENT SLAYS THE GIANT SLONGUS OF FLONTHUS.

(89)

Thoo wold Torrent no lenger^o byd,
 Tyll the theff gan he Ryde,
 Ase fast ase euyr^o he may. 1025
 The theff had non ey but on^o,
 Soche sawe I neuer none,
 Neyther^o be nyght *nor* be day.
 Thurrow goddes helpe and sent Awsden^o
 The spere *throw ye and herne gan ren*. 1030
 God send hym the Ryght wey;
 Than the theff be-gane to Rore.
 All that in^o the sytte wore,
 Ouyr^o the wallys they laye.

Torrent charges,

pierces the Giant's eye,

1024. *the*] *f* add. (!) MS.
 1028. *Blyther* (!) MS.
 nor] so [E. VI](#); *and* MS.
 1030. *throw—ren*] *anon he toke to hym* MS.
 1033. *wore*] so [E. VI](#); *were* MS.

(90)

Thow the fyndes ey were owte, 1035
 Fast he leyd hym a-bowte
 All þat somyrres nyght;
 He set ys backe to an hyl;
 That Torrent schuld not come hym tyll;
 So meche þat theff covd of fyght. 1040
 He bled so sore, I vndyrstond,
 Hys croke fell owt of hys hond,
 Hys dethe to hyme ys dyght.
 Torrent to hyme Rane *with* a spere,
 Thurrow the body he gan hym bere, 1045
 Thus helpe hym god of myght.

then spears him thro' th
body,

1040. *þat*] *þ^e* add. MS.

(91)

All that in^o the sytte were,

Mad full nobill chere,
 That thys fynd wase Dedde.
 Forthe they Ran *with* stavys of tre, 1050
 Torrent seyde: 'So mvt I the,
 Kepe hole hys hed!
 Yf yt be broke, so god me sped,
 Yt ys wyll the worse to lede.'
 They dyd ase *he* hem bede, 1055
 Mo than thre hunderd on a throng
 Yt ys solas Euyr^a a-mong
 Whan that he was dede.

and kills him.

f. 94a.

Torrent preserves the
 Giant's head.

1047. *That alle* MS.

1054. *lede*] *Rede*, struck out and *lede* added in paler ink.

1055. *That seson they* MS.

he hem] *hyme* (!) MS.

bede] *bad* MS.

1057 *put before* 1056 *MS.*

ENT GOES TO THE CASTLE OF GIANT SLONGUS.

(92)

Than^a the kyng of Calaber ayen^a hym went,
 Torrent be the hond he hent, 1060
 To the hall he gan^a hym lede
 And comaundid squiers two,
 Of hys harnes for to do
 And cloth hym^a in another wede.
 Waytes on the wall gan blowe, 1065
 Knyghtis assembled on a Rowe,
 And sith to the deyse they yede;
 'Sir,' quod the kyng, 'of whens are ye?'
 'Of Portingale, sir,' said he,
 'I com heder, to sech my dede.' 1070

The King of Calabria

feasts him,

1062. *two*] *tho* MS.

1063. *hys*] *her* MS.

1070. *deth* MS.

(93)

Full curtesly the kyng gan say
To Torrent on the opure day:
‘Wyll ye wend with me
A litul here be-side to passe,
There as the Geauntes dwelling was 1075
His maner now for to see?’
To the castell gan they gone,
Richer saw they never none,
Better myght none be.
‘Sir,’ he said, ‘be god all-myȝt’, 1080
For thou hym slew, þat it dight,
I vouche it saue on the,

and takes him to the
Giant’s Castle.

The King of Calabria
gives Torrent the
Giant’s castle,

1072. *To T.] Torrent said MS.*
1081. *it] is MS.*

ENT HEARS THAT DESONELL IS TO WED A KING.

(94)

‘I yeve yt the, *sir*, of my *hond*,
And there-to, an erledome of *my lond*,
For soth, ye shall it haue; 1085
Omage thou shalte none *nor* ffyne,
But euer more to the and thyne,
Frely, so god me saue!’
Lordys, and ye liston wold,
What was clepud the riche hold: 1090
The castell of Cardon, *by sawe*.
Two days or thre dwellith he thare
And sith he takythe *leve* to ffare,
Both at knyght and knave.

f. 94b.

and an Earldom.

The Castle’s name is
Cardon.

1083. *yt] om. MS.*
of] alle add. MS.
hond] lond MS.
1084. *my] om. MS.*

1086. *nor*] om. MS.
1091. *by s.*] om. MS.
1092. *there* MS.

(95)

By the kyng of Pervens he gan gane, 1095
That he had oute *of preson* i-tane
His son vppon a day.
Gentilmen were blith and ffayn',
That he in helth was comyn' agayn',
That they myght with hym' play. 1100
There of herd he, *sertaynle*,
That Desonell wedid shold be
With an vncouth Ray.
And listonyth, lordis, of a chaunce,
Howe he lefte his countenaunce 1105
And takyth hym' armes gay!

1098. *leve*] *the way* MS.
1096. *of preson*] om. MS.
1101. *sertayn* MS.
1103. *vnc.*] *a* add. MS.

Torrent hears that
Desonell is to marry a
strange King.

ENT IS KNIGHTED. DESONELL IS MARRIED.

(96)

By-fore the kyng he fell on kne:
'Good lord,' he said, 'for charite,
Yeve me order of knyght!
I wott well, leryd are ye, 1110
My lordys doughter shall wed be
To a man' off myght.'
'Sir,' he said, 'I trow, she mone
To the prynce off Aragon',
By this day sevynnyght. 1115
Swith,' he seith, 'that this be done,
That thou be there and wyn' thy shone,

The King of Provyns
knights Torrent.

f. 95a.

Gete the armes bryght.'

1110. *ye are leryd* MS.

1111. *be wed* MS.

1115 and 1118 have changed their place in the MS.

(97)

Sir Torrent ordenyth hym a sheld,

It was ryche in euery ffeld, 1120

Listonyth, what he bare:

On azure a squier off gold,

Richely bett on mold;

Listonyth, what he ware:

A dragon' lying hym be-syde, 1125

His mouth grennyng full-wyde,

All ffyghtyng as they were;

The creste, that on his hede shold stond,

Hit was all gold shynand,

Thus previd he hym' there. 1130

1122. *On] of* MS.

(98)

Lordys assemblid in sale,

Well-mo than I haue in tale,

Or ellis gret wonder were.

There herd *he* tell-ffor certan',

That Desonell-wed shold be than', 1135

That was hym selfe ffull-dere.

And whan' he herd of that ffare,

Wors tydingis than were thare,

Might he none gladly here

1134. *he] I* MS.

Torrent has

an azure shield with a
gold squire on it;

and a grinning dragon
of gold on the crest of
his helmet.

He hears that Desonell':
marriage is certain.

(99)

He wold not in passe, 1140
Till *at* the myd mete was
The kyng and meny a knyght;
As they satt at theyre *mete* glade,
In at the hall dur *he* rade
In armes ffeyre and bryght, 1145
With a squier, that is ffre;
Vp to the lady ryduth he,
That rychely was i-dight.
'Lordys,' he said, 'among you all
I challenge thre coursus in the hall, 1150
Or Delyuer *her* me with right!'

1141. *at*] om. MS.

1143. *mete*] om. MS.

1144. *he*] *they* MS.

1151. *Delyuer it me* MS.

Torrent rides into the
Hall where Desonell is,
f. 95b.

and challenges any one
to fight him for her.

(100)

The kyng of Aragon sett her bye,
And he defendid her nobely:
'I wyll none delyuer the.'
His son said: 'So muste I thryve, 1155
There shall no man just for my wiffe;
But yf youre wyll it be,
For her love did I never no dede,
I shall to day, so god me spede:
Be-hold and ye shall se.' 1160
'Alas!' said Desonell the dere,
'Full longe may I sitt here,
Or Torrent challenge me.'

The Prince of Aragon
accepts,

(101)

Trumpettes blew in the prese,
Lordys stond on *the grese*, 1165

and the lists are made
ready.

Ladyes lay ouer and be-held.
The prynce and Torrent then
Eyther to other gan ren',
Smertely in that ffeld;
Torrent sett on hym' so sore, 1170
That hors and man down' he bore,
And all-to-sheverd his sheld.
So they tombelid all in ffere,
That afterward of VII yere
The prynce none armes myght weld. 1175

Torrent

unhorses the Prince of
Aragon,

1165. *the grese]* *reugis* or *rengis* MS.

ENT BEATS THE PRINCE OF ARAGON.

(102)

Torrent said: 'So god me saue,
Other two coursus wylt I haue,
Yf ye do me law of lond.'
Gret lordys stond stylt;
They said nether good ne ylt 1180
For tynding of his hond.
The prynce of Aragon' in they barr'
With litult worshipp and sydes sare,
He had no fote on ffor to stond.
Thus thes lordys justid aye; 1185
Better *they* had to haue be away,
Suche comffort there he ffond.

f. 96a.

and he is carried
indoors.

1167. *than* MS.

1186. *they]* *he* MS.

1187. *ffound* MS.

(103)

He wold not in passe,
Tilt they at myd mete was,

At dinner,

On the other day at none. 1190
 His squiers habite he had,
 Whan' he to the deyse yad,
 With oute couped shone,
 And the hede on' the bord he laid:
 'Lo, sir kyng, hold this,' he said, 1195
 'Or ellis wroth we anon!'
 They sett stilȝ at the bord,
 None of hem spake one word,
 But ryght that he had done.

Torrent lays Slongus's
 head on the table.

1198. *They spake nether ylle ne good* add. (!) MS.

ENT CLAIMS DESONELL, AND HALF PORTUGAL.

(104)

Torrent at the syde bord stode: 1200
 'Lystonyth, lordynges, gentilȝ of blood,
 For the love of god allȝ-myght:
 The kyng heyght me his doughter dere,
 To ffyght with a ffeendys ffere,
 That wekyd was and wight, 1205
 To wed her to my wyffe,
 And halffe his kyngdome be his liffe,
 And after his days allȝ his ryght.
 Lokyth, lordys, you among, [1210]
 Whether he do me ryght or wrong!' 1210
 Tho waried hym' both kyng & knyght.

Torrent proclaims the
 promise of the King of
 Portugal
 to give him Desonell,
 and half Portugal, if he
 slew Slongus.

f. 96b.

1211. &] *ky*, struck out, add. MS.

(105)

Tho said the kyng of Aragon, i-wys:
 'Torrent, I wiste no thing of thys,
 A gret maister arte thou!'
 The kyng sware be seynt Gryffen': 1215

The King of Aragon

‘With a sword thou shalte her wyne,
Or thou haue her now:
For why, my son to her was wed,
Gret lordys to churche her led, [1220]
I take wittnes of all you.’ 1220
‘Kyng Calamond, haue good day,
Thou shalt i-bye it, and I may,
To god I make avowe.’

1220. *you alle* MS.

(106)

The Emperoure of Rome ther was,
Be-twene thes kynges gan’ he passe 1225
And said: ‘Lordys, as sone,
This squier, that hath brought this hede,
The kyng had wend he had be dede,
And a-venturly gan’ he gone: [1230]
I rede you take a day of *ryghtes*, 1230
And do it vppon’ two knyghtes,
And let no man’ be slon’!’
Gret lordys, that were thare,
This talis lovid at that fare
And ordenyd that anon’. 1235

1230. *ryghtes*] *Restys* MS.

1232. *slayn* MS.

1235. *that*] *than* MS.

says his son has wedded
Desonell.

He will be revenged on
the King of Portugal.

To settle the quarrel,

the Emperor suggests a
fight between 2
Champions.

ENT IS TO FIGHT THE GIANT CATE.

(107)

To the kyng *the thoght* com’ was,
To send vnto Sathanas
For a geaunt, that hight Cate,
For to make hym’ knyght to his hond [1240]

The King of Aragon
sends to the giant Cate

And sease hym' in all his lond; 1240
The messingere toke the gate.
Gret othes he sware hym than',
That he shold ffyght but *with* one man',
And purvey hym he bad
Iryn stavis two or thre, 1245
For to ffyght with Torent ffre,
Though he there of ne watt.

f. 97a.

to fight Torrent

1236. *the thoght* om. MS.
1247. *wott* MS.

(108)

Than take counsell kyng and knyght,
On lond that he shold not ffyght, [1250]
But ffar oute in the see, 1250
In an yle long and brad;
A gret payn' there was made,
That holdyn' shold it be.
Yf Cate slow Torent, that ffre ys,
Halfe Portyngale shold be his, 1255
To spend with dedys ffre;
And yf *sir* Torrent myght hym ouer-com',
He shold haue halfe Aragon',
Was better than suche thre. [1260]

on an island

for half Portugal.

1248. *couns.*] *of* add. MS.
1251. *brod* MS.

.....
IANT CATE, AND TORRENT, GO TO THE ISLAND.
.....

(109)

The Gyaunt shipped in a while 1260
And sett hym' oute in an yle,
That was grow both grene and gay.
Sir Torrent com' prekand on a stede,

The Giant Cate comes
to an Island.

Richely armed in his wede;
 'Lordyngys,' gan he say, 1265
 'It is semely ffor a knyght,
 Vppon a stede ffor to ffyght.'
 They said sone: 'Nay,
 He is so hevy, he can not ryde. [1270]
 Torrent said: 'Evill-mut he be-tyde, 1270
 Falshode, woo worth it aye!'

(110)

'Sir, takyth housell-and shrefte!'
 To god he did his hondys lifte,
 And thankid hym of his sond:
 'Iesu Cryste, I the praye, 1275
 Send me myght and strengith this day
 A-yen' the ffend to stond!'
 To the shipp *sir* Torent went,
 With the grace, god had hym sent, [1280]
 That was never ffayland; 1280
 All the lordys of that contre,
 Frome Rome vnto the Grekys se,
 Stode and be-held on lond.

f. 97b.

Torrent prays for
 Christ's help,

1278. This line begins with a big initial letter.

Torent] yode, struck out, add. MS.

1283. *On lond stode and be held* MS.

(111)

Whan *sir* Torrent in to the Ile was brought,
 The shipmen' lenger wold tary nought, 1285
 But hied hem sone ageyn';
 The Giaunt said: 'So must I the,
 Sir, thou art welcom to me,
 Thy deth is not to layn'!' [1290]
 The ffirste stroke to hym he yaue, 1290
 Oute of his hand flew his staff:

and lands in the Island
 too.

The Giant

knocks Torrent's staff
 out of his hand,

That thefe was full-fayn'.
Tho *sir* Torent went nere Cate,
He thought, he wold hym' haue slayn'.

ENT KILLS THE GIANT CATE WITH COBBLE-STONES.

(112)

The theff couth no better wonne, 1295
In to the see rennyth he sone,
As faste as he myght ffare.
Sir Torrent gaderid cobled stonys, [1300]
Good and handsom ffor the nonys,
That good and round ware; 1300
Meny of them to hym' he caste,
He threw stonys on hym so faste,
That he was sad and sare.
To the ground he did hym felþ;
Men' myght here the fend yelþ 1305
Halfe a myle and mare.

and runs into the sea.

Torrent shies cobble-
stones at him,

kills him,

f. 98a.

1298. *gad.*] *good* add. MS.
1300. *were* MS.
1303. *sore* MS.
1306. *more* MS.

(113)

Sir Torent said, as he was wonne,
He thankid Iesu, Maryes son', [1310]
That kyng, that sent hym myȝt';
He said: 'Lordys, for charite, 1310
A bote that ye send to me,
It is nere hand nyght!'
They Reysed a gale *with* a saylþ;
The Geaunt to lond for to traylþ;
All-men wonderid on that wight. 1315
Whan that they had so done,

and he is towd ashore.

They went to *sir* Torent full-sone
And shipped that comly knyght. [1320]

Torrent is shipt to the
mainland.

ENT WINS DESONELL, LANDS, AND A CITY.

(114)

The emperoure of Rome was there,
The kynges of Pervens and of Calabere yare, 1320
And other two or thre.

They yaue *sir* Torent, that he wan,
Both the Erth and the woman',
And said, well-worthy was he.

Torrent is awarded
Desonell, territory,

Sir Torent had in Aragon' 1325
The riche Cite of Cargon'

and the City of Cargon.

And all that riche contre;
Archbeshoppes, as the law felþ, [1330]
Departid the prynce and Dissonell
With gret solempnite. 1330

Desonell is divorst from
the Prince of Aragon.

1320. *The kynges*] om. MS.
1321. *other*] *kynges* add. MS.
or] *the* add. MS.

(115)

For *sir* Torent the fend did fall;
Gret lordys honoured hym' all
And for a doughty knyght hym' tase;
The kyng said: 'I vnderstond,
Thou hast fought ffor my doughter & my
lond, 1335

The King of Portugal
acknowledges Torrent,

f. 98b.

And well-wonne her thou hase.'
He gaue to *saint* Nycholas de Barr'
A grett Erldome and a *simarr*' [1340]
That abbey of hym *tas*
For Iesus love, moch of myght, 1340
That hym helpith day & nyght,

Whan' he to the battell *gas*.

1337. *saint*] *sir* MS.

1338. *simarre*] *marr* MS.

1339. *tas*] *redith* MS.

1342. *gas*] *yode* MS.

[\(116\)](#)

Lordys than' at the laste,

Echone on theyre way paste,

And euery man' to his. 1345

The quene of Portingale was ffayn',

That *sir* Torent was com agayn'

And thankyd god of this. [1350]

Than said the kyng: 'I vnderstond,

Thou hast fought for my doughter & my lond, 1350

And art my ward, i-wys,

And I wyll not ageyn' the say;

But abyde halfe yere and a day,

And broke her well with blis!'

and the Queen is glad.

The King of Portugal
bids Torrent

wait 6 months and a day
for Desonell.

ENT BEGETS TWINS ON DESONELL.

[\(117\)](#)

Torent said: 'So muste I the, 1355

Sith it wyll no better be,

I cord with that assent!'

After mete, as I you tell, [1360]

To speke with mayden' Desonell;

To her chamber he went. 1360

The damysell so moche of pride

Set hym on' her bed-syde,

And said: 'Welcom', verament!'

Such gestenyng he a-right,

That there he dwellid all nyȝt' 1365

With that lady gent.

Torrent

passes a night with
Desonell.

(118)

f. 99a.

Sir Torent dwellid thare
Twelffe wekys and mare, [1370]
Till letters com hym till
Fro the kyng of Norway; 1370
For Iesus love he did hym praye,
Yf it were his wylk,
He shold com as a doughty knyght,
With a Geaunt for to ffyght,
That wylk his londys spylk; 1375
He wold hym yeve his doughter dere
And halfe Norway ffar and nere,
Both be hold and be hylk. [1380]

The King of Norway
begs

him to come and fight a
Giant there.

ENT SAILS TO FIGHT A NORWEGIAN GIANT.

(119)

Sir Torent said: 'So god me saue,
I-nough to lyve vppon I haue, 1380
I wylk desire no more;
But it be, for Iesu is sake
A poynt of armes for to take,
That hath helpid me be-ffore.
I yeve the here oute of my hond 1385
To thy doughter all my lond,
Yf that I end thore.'
And whan he toke his way to passe, [1390]
Mo than ffyfty with hym was,
That fals to hym wore. 1390

Torrent

gives all his land to the
King for Desonell;

1387. *there* MS.

1390. *were* MS.

(120)

Syr Torent to the lady went,

Full curtesly and gent:

‘Desonellȝ haue good day!

I muste now on my jurnay,

A kyngis lond for to fend. 1395

Thes gold rynges I shallȝeve the,

Kepe *them* wellȝ, my lady ffre,

Yf god a child vs send!’ [1400]

She toke the ryngis with moche care,

Thries in sownyng felt she thare, 1400

Whan she saw, that he wold wend.

1393. *Denoselle* MS.

1397. *them*] om. MS.

(121)

Shipp and takylȝ they dight,

Stede and armour ffor to ffyght

To the bote they bare.

Gentilmenȝ, that were hend, 1405

Toke her leve at theyre frend,

With hym ffor to fare.

Kyng Colomond, is not to laynȝ, [1410]

He wold, that he cam nevure agaynȝ;

There fore god yeff hymȝ care! 1410

So within the ffyfty dayes

He Come in to the lond of Norways,

Hard Contre ffound he thare.

leaves 2 gold rings with
her,

f. 99b.

and goes on board ship
with his steed and
armour.

Torrent gets to Norway.

ENT REACHES NORWAY, AND HEARS OF A GIANT.

(122)

Thus *sir* Torrent, for soth, is fare,

A noble wynd droffe hymȝ thare, 1415

Was blowyng oute of the weste.

Of the Coste of Norway they had a sight . . .

[1419]

Of sayling they were all preste.
So ffeyre a wynd had the knyght,
A litul be-ffore the mydnyght 1420

He Rode be a foreste.
The shipmen said: 'We be shent;
Here dwellith a geaunt, verament,
On his lond are we *kest*!'

The shipmen tell him of
a Giant.

1424. *kest*] *sett* MS.

(123)

The maistershipmon' said: 'Nowe 1425
I Rede, we take down' sayle & Rowe,
While we haue this tyde. [1430]
Sir,' he said, 'be god all myght,
The giant lieth euery nyght
On' the mowntayn' here be-syde; 1430
My lord the kyng wyl not ffyght,
Till he of you haue a sight,
On you ys all his pryde!'
Sir Torrent said: 'Here my hond!
Sith we be ryven on this lond, 1435
To nyght wyl I ryde.'

f. 100a.

Torrent resolves to land

1425. *maistershipmen* MS.

1429. *lieth*] *here* add. MS.

1434. *Torerent* MS.

ENT LANDS IN THE FOREST OF BRASILL.

(124)

Sir Torent armyd hym' anon [1440]
And his knyghtes euerychone
With sheld and spere in hond.

Torrent and his knights
arm.

The shipmen' said: 'As mut I thryve, 1440
I Rede, that euery man' other shryve,
Or that we go to the lond.'
Sir Torent said: 'As god me spede,
We will firste se that ffede,
My lord was never *failand*! 1445
Gentilmen, make chere good,
For Iesu love, that died on Rood, [1450]
He will be oure waraunt!'

1445. *fleand* MS.

1446. *make*] *made* MS.

(125)

In a forest can' they passe,
Of Brasill; saith the boke, it was, 1450
With bowes brod and wyde.
Lyons and berys there they ffind
And wyld bestes aboute goand,
Reysing on euery side.
Thes men' of armes, *with* trayn' 1455
To the shipp they flew agayn'
In to the see at that tyde; [1460]
Fast from land row they be-gan',
A-bove they left that gentilman',
With wyld beestis to haue kyde. 1460

1451. *bowes*] *browes* MS.

1452. *ffound* MS.

1460. *k* corrected out of *r*.

They reach the Forest o
Brasill.

The coward knights flec
to the ship,

and leave Torrent alone.

(126)

The shipmen' of the same lond
Ryved vp, I vnderstond,
In another lond off hold.
To the chamber they toke the way,
There the kyng hym' selfe lay, 1465

f. 100b.

False tales of Torrent
are told to the King of

And fals talis hym' told
For he wold not the geaunt abyde, [1470]
For all this contrey feyre and wyde,
Thou3 he yeff it hym wold.

Norway.

1465 put before 1464 MS.

ENT COMES ON 2 DRAGONS IN A VALLEY.

(127)

'Sir kyng, ye haue youre selfe 1470
Erlis *doughty be* ten' or twelfe,
Better know I none:
Send youre messingeris ffar and wyde,
For to ffel the geauntes pride,
That youre doughter hath tane.' 1475
'I had lever to haue that knyght;
With hym' is grace of god all my3t',
To be here at his bane.' [1480]
Full litul wist that riche kyng
Of *sir* Torrentes ryding 1480
In the forest all alone.

The King of Norway
wants Torrent to come.

1471. *doughty be*] om. MS.

1476. *that*] *ky*, struck out, add. MS.

(128)

Thorou3 helpe of god that *with* hym was,
Fro the wyld bestis gan' he passe
To an hye hyl:
A litul while be-fore the day 1485
He herd in a valey
A dynnyng and a yell. [1490]
Theder than' riduth he,
To loke, what thing it my3t be,
What adventure thare be-fel. 1490

Torrent rides up to 2
Dragons.

It were two dragons stiff and strong,
Vppon' theyre lay they sat and song,
Be-side a depe well.

1490. *thare]* *that* MS.

(129)

Sir Torent said thanne
To god, that made man' 1495
And died uppon' a tree:
'Lord, as thou mayst all-weld, [1500]
Yeve me grace, to wyn' the feld
Of thes ffeendys onfre!'
Whan he had his prayers made, 1500
Pertely to hem' he Rade
And one thorou3 oute bare he.
Thus sped the knyght at his comyng
Thorough the helpe of hevyn' kyng:
Lord, lovid muste thou be! 1505

f. 101a.

Torrent prays to Christ,

spears the first Dragon;

1499. *onfre]* *ontrewe* MS.

1502. *he bare* MS.

ENT KILLS THE 2 DRAGONS, AND SEES A CASTLE.

(130)

The other dragon wold not flee,
But showith all his myght; [1510]
He smote ffire, that lothely thing,
As it were the lightnyng,
Vppon' that comly knyght. 1510
There fore *sir* Torent wold not lett,
But on' the dragon) fast' he bett
And over-come that foule wight.
Tho anon the day sprong,
Fowles Rose, mery they song, 1515

and then kills the
second.

The sonne a-Rose on hyȝt.

1507. *shotith* MS.

1516. *hyȝe* MS.

(131)

Torent of the day was fullþ blithe, [1520]

And of the valey he did hym' swith,

As fast as euer he may.

To a mowntayn' he rode ryght, 1520

Of a castell' he had a sight

He sees a Castle.

With towrys hyȝe and gay

He come in to an hyȝe strete,

Few folke gan' he mete,

To wis hym' the way. 1525

1525. *wish* MS.

ENT BEFORE THE NORSE GIANT'S CASTLE.

(132)

To the gatys tho he Rade;

Fullþ craftely they were made [1530]

Of Irun' and eke of tree.

One tre stonding there he ffound:

f. 101b.

Nyne oxen' of that lond 1530

Shold not drawe the tre.

The Giaunt wrought vp his wallþ

And laid stonys gret and smallþ

A lothely man' was he.

'Now,' quod Torrent, 'I not, whare, 1535

My squiers be ffro me to fare,

Euer waried they be! [1540]

1526. *rode* MS.

1529. *ffound* MS.

1532. *welle* MS.

Torrent rides to the
Norse Giant's castle
gates.

1535. *wot* MS.
1537. *they*] *thou* MS.

(133)

‘Lord god, what is beste,
So Iesu me helpe, Est or Weste,
I Can not Rede to say. 1540
Yf I to the shipp fare,
No shipmen’ ffynd I thare;
It is long, sith they were away.
Other wayes yf I wend,
Wyld bestis wylt me shend: 1545
Falshede, woo worth it aye!
I ffyght here, Iesu, for thy sake; [1560]
Lord, to me kepe thou take,
As thou best may!’

He considers what he
shall do,

and resolves to fight.

1540. *say*] *done* MS.
1542. *And no* MS.
I] om. MS.

(134)

Down’ light this gentill knyght, 1550
To Rest hym’ a litull wight,
And vnbrydelid his stede
And let hym’ bayte on’ the ground,
And aventid hym’ in’ that stound,
There of he had gret nede. 1555
The Gyaunt yode and gaderid stone
And sye, where the knyght gan’ gone, [1570]
Alf armed in dede;
And wot ye well and not wene,
Whan eyther of hem had other sene, 1560
Smertely *they* rerid her dede.

He baits his steed.

The Norse Giant
prepares to fight.

f. 102a.

1553. *bayte*] *hym* add. MS.
1561. *they*] om. MS.

(135)

For that *sir* Torent had hym sene,
He worth vppon his stede, I wene,
And Iesu prayde he tilke
'Mary son', thou here my bone, 1565
As I am' in venturus stad come,
My jurnay to full-ffylle' [1580]
A voys was fro hevyn' sent
And said: 'Be blith, *sir* Torent,
And yeve the no thing yll, 1570
To ffyght with my lordys enemy:
Whether that thou lyve or dye,
Thy mede the quyte he wylle'

1566. *sad* MS.

1567. *to*] *than* MS.

1573. *He wylle quyte the thy mede* MS.

Torrent prays to Christ,

and is cheerd by a voice
from Heaven.

(136)

Be that the giaunt had hym dight,
Cam' ageyn' that gentill-knyght, 1575
As bold as eny bore;
He bare on' his nek a croke, [1590]
Woo were the man', that he ouertoke,
It was twelfe ffote and more.
'Sir,' he said, 'ffor charite, 1580
Loke, curtes man' that thou be,
Yf thy wylle-ware:
I haue so fought all this nyght
With thy II dragons wekyd and wight,
They haue bett me full-sore.' 1585

The Giant advances
against Torrent.

(137)

The Geaunt said: 'Be my fay,
Wors tydinges to me this day [1600]
I myght not goodly here.
Thorough the valey as thou cam',
My two dragons hast thou slan', 1590
My solempnite they were.
To the I haue full good gate;
For thou slow my brother Cate,
That thou shalte by full dere!'
Be-twene the giaunt and the knyght 1595
Men myght se buffettes right,
Who so had be there. [1610]

1590. *slayne* MS.

(138)

Sir Torent yaue to hym' a brayd;
He levid that the aungell said,
Of deth yaue he *nought*. 1600
In to the brest he hym' bare,
His spere hede lefte he thare,
So evill was hitt *bythought*.
The Giaunt hym ayen' smate
Thorough his sheld and his plate, 1605
In to the flesh it sought;
And sith he pullith at his croke, [1620]
So fast in to the flesh it toke,
That oute myȝt he gete it nought.

1600. *nought*] *no dynt* MS.

1603. *byth.*] *mynt* MS.

(139)

On hym' he hath it broke, 1610
Glad pluckys there he toke,

The Giant says he'll
punish

Torrent for killing his 2
Dragons

f. 102b.

and his Brother Cate.

The Giant's crook cuts
through Torrent's shield
to his flesh,

and sticks there.

Set sadly and sare.
Sir Torent stalworth satt,
Oute of his handys he it gatt,
No lenger dwellid he thare. 1615
In to the water he cast his sheld,
Croke and all-to-geders it held, [1630]
Fare after, how so euer it ffare.
The Geaunt folowid *with* all his mayn',
And he come never quyk agayn': 1620
God wold, that so it ware.

1612. *sore* MS.

1615. *there* MS.

Torrent throws his
shield and the Giant's
crook into the water.

The Giant goes in after
them and is drowned.

ENT SLAYS THE NORSE GIANT, WERAUNT.

(140)

Sir Torent bet hym' there,
Till that this fend did were,
Or he thens wend.
On hym had he hurt but ane, 1625
Lesse myght be a *mannus* bane,
But god is full hend: [1640]
Thorough grace of hym, that all shall weld,
There the knyght had the feld,
Such grace god did hym' send. 1630
Be than it nyed nere hand nyȝt',
To a castell he Rode right,
All nyght there to lend.

f. 103a.

1626. *But lesse* MS.

Torrent rides to the
Giant's castle,

(141)

In the castell found he nought,
That god on the Rode bought; 1635
High vppon' a toure,

As he caste a side lokyng, [1650]
He saw a lady in her bed syttyng,
 White as lylve ffloure;
Vp a-Rose that lady bryght, 1640
And said: 'Welcom', *sir* knyght,
 That fast art in stoure!
'Damysel, welcom' mut thou be!
Graunt thou me, for charite,
 Of one nyghtis soioure!' 1645

and finds a fair Lady
there.

Torrent asks for a
night's lodging.

1645. *socoure* MS.

ENT IN THE GIANT WERAUNT'S CASTLE.

(142)

'By Mary,' said that lady clere,
'Me for-thinkith, that thou com' here, [1660]
 Thy deth now is dight;
For here dwellith a geaunt,
He is clepud Weraunt, 1650
 He is *to* the devill-be-taught.
To day at morn' he toke his croke,
Forth at the yates the way he toke,
 And said, he wold haue a draught;
And here be chambers two or thre, 1655
In one of hem I shall hide the,
 God the saue ffrome harmes right!' [1670]

The Lady says the Gian
Weraunt will kill him.

f. 103b.

1650. *Weraunt*] *weraunt* (?) MS.
1651. *to*] *of* MS.

(143)

'Certayn', tho said the knyght,
'That theffe I saw to nyght,
 Here be-side a slade. 1660
He was a ferly freke in ffyght,

Torrent tells her to

With hym faught a yong knyght,
Ech on other laid good lade;
Me thought welȝ, as he stode,
He was of the fendus blood, 1665
So Rude was he made.
Dame, yf thou leve not me, [1680]
Com' nere, and thou shalt se,
Which of hem abade.'

1660. *slate* or *flate* MS.

1663. *lode* MS.

1669. *abode* MS.

(144)

Blith was that lady bryght 1670
For to se that *selly* sight:
With the knyght went she.
Whan she cam, where the Geaunt lay,
'Sir,' she said, '*parmaffay*
I wott welȝ, it is he. 1675
Other he was of god all-myght
Or seynt George, oure lady knyȝt', [1690]
That there his bane hath be.
Yf eny cryston' man smyte hym down',
He is worthy to haue renown' 1680
Thorough oute all-crystiaunte.'

1671. *selly*] om. MS.

come and see the Giant.

The Norwegian Princes
sees the Giant's corpse,

and praises his slayer.

ENT RESCUES THE PRINCESS OF NORWAY.

(145)

'I haue wonder,' said the knyght,
'How he gate the, lady bryght,
Fro my lord the kyng.'
'Sir,' she said, 'verament, 1685

She tells Torrent

As my fader on huntynge went
Erly in a mornynge, [1700]
Fore his men pursued a dere,
To his castell, that stondith here,
That doth my hondys wryng, 1690
This Giaunt hym toke, wo he be!
For his love he geuith hym me,
He wold none other thinge.'

f. 104a.

that her Father gave her
as his ransom, to the
Giant.

1688. *For MS.*

(146)

Forth she brought bred and wyne,
Fayn he was for to dyne 1695
This knyght made noble chere,
Though that he woundid were [1710]
With the Geaunt strong.

(147)

Sir Torrent dwellid no lenger thare,
Than he myȝt away fare 1700
With that lady bryght.
'Now, Iesu, that made hell,
Send me on lyve to Desonell;
That I my trouth to plight!'
Tho sye they be a forest syde 1705
Men of armes ffaste ride
On coursers comly dight. [1720]
The lady said: 'So mvst I thee,
It is my fader, is com for me,
With the Geaunt to ffyght.' 1710

Torrent takes her away.

Torrent longs for
Desonell.

The Norwegian Princes
sees her Father.

ENT IS WELCOMD BY THE KING OF NORWAY.

(148)

An harood said anon' right:
 'Yon I se an armed knyght,
 And no squier, but hym' one:
 He is so *big* of bone & blood,
 He is the Geaunt, be the Rode!' 1715
 Som' seith, he riduth vppon'.
 'Nay,' said the kyng, 'verament, [1820]
 It is the knyght, that I after sent,
 I thanke god and seynt Iohn,
 For the Geaunt slayn') hath he 1720
 And wonne my doughter, well is me!
 All his men are atone!'

f. 104b.

Torrent is recognised

1714. *big*] *long* MS.

1722. *at.*] *tane* MS.

(149)

Wott ye well, with Ioy and blis
 Sir Torent there recevid ys,
 As doughty man' of dede. 1725
 The kyng and other lordys gent
 Said, 'Welcom', *sir* Torent, [1830]
 In to this vncouth *thede*!
 In to a state they hym' brought,
 Lechis sone his woundis sought; 1730
 They said, so god hem spede,
 Were there no lyve but ane,
 His liffe they wyll not vndertane,
 For no gold ne ffor mede.

and welcomd by the
 King of Norway.

His wounds are drest.

1728. *thede*] *lond* MS.

ESS GENDRES. TORRENT STAYS A YEAR IN NORWAY.

(150)

The lady wist not or than', 1735

The Princess

That he was hurt, that gentilman',
 And sith she went hym tylk; [1840]
 She sought his woundus and said thare:
 'Thou shalte lyve and welfare,
 Yf the no-thing evylk! 1740
 My lord the kyng hath me hight,
 That thou shalt wed me, *sir* knyght,
 The fforward ye to fulle ffylk.'
 'Damyselk; loo here my hond:
 And I take eny wyffe in this lond, 1745
 It shall be at thy wylk!'

claims Torrent as her
 husband.

(151)

Gendres was that ladyes name. [1850]
 The Geauntes hede he brought hame,
 And the dragons *he brought*.
 Mene myght here a myle aboute, 1750
 How on the dede hedys they did shoute,
 For the shame, that they hem' wrought,
 Both with dede and with tong
 Fyfte on the hedys dong,
 That to the ground they sought. 1755
 Sir Torrent dwellid thare
 Twelfe monythis and mare, [1860]
 That fforwarder myzt he nought.

Her name is Gendres.

f. 105a.

Torrent stays 12 months
 in Norway.

1749. *he br.*] *also* MS.
 1752. *they*] *had* add. MS.

(152)

The kyng of Norway said: 'Nowe,
 Fals thevis, woo worth you, 1760
 Ferly sotell were ye:
 Ye said, the knyght wold not com':
 Swith oute of my kyngdome,
 Or hangid shall ye be!'

His squiers, that fro hym¹ fled, 1765
 With sore strokys are they spred
 Vppon the wanne see, [1870]
 And there they drenchid euery man¹,
 Saue one knave, that to lond cam¹,
 And woo be-gone is he. 1770

The King of Norway
 sends Torrent's false
 Squires to sea,

where all drown, save
 one.

NELL IS NEAR CHILD-BEARING.

(153)

The child, to lond that god sent,
 In Portyngale he is lent,
 In a riche town¹,
 That hath hight be her day,
 And euer shall; as I you say, 1775
 The town¹ of Peron¹.
 By-fore the kyng he hym sett, [1880]
 'Full-wel-thy men¹, lord, the grett,
 And in the see *did* they drown.'
 Desonell-said: 'Where is Torent?' 1780
 'In Norway, lady, verament.'
 On sownyng fel-thy down¹.

He takes the news to the
 King of Portugal,

and tells Desonell that
 Torrent is in Norway.

f. 105b.

1774. *hatt* (!) MS.
 1778. *the*] *they* MS.
 1779. *did*] *are* MS.
drowned MS.

(154)

As she sownyd, this lady myld,
 Men myȝt se tokenyng of her child,
 Steryng on¹ her right syde. 1785
 Gret Ruth it was to tel;
 How her maydens on¹ her fel, [1890]
 Her to Couer and to hide.
 Tho the kyng said: 'My doughter, do way!

She swoons, and folk
 see she is big with child

By god, thy myrth is gone for aye, 1790
Spousage wyllthou none *bide*!
There fore thou shalt in to the see
And that Bastard with-in the,
To lerne you ffor to ride.'

1791. *bide*] *lede* MS.

The King of Portugal
declares he'll send
Desonell and her
Bastard to sea.

NELL BEARS TWINS TO TORRENT.

(155)

Erlis and Barons, that were good, 1795
By-fore the kyng knelid and stode
For that lady free. [1900]
The quene, her moder, on knees felþ;
'For Iesu is love, that harood helþ;
Lord, haue mercy on' me! 1800
That ylke dede, that she hath done,
It was with an Erlis sonne,
Riche man' i-nough is he;
And yf ye wyll not let her lyve,
Right of lond ye her yeve, 1805
Till she delyuerd be!'

His Earls

and the Queen

pray for mercy for
Desonell.

(156)

Thus the lady dwellith there, [1910]
Tyll that she delyuerd were
Of men' children' two;
In all poyntes they were gent, 1810
And like they were to *sir* Torent;
For his love they sufferid woo.
The kyng said: 'So mut I thee,
Thou shalte in-to the see
With oute wordys moo. 1815
Euery kyngis doughter ffer and nere,

She is delivered of 2
male children

like Torrent.

f. 106a.

Her Father says she
shall be sent out to sea.

At the shall they lere, [1920]
Ayen' the law to do.'

1807. *Thus the*] so [F. VII](#); *This* MS.

1808. *Tyll*] so [F. VII](#); om. MS.

1810. *all*] so [F. VII](#); om. MS.

(157)

Gret ruth it was to se,
Whan they led that lady ffree 1820
Oute of her faders lond.
The quene wexid tho nere wood
For her doughter, that gentill ffode,
And knyghtis stode wepand;
A cloth of silke gan they ta 1825
And partyd it be-twene hem twa,
Therin they were wonde.
Whan' they had shypped that lady ying, [1930]
An hunderid felt in sownyng
At Peron' on' the sond. 1830

1827. so [F. VII](#); om. MS.

1828. *had sh.*] so [F. VII](#); *clepud* MS.
yeng MS.

She is led from his land

The Queen bewails her
daughter's fate.

Desonell is sent to sea.

.....
NELLE IS SENT OUT TO SEA. SHE REACHES LAND.
.....

(158)

Whan that lady was downe fall,
On Iesu Cryste dyd she call;
Down' knelid that lady clene:
'Rightfull god, ye me sende
Some good londe, on to lende, 1835
That my chyldren may crystonyd bene!'
She said, 'Knyghtis and ladyes gent,
Grete well my lord, *sir* Torrent,
Yeff ye hym' euer sene!'

She prays to Christ for
her children.

The wynd Rose ayen' the nyght, 1840
Fro lond it blew that lady bryght [1941]
Vppon the see so grene.

1831 f.] so [F. VII](#); om. MS.

1833. *clene*] *clere* MS.

1834 f.] so [F. VII](#);

Iesu Cryste, that com vp here

On this strond, as I wenyd MS.

1836. *my ch.*] so [F. VII](#); *we* MS.

(159)

Wyndes and weders haue her drevyn',
þat in a forest she is revyn',
There wyld beestis were; 1845
The see was eb, and went her ffroo,
And lefte her and her children' two
Alone with-oute ffere.
Her one child woke and be-gan' to wepe,
The lady a-woke oute of her slepe 1850
And said: 'Be still; my dere, [1951]
Iesu Cryst hath sent vs lond;
Yf there be any cryston man' nere hond,
We shall haue som socoure here.'

She and they reach land

f. 106b.

Desonell stills her
crying child,

1844. *forest*] so [F. VII](#); *ftrest* MS.

she is] so [F. VII](#); *be they* MS.

FFIN CARRIES OFF ONE OF DESONELL'S BOYS.

(160)

The carefull lady was full blith, 1855
Vp to lond she went swith,
As fast as euer she myght.
Tho the day be-gan' to spryng,
Foules a-Rose and mery gan syng
Delicious notys on' hight. 1860

To a mowntayn went that lady ffree: [1961]
 Sone was she warr' of a Cite
 With towrus ffeyre and bryght.
 There fore, i-wys, she was full-fayn',
 She sett her down', as I herd sayn', 1865
 Her two children' ffor to dight.

goes up a mountain,

(161)

Vppon' the low the lady ffound
 An Erber wrought *with* mannus hond,
 With herbis, that were good.
 A Grype was in' the mowntayn' wonne, 1870
 A way he bare her yong son' [1971]
 Ouer a water fflood,
 Over in to a wyldernes,
 There seynt Antony ermet wes,
 There as his chapell-stode. 1875
 The other child down' gan' she ly,
 And on the ffoule did shoute & crye,
 That she was nere hond wood.

and finds an Arbour
there.

A Griffin carries off one
of her boys.

She puts the other
down,

f. 107a.

1874. *was* MS.
 1876. *ly*] *lay* MS.

PARD CARRIES OFF DESONELL'S 2ND BOY.

(162)

Vp she rose ageyn' the rough,
 With sorofull-hert and care Inough, 1880
 Carefull of blood and bone [1981]
 She sye, it myght no better be,
 She knelid down' vppon' her kne,
 And thankid god and seynt Iohn'.

and sorrows.

(163)

There come a libard vppon' his pray, 1885
 And her other child bare away,
 She thankid god there
 And his moder Mary bryght.
 This lady is lefte alone ryght:
 The sorow she made there 1890

A leopard takes her
 other boy away.

(164)

That she myght no further ffare: [1991]
 'Of one poynt,' *she sayd*, 'is my care,
 As I do now vnderstond,
 So my children' crystenyd were,
 Though they be with beestes there, 1895
 Theyre liffe is in goddus hond.'
 The kyng of Ierusalem' had bene
 At his brothers weddyng, I wene,
 That was lord of all that lond.
 As he com homward on his way, 1900
 He saw where the liberd lay [2001]
 With a child pleyand.

The King of Jerusalem
 sees the leopard and
 child.

1892. *she s.*] om. MS.

(165)

Torrent had yeve *her* ringes two,
 And euery child had one of tho,
 Hym' with all to saue. 1905
 The kyng said: 'Be Mary myld,
 Yonder is a liberd *with* a child,
 A mayden' or a knave.'
 Tho men' of armes theder went,
 Anon' they had theyre hors spent, 1910
 Her guttys oute she Rave. [2011]
 For no stroke wold she stynt;
 Tilt they her slew *with* speris dynt,

Each child has one of
 Torrent's rings.

f. 107b.

The King's men

kill the Leopard,

The child myght they not haue.

1903. *her]* *his lady* MS.

LEOBERTUS) IS ADOPTED BY THE KING OF JERUSALEM.

(166)

Vp they toke the child ying 1915
And brought it be-ffore the kyng
And vndid the swathing band,
As his moder be-ffore had done,
A gold ryng they ffound sone,
Was closud in his hond. 1920
Tho said the kyng of Ierusalem': [2021]
'This child is come of gentill-teme,
Where euer this beest hym' ffound.
The boke of Rome berith wytnes,
The kyng hym' namyd Leobertus, 1925
That was hent in hethyn' lond.

1915. *yong* MS.

1923. *ffound* MS.

and take the Child to the
King,

who christens him
'Leobertus,'

(167)

Two squiers to the town' gan' flyng,
And a noryse to the child did bryng,
Hym' to kepe ffrome greme.
He led it in' to his own' lond 1930
And told the quene, how he it ffound [2031]
By a water streame.
Whan' the lady saw the ryng,
She said, with-oute lettyng:
'This child is com' of gentill-teme: 1935
Thou hast none heyre, thy lond to take,
For Iesu love thou sholdist hym' make
Prynce of Ierusalem'.'

and takes him to
Jerusalem.

1929. *grame* MS.
1937. *woldist* MS.

TONY GETS THE FIRST BOY FROM THE GRIFFIN.

(168)

Now, in boke as we rede,	
As seynt Antony aboute yede, 1940	St. Anthony
Byddyng his orysoun', [2041]	
Of the gripe he had a sight,	f. 108a.
How she flew in a fflight,	sees the Griffin
To her birdus was she boun'.	
Be-twene her clawes she bare a child: 1945	and Desonell's first boy
He prayed to god and Mary myld,	
On lyve to send it down'.	
That man was well-with god all-myzt',	
At his fote gan' she light,	whom the bird lays at
That foule of gret renown'. 1950	his feet.

(169)

Vp he toke the child there, [2051]	
To his auter he did it bere,	
There his chapell-stode.	
A knave child there he ffound,	
There was closud in his hond 1955	
A gold ryng riche and good.	
He bare it to the Cite grett,	St. Antony takes the boy
There the kyng his fader sett	to his Father, the King
As a lord of jentill-blood,	of Greece.
For he wold saue it ffro dede; 1960	
A grype flew a-bove his hede [2061]	
And cryed, as he were wood.	

1951. *thare* MS.
1954. *ffound* MS.
1958. *sett*] *lett* MS.

(170)

This holy man' hied hym' tyte
To a Cite *with* touris white,
As fast as he may. 1965
The kyng at the yate stode
And other knyghtes and lordys good
To se the squiers play.
The kyng said: 'Be Mary myld,
Yonder comyth Antony, my child, 1970
With a gryffon' gay. [2071]
Som' of his byrdus take hath he,
And bryngith hem' heder to me!'
Gret ferly had thaye.

The King sees

his son Antony,

ANTONY FITZ-GRIFFIN) IS ADOPTED BY THE KING OF GREECE.

(171)

The kyng there of toke good hede, 1975
And a-geyn' his sonne he yede
And said: 'Welcom' ye be!'
'Fader,' he said, 'god you saue!
A knave child ffound I haue,
Loke, that it be dere to the! 1980
Frome a greffon' he was refte, [2081]
Of what lond that he is lefte,
Of gentill-blood was he:
Thou hast none heyre, thy lond to take,
For Iesu love thy sonne hym' make, 1985
As in the stede of me!'

f. 108b.

who asks him to adopt
Desonell's boy as

his heir.

(172)

The kyng said: 'Yf I may lyve,
Helpe and hold I shall hym yeve
And receyve hym as my son'.

The King of Greece
agrees,

Sith thou hast this lond forsake, 1990
 My riche londys I shall hym take, [2091]
 Whan he kepe them con'.
 To a ffont they hym yaue,
 And crystonyd this yong knave;
 Fro care he is wonne. 1995
 The holy man yaue hym name,
 That Iesu shild hym ffrome shame:
 Antony fice greffoun'.

and has the Boy
 baptized.

The Boy is christend
 Antony Fitzgriffin.

1992. *can* MS.

NELL BEWAILS HER LOST CHILDREN.

(173)

'Fader, than haue thou this ryng,
 I ffound it on this swete thing, 2000
 Kepe it, yf thou may: [2101]
 It is good in euery fight,
 Yf god yeve grace, that he be knyght,
 Be nyght *and* be day.'
 Let we now this children dwell, 2005
 And speke we more of Desonell:
 Her song was welaway.
 God, that died vppon the Rode,
 Yff grace, that she mete *with* good!
 Thus disparplid are thay. 2010

Desonell laments,

f. 109a.

2002. *fight*] *sight* MS.?

2004. *Other be* MS.

and] *or forme of* (!) MS.

2010. *disparlid* MS.

(174)

This lady walkyd all alone [2111]
 Amonge wyld bestis meny one,
 Ne wanted she no Woo;

wanders among wild
 beasts,

Anon' the day be-gan to spryng,
And the ffoules gan to syng, 2015
With blis on euery bowȝe

(175)

'Byrdus and bestis, aye woo ye be!
Alone ye haue lefte me,
My children' ye *have* slone.'
As she walkid than' a-lone, 2020
She sye lordis on' huntynge gone, [2121]
Nere hem' she yede full̄ sone.
This carfull̄ lady cried faste,
Than she herd this hornes blaste
By the yatis gone, 2025
But *ran* in to a wildernes,
Amongist beests that wyld wes,
For drede, she shold be slone.

and bewails her lost
children.

Desonell flees from
some hunters

2018. *haue*] *a* corrected out of *e* MS.
2019. *have sl.*] *slough* MS.
2026. *ran*] om. MS.
2027. *was* MS.

NELL FLEES TO THE LAND OF NAZARETH.

(176)

Till̄ it were vnder of the Day,
She went *fro* that wilsom' way, 2030
In to a lond playn'. [2131]
The kyng of Nazareth huntid there,
Among the hertes, that gentill̄ were;
There of she was full̄ ffayn'

into the land of
Nazareth.

2030. *fro*] *in* MS.

(177)

They had ferly, kyng and knyght, 2035
Whens she come, that lady bryght,
Dwelling here a-lone.

She said to a squier, that there stode:
‘Who is lord of most jentill blood?’

And he answerid her anon: 2040
‘This ys the lond of Nazareth, [2141]

Se, where the kyng gethe,

Of speche he is fful bone;
Al in gold couerid is he.’

‘Gramercy, *sir*,’ said she, 2045

And nere hym gan she gone.

f. 109b.

She sees the King,

(178)

Lordys anon ageyn her yode,
For she was com of gentill blood,

In her lond had they bene:

‘God loke the, lady ffree, 2050

What makist thou in this contre?’ [2151]

‘Sir,’ she said, ‘I wene,

Seynt Katryn I shold haue sought,

Wekyd weders me heder hath brought

In to this fforest grene, 2055

And all is dede, I vnderstond,

Saue my selfe, that com to lond

With wyld beestis and kene.’

whose Lords greet her.

Desonell says that her
boys are dead, and she
is left alone.

NELL IS WELCOMD BY THE QUEEN OF NAZARETH.

(179)

‘Welcom,’ he said, Desonell;

By a tokyn I shall the tell: 2060

Onys a stede I the sent. [2161]

Lady gent, ffeyre and ffree,

To the shold I haue wedid be,

My love was on' the lent.'
Knyghtis and squiers, that there were, 2065
They horsid the lady there,
And to the Cite they went.
The quene was curtes of that lond
And toke the lady be the hond
And said: 'Welcom, my lady gent! 2070

She is taken to
Nazareth,

and welcomd by the
Queen,

(180)

'Lady, thou art welcom' here, [2171]
As it all'thyn' own' were,
All'this ffeyre contree!'
'Of one poynt was my care,
And my two children' crystonyd ware, 2075
That in wood were reft ffro me.'
'Welcom art thou, Desonell;
In my chamber for to dwell;
Inough there in shall-ye see!'
Leve we now that lady gent, 2080
And speke we of *sir* Torrent, [2181]
That was gentill and ffre.

f. 110a.

with whom she stays.

2076. in] *the* add. MS.

.....
ENT HEARS OF THE EXILE OF DESONELL AND HER BOYS.
.....

(181)

The kyng of Norway is full woo,
That *sir* Torent wold wend hym ffro,
That doughty was and bold: 2085
'Sir,' he said, 'abyde here
And wed my daughter, that is me dere!'
He said, in no wise he wold.
He shipped oute of the kynges sale
And Ryved vp in' Portingale 2090

Sir Torrent won't stop in
Norway,

but goes back to

At another hold. [2191]
Whan' he herd tell of Desonell;
Swith on sownyng there he felt
To the ground so cold.

Portugal.

(182)

The fals kyng of Portingale, 2095
Sparid the yatis of his sale
For Torent the ffree;
He said: 'Be Mary clere,
Thou shalt no wyfe haue here,
Go sech her in' the see! 2100
With her she toke whelpis two, [2201]
To lerne to row wold she go.'
'By god, thou liest,' quod he,
'Kyng Colomand, here my hond!
And I be knyght levand, 2105
I-quytt shall it be!'

The false King
Calamond of Portugal

tells him that Desonell
and her 2 Boys were
sent out to sea.

f. 110b.

(183)

Torent wold no lenger byde,
But sent letters on euery side
With fforce theder to hye.
Theder com oute of Aragon' 2110
Noble knyghtes of gret renown' [2211]
With grett chevalrye.
Of Pervyns and Calaber also
Were doughty knyghtes meny moo,
They come all to that crye. 2115
Kyng Calomond had no knyght,
That with *sir* Torent wold fyght,
Of all that satt hym' bye.

Torrent gathers an army

Torrent's knights

2113. *Calaber*] *Cababer* (!) MS.

(184)

There wold none the yatis deffend,
But lett *sir* Torent in wend 2120
With his men' euerychone. [2221]
Swith a counsell-yede they to,
To what deth they wold hym do,
For he his lady had slone.
'Lordis,' he said, 'he is a kyng, 2125
Men may hym' nether hede ne hing.'
Thus said they euerychone.
They ordenyd a shipp all of tree
And sett hym' oute in' to the see,
Among the wawes to gone. 2130

and he are let into the
chief City of Portugal,

and resolve to send the
false King to sea

2123. *To*] om. MS.

2126. *hing*] *heng* MS.

(185)

Gret lordis of that lond [2231]
Assentid to that comand,
That hold shold it be.
In the havyn' of Portyngale,
There stode shippes of hede vale 2135
Of Irun and of tree.
A bote of tre they brought hym be-fforn',
Full of holis it was born',
Howselþ and shryfte *wold* he.
Sir Torent said: 'Be seynt Iohn', 2140
Seth thou gaue my lady none, [2241]
No more men' shall do the!'

f. 111a.

in a boat full of holes.

2132. *comland* MS.

2138. *boryn* MS.

2139. *wold*] *had* MS.

(186)

The shipp-men^l brought *sir* Colomond
And sent hym fforth within^l a stound
As ffar as it were. 2145
Wott ye well^l and vnderstond,
He come never ayen to lond,
Such stormes ffound he there.
Gret lordys of renown^l
Be-toke *sir* Torent the crown^l 2150
To reioyse it there. [2251]
Loo, lordys of euey lond:
Falshode wyll^l haue a foule end,
And wyll^l haue euermore.

The false king
Calamond is drownd,

and Torrent is made
King of Portugal,

(187)

Sir Torent dwellid thare 2155
Fourty days in moche care,
Season^l for to hold;
Sith he takith two knyghtes,
To kepe his lond and his rightes,
That doughty were and bold. 2160
'Madam',^l he said to the quene, [2261]
'Here than shall^l ye lady bene,
To worth as ye wold.'
He purveyd hym^l anon^l,
To wend ouer the see fome, 2165
There god was bought and sold.

but he gives the land up
to the Queen,

and resolves to go to the
Holy-Land.

2161. *He said madam* MS.

(188)

And ye now will^l liston^l a stound,
How he toke armes of kyng Calomond,

f. 111b.

Listonyth, what he bare.
 On asure, as ye may see, 2170
 With syluer shippes thre, [2271]
 Who so had be thare.
 For Desonell is love so bryght,
 His londis he takyth to a knyght,
 And sith he is *boun* to fare. 2175
 ‘Portyngale, haue good day
 For Sevyn’ yere, *parmaffay*,
Par aventure som’ dele mare!’

His arms are 3 silver
ships on an azure field.

For love of Desonell,

Torrent leaves Portugal.

2170. This line begins with a big initial letter.

Off MS.

2175. *boun*] *home* MS.

2178. *more* MS.

ENT TAKES THE CITY OF QUARELL.

(189)

Sir Torent passid the Grekys flood
 In to a lond both riche and good, 2180
 Full evyn’ he toke the way [2281]
 To the *cite* of Quarell;
 As the boke of Rome doth tell;
 There a soudan’ lay.
 There he smote and set adown’ 2185
 And yaue asaute in to the town,
 That *will* the storye say.
 So well they vetelid were,
 That he lay there two yere,
 Sith in’ the town’ went they. 2190

He besieges the City of
Quarell

for 2 years, and then
takes it.

2182. *cite*] *see* MS.

2187. *well* MS.

says MS.

2190. *And sith in to* MS.

(190)

And tho *sir* Torent ffound on' lyve, [2291]
 He comaundid with spere and knyffe
 Smertely dede to be;
 He said: 'We haue be here
 Moche of this two yere 2195
 And onward on' the thre.'
 All the good, that *sir* Torent wan',
 He *partid* it among his man',
 Syluer, gold and ffee;
 And sith he is boun to ride 2200
 To a Cite there be-syde, [2301]
 That was worth such thre.

2196. *thrid* MS.

2198. *men* MS.

He has its inhabitants
 kild,

and shares its booty
 among his men.

f. 112a.

ENT TAKES ANOTHER CITY, AND GOES TO ANTIOCH.

(191)

There he stode and smote adown'
 And leyd sege to the town',
 Six yere there he lay. 2205
 By the VI yere were all done,
 With honger they were all slone,
 That in the Cite lay.
The Soudan sent to *sir* Torent than',
 With honger that thes people be slan, 2210
 All the folke of this Cite; [2311]
 'Yf ye thinke here to lye,
 Ye shall haue wyne and spycery,
 I-nough is in this contre.'

2209. *The*] A MS.

2209-14 put before 2203-8 MS.

2210. *slayn* MS.

2211. *thes* MS.

Torrent then besieges
 another heathen City fo
 6 years.

All its folk die of
 hunger.

(192)

Now god do his soule mede! 2215
On the soudan' he had a dede
Vppon' euery good ffryday.
Iesu sent hym strengith I-nough,
With dynt of sword he hym slough,
There went none quyk away. 2220
Down knelid that knyght [2321]
And thankid god with all his myȝt':
So ought he well to say.
The Cite, that *sir* Torent was yn',
Worldely goodis he left ther yn', 2225
To kepe it nyght and day.

Torrent kills the Sultan,

(193)

Sith he buskyd hym' to ride
In to a lond there be-syde,
Antioche it hight.
Sevyn' yere at the Cite he lay 2230
And had batell euery good ffryday, [2331]
Vppon' the Sarȝins bryght;
And be the VII yere were gone,
The child, that the liberd had tane,
Found hym his fill off ffyght 2235

goes to Antioch,

f. 112b.

and fights every good
Friday.

2230-32 put before 2227-29 MS.

.....
ENT'S SON LEOBERTUS FIGHTS AGAINST HIM.
.....

(194)

The kyng of Ierusalem' herd tell
Of this lord good and fell,
How doughtyly he hym bare.
Vppon' his knyghtes can he call,
'Ordeyn' swith among you all, 2240

The King of Jerusalem

For no thing that ye spare!' [2341]
They buskyd hem oute of the land,
The nombre off ffyfty thousand,
Ageyn Torent ffor to ffare

sends 50,000 knights,

2243. *thousaid* MS.

(195)

The kyng of Ierusalem said thus: 2245
'My dere son, Liobertus,
That thou be bold and wight!
Thou shalt be here and defend the lond
From that fals traytors hond
And take the ordre of a knyght.' 2250
He yaue hym armes, or he did passe: [2351]
Right as he ffound was,
On gold he bare bryght
A liberd of asure bla
A child be-twene his armes twa: 2255
Woo was her, that se it myght!

and his adopted son
Leobertus (Torrent's
second boy)

2246. *Liobertious* MS.
2253. *On*] *Of* MS.
2254. *blay* (!) MS.
2255. *tway* MS.
2256. *ffulle woo* MS.
se it m.] it ought MS.

(196)

Sir Torent wold no lenger abyde,
But thederward gan' he ride;
And to the feld were brought
Two knyghtes, that were there in stede; 2260
Many a man did they to blede, [2361]
Such woundis they wrought.
There durst no man com' Torent nere,
But his son, as ye may here,

against Torrent.

f. 113a.

Torrent's son Leobertus

Though he knew hym nought. 2265
Alþto nought he bet his shild,
But he toke his fader in the feld,
Though he there of evill thought.

captures him.

ENT IS IMPRISOND IN JERUSALEM.

(197)

Whan' *sir* Torent was takyn' than',
His men fled than', euery man', 2270
They durst no lenger abyde. [2371]
Gret ruth it was to be hold,
How his sword he did vp-hold
To his son' that tyde.
To Ierusalem' he did hym' lede, 2275
His actone and his other wede,
Alþbe the kyngis side;
'Sir,' he said, 'haue no care,
Thou shalte lyve and welfare,
But lower ys thy pryde!' 2280

Torrent

is taken to Jerusalem

(198)

Fro that *sir* Torent was hom brought, [2381]
Doughty men' vppon' hym' sought,
And in preson' they hym' thronge.
His son above his hede lay,
To kepe hym' both nyȝt and day, 2285
He wist well, that he was strong.
Thus in preson as he was,
Sore he sized and said alas,
He couth none other songe.
Thus in bondys they held hym thare 2290
A twelfmonyth and som dele mare, [2391]
The knyght thought ffull long.

and thrust into prison,

where his son Leobertu:
hears him lament a
whole year.

f. 113b.

2281. *hom]* *hem* MS.
2283. *And and (!)* MS.
throuze MS.

ENT'S SON ASKS FOR HIS FATHER'S FREEDOM.

(199)

In a mornynge as he lay,
To hym selfe gan' he say:
 'Why lye I thus alone? 2295
God, hast thou forsakyn' me?
All my truste was in the,
 In lond where I haue gone!
Thou gave me myȝt ffor to slee
Dragons two other thre 2300
 And giauntes meny one, [2401]
And now a man' in wekid lond
Hath myn' armour and stede in' hond:
 I wold, my liffe were done!'

2299. *flee* MS.!

Torrent

appeals to God

who once enabled him
to kill Dragons and
Giants.

(200)

His son herd hym' say soo 2305
And in his hert was full woo,
 In chamber there he lay;
'Sir,' he said, 'I haue thy wede,
There shall no man reioyse thy stede,
 Yf so be, that I may. 2310
By oure lady seynt Mary, [2411]
Here shalt thou no lenger lye,
 Nether be nyȝt' ne be day;
As I am' Curtesse and hend,
To the kyng I shall wend, 2315
 And ffor thy love *hym* pray!'

2313. *Nether be day ne be nyȝt* MS.

His son Leobertus hears
him,

and promises to get him
freed.

2316. *ffor thy love and pray this nyzt* MS.

(201)

On' the morow whan' he Rose,
The prynce to the kyng gose
And knelid vppon' his knee;
'Sir,' he said, 'ffor goddus sonne, 2320
The knyght, that lieth in the dungeon', [2421]
Ye wold graunt hym' me!
I hard hym say be hym' alone,
Many Geauntes had he slone
And dragons II or thre.' 2325
The kyng said: 'Be my ffay,
Be warr', he scape not away;
I vouch hym saue on the!'

f. 114a.

Leobertus asks the King
of Jerusalem for
Torrent.

The King of Jerusalem
grants Torrent to his
elder son,

ENT IS FREED, AND HONOURD IN JERUSALEM.

(202)

The prynce in to the preson went,
Torent by the hond he hent 2330
Oute of his bondys cold; [2431]
To the castell he brought hym sone
And light ffettouris did hym' vppon',
For brekyng oute off hold.
The kyng said: 'Be my ffaye, 2335
And he euer scape away,
Full dere he shall be sold!'
'Sir,' he said, 'parmaffay,
We wyl hym' kepe, and we may:
There of be ye bold!' 2340

who frees him from
prison,

tho' still fettering him.

2331. *And toke hym oute* MS.

(203)

For he was curtes knyght & free, [2441]
 At the mete sett was he
 By the kyng at the deyse.
 ‘Sir, thou haste i-bene
 At Iustis and at tornementes kene, 2345
 Both in warr¹ and in peas:
 Sith thy dwelling shall be here,
I pray, that thou woldist my son¹ lere,
 Hys Tymber ffor to asay.’
 ‘Sir,’ he said, ‘I vnderstond, 2350
 Aftter the maner off my lond [2451]
 I shall, with outen *delay*.’

Torrent dines with the
 King,

and promises to teach
 his son Leobertus
 spearcraft.

f. 114b.

2348. *I pray*] om. MS.

2352. *delay*] lese MS.

ENT JOUSTS WITH HIS ELDER SON, AND OTHERS.

(204)

The castell¹ court was large with in¹,
 They made ryngis ffor to Ren¹,
 None but they alone. 2355
 Euery of hem to opure Rade:
 Feyrer Turnamentes than they made,
 Men sye never none.
 The prynce in armes was full¹ preste,
 Thre shaftys on¹ his fader he breste, 2360
 In shevers they gan gone. [2461]
 Sir Torent said: ‘So mvt I thee,
 A man of armes shall thou be,
 Stalworth of blood and bone!’

The jousts at Jerusalem.

Torrent’s son Leobertus
 breaks 3 shafts on his
 Father.

2356. *Rode* MS.

2357. *Turmentes* MS.

(205)

Harroldys of armes cryed on' hight, 2365
The prynce and that other knyght
No more juste shall thay;
But lordys of other lond,
Euery one to other ffond,
And sith went theyre way. 2370
Sixe wekys he dwellid there, [2471]
Till that all delyuerd were,
That in the Cite *lay*.
Tho they held a gestonye,
With all maner of mynstralsye, 2375
Tyll the Sevynt day.

2373. *lay*] were MS.

(206)

Lordis with all other thing
Toke leve at the kyng,
Home theyre ways to passe.
That tyme they yaue Torent the floure 2380
And the gre with moch honowre, [2481]
As he well worthy was.
The kyng said: 'I shall the yeve
Liffe and lyvelode, whill I lyve,
Thyn armour, as it was.' 2385
Whan he sye ffeyre ladyes wend,
He thought on her, that was so hend,
And sighed and said: 'Alas!'

NELL IS TOLD OF TORRENT'S VICTORY.

(207)

The kyng of Nazareth home went,
There that his lady lent, 2390
In his own lede. [2491]

The jousts last 6 weeks.

A Feast is held.

Torrent is declared
victor.

f. 115a.

The King of Jerusalem
promises to support
Torrent.

The King of Nazareth

‘Sir,’ she said, ‘ffor goddus pite,
What gentilman’ wan’ the gre?’

He said, ‘So god me spede,
One of the ffeyrest knyghtis, 2395
That slepith on’ somer nyghtes
Or walkyd in wede;
He is so large of lym’ and lith,
All the world he hath justid with,
That come to that dede.’ 2400

(208)

‘Good lord,’ said Desonell, [2501]
‘For goddus love ye me tel;
What armes that *he* bare!’
‘Damysell, also muste I the,
Syluer and asure beryth he, 2405
That wott I well thare.
His Creste is a noble lond,
A Gyaunt with an’ hoke in’ hond,
This wott I well, he bare.
He is so stiff at euery stoure, 2410
He is prynce and victoure, [2511]
He wynneth the gree aye where.

tells Desonell that the
Victor (Torrent) has an
armd Giant as his crest.

f. 115b.

2403. *he*] *ye* MS.

ENT AND HIS 2 SONS GO TO A JOUSTING.

(209)

Of Portyngale a knyght he ys,
He wanne the town’ of Raynes
And the Cite of Quarelle; 2415
At the last jurney that was sett,
The prynce, my broders son’ *he mett*,
And in his hond he ffelk.

The Victor is a Knight
of Portugal.

The prynce of Grece leth nere
There may no juster be his pere, 2420
For soth as I you telk: [2521]
A dede of armes I shall do crye
And send after hym' in hye.'
Blith was Desonelk:

The King of Nazareth
proclaims a Jousting.

2415. *Quarellis* MS.
2416. *that]* *he* add. MS.
2417. *he m.] was gatt* MS.

(210)

This dede was cried ffar and nere, 2425
The kyng of Ierusalem did it here,
In what lond that it shold be.
He said: 'Sone, anon right
Dight the and thy cryston' knyght,
For sothe, theder will we.' 2430
Gret lordys, that herith this crye, [2531]
Theder come richely,
Everyman' in his degre.
The kyng of Grece did *make hym boun*,
With hym' come Antony ffy3 greffon', 2435
With moche solempnite

The King of Jerusalem
sends Torrent and his
elder son Leobertus
to it.

The King of Greece
brings the younger son,
Antony Fitzgriffin.

2434. *make hym b.] assigne* MS.

(211)

'The kyng of Nazareth sent me,
That there shold a justynge be
Of meny a cryston' knyght,
And all is ffor a lady clere, 2440
That the justyng is cryed ffar and nere, [2541]
Of men' of armes bryght.'
Gret joye it was to here telk;
How thes kynges *with* the knyghtis fell
Come and semled to that ffyght. 2445

The Jousting is for a
lady.

f. 116a.

JOUSTS AT NAZARETH BEGIN.

(212)

There come meny another mon',
That thought there to haue to done,
And than' to wend her way.
Whan' they come to the castell-gent,
A Roall ffyght, verament, 2450
There was, the sothe to say. [2551]
Trompes resyn' on the wall;
Lordys assembled in the hall;
And sith to souper yede thay.
They were recevid *with* rialte, 2455
Euery man' in his degre,
And to her logyng went her way.

Many folk come to the
jousts.

They sup

and sleep,

(213)

The lordys Rosyn all-be-dene
On the morow, as I wene,
And went masse ffor to here. 2460
And ffurthermore *with-oute* lent [2561]
They wesh and to mete went,
For to the ffeld they wold there.
After mete anon' right
They axid hors and armes bryght, 2465
To hors-bak went thay in ffere.
Knyghtis and lordys reuelid all;
And ladyes lay ouer the castell-wall;
That semely to se were.

rise,

hear Mass,

and dine,

then mount,

(214)

Than' eueryman toke spere in' hond, 2470
And euerych to other ffond, [2571]

Smert boffettes there they yeld.
The prynce of Ierusalem' and his brother,
Eueriche of hem' Ran to other'

Smertely in the feld 2475
Though' Antony ffygryffon' yonger were,
His brother Leobertus he can down' bere;
Sir Torent stode and be-held.

2471. *ffound* MS.
2472. *there th. y.] they yeldyd there* MS.

and begin to joust.

f. 116b.

Torrent's 2 sons joust.

The younger, Antony,
unhorses his brother
Leobertus.

ENT AND HIS SONS JOUST. HE IS VICTOR.

(215)

'Be my trouth,' said Torent thanne,
'As I am' a cryston' man 2480
I-quytt shall it be.' [2581]
Torent be-strode a stede strong
And hent a tymber gret and long,
And to hym' rode he.

2483 put before 2482 MS.

(216)

Torrent to hym rode so sore, 2485
That he to the ground hym' bare,
And let hym' lye in' the *bent*.
There was no man' hy3e ne lowe,
That myght make Torent to bowe
Ne his bak to bend. 2490
They justyd and turneyd there, [2591]
And eueryman' ffound his pere,
There was caught no dethis dent.
Of alþe Justis, that there ware,

Torrent rides down his
younger son.

He and his sons are the

Torent the floure a way bare 2495
And his sonnys, *verament*.

best jousters.

2485 f.:

*Torrent so sore to hym rode,
That he bare hym to the ground* MS.

2487. *bent*] *ffeld* MS.

2493. *dynt* MS.

2496. *ver.*] *in that tyde* MS.

(217)

And on^o the morow, whan^o it was day,
Amonge all^o the lordys gay,
That worthy were, *par de*,
Desonell^o wold no lenger lend, 2500
But to *sir* Torent gan^o she wend [2601]
And knelid on her kne.
She said: ‘Welcom^o, my lord *sir* Torent!’
‘And so be ye, my lady gent!’
In sownyng than fell^o she. 2505
Vp they coueryd that lady hend,
And to mete did they wend
With joye and solempnite.

Desonell greets Torrent,

f. 117a.

and swoons.

2499. *par de*] *in wede* MS.

2502. *And on her kne she knelid* MS.

NELL GREETS TORRENT. HER BEAUTY.

(218)

Dame Desonell^o be-sought the kyng.
That she myght, with oute lesyng, 2510
Sytt with Torent alone. [2611]
‘Yes, lady, be hevyn^o kyng,
There shall^o be no lettyng;
Worthy is he, be seynt Iohn!’
Tho they washid and went to mete, 2515

All go to Dinner.

And riallly they were sett
 And seruid worthely, *echone*.
 Euery lord in' the hall,
 As his state wold be-ffall,
 Were couplid with ladyes *schone*. 2520

2514. *ffor welle worthy* MS.
 2517. *echone*] *verament* MS.
 2520. *schone*] *gent* MS.

(219)

But of all ladyes, that were there sene, [2621]
 So ffeire myght there none bene
 As was dame Desonell:
 Thes two kyngis, that doughty ys,
 To the Cite come, i-wys, 2525
 With moche meyne *emell*.

Desonell is the fairest
 lady.

The Kings of Jerusalem
 and Greece go to the

2526. *emell*] om. MS.

(220)

To the castell they toke the way,
 There the kyng of Nazareth lay,
 With hym' to speke on high.
 At none the quene ete in' the hall, 2530
 Amongist the ladyes ouer all, [2631]
 That couth moche curtesye.
 Desonell wold not lett,
 By *sir* Torent she her sett,
 There of they had *envye* 2535

King of Nazareth's
 Castle.

Desonell sits by Torent

2535. *envye*] *wonder* MS.

NELL FINDS HER TWO SONS BY TORRENT.

(221)

Whan' eyther of hem other be-held,
Off care no thyng they ffeld,
Bothe her hertes were blithe.
Gret lordys told she sone,
What poyntes he had for her done, 2540
They be-gan to be blithe; [2641]
And how her *fader* in the see did her do,
With her she had men' childre two;
They waried hym' fell-sithe.
'Sir kyng, in this wildernes, 2545
My two children' fro me revid wes,
I may no lenger hem' hide.

2542. *fader*] om. MS.

2546. *was* MS.

f. 117b.

She tells the Lords how
her

Father sent her and her
2 Boys to sea;

(222)

'The knyght yaue me rynges two,
Euerich of hem' had one of thoo,
Better saw I never none. 2550
A Gryffon' bare the one away, [2651]
A liberd the other, *parmaffay*,
Down' by a Roche of stone.'
Than' said the kyng of Ierusalem':
'I ffound one by a water streme, 2555
He levith *with* blood & bone.'
The kyng of Grece said: 'My brother,
Antony my son' brought me anopure.'
She saith: 'Soth, be seynt Iohn'?

2556. *levith*] yet add. MS.

and how one was
carried off by a Griffin,
and the other by a
Leopard.

Leobertus and Antony
are these boys.

ENT INVITES 3 KINGS TO PORTUGAL.

(223)

The kyng said: 'Sith it is so, 2560

Kys ye youre fader bo, [2661]
 And axe hym' his blessyng!
 Down' they knelid on' her knee:
 'Thy blessing, ffader, for charite!'
 'Welcom', children' ying!' 2565
 Thus in armes he hem' hent,
 A blither man' than' *sir* Torent
 Was there none levyng;
 It was no wonder, thouze it so were;
 He had his wiffe and his children' there, 2570
 His joye be-gan' to spryng. [2671]

2561. *bothe* MS.

2565. *yong* MS.

f. 118a.

Torrent's 2 Sons kneel
and ask his blessing.

He rejoices in them and
their Mother,

(224)

Of all the justis, that were thare,
 A way the gre his sonnys bare,
 That doughty were in dede.
 Torent knelid vppon' his knee 2575
 And said: 'God yeld you, lordys ffree,
 Thes children' that ye haue ffed:
 Euer we will be at youre will;
 What jurney ye will put vs tyl;
 So Iesu be oure spede, 2580
 With that the kyng thre [2681]
 In to my lond will wend *with* me,
 For to wreke oure stede.'

and thanks the Kings fo
taking care of them.

He asks the Kings to
Portugal.

([225](#))

They graunted that there was,
 Gret lordys more and lesse, 2585
 Bothe knyght and squiere;
 And with Desonell went
 Al the ladyes, that were gent,
 That of valew were.

All agree to go.

Shippis had they stiff and strong, 2590
Maistis gret and sayles long, [2691]
Hend, as ye may here,
And markyd in to Portingale,
Whan' they had pullid vp her sayl;
With a wynd so clere. 2595

Their ships arrive at
Portugal.

ENT, DESONELL, AND THEIR SONS, GO TO PORTUGAL.

(226)

The riche quene of that lond
In her castell-toure gan stond
And be-held in'-to the see.
'Sone,' she said to a knyght,
'Yonder of shippis I haue a sight, 2600
For sothe, a grett meyne.' [2701]
The quene said: 'Verament,
I se the armes of *sir* Torent,
I wott welk; it is he.'
He answerid and said tho: 2605
'Madam, I wilk; that it be so,
God gefe grace, that it so be!'

f. 118b.

The Queen

2605-7 put before 2602-4 MS.

(227)

A blither lady myȝt none be,
She went ageyn hym' to the see
With armed knyghtes kene. 2610
Torent she toke by the hond: [2711]
'Lordys of vncouth lond,
Welcom muste ye bene!'
Whan she sye Desonell,
Swith in' sownyng she fell 2615
To the ground so grene.

welcomes

Torrent and his friends,

and swoons when she
sees her daughter
Desonell.

Torent gan' her vp ta:
'Here bene her children' twa,
On lyve thou shalt hem seene!'

2616. *grene*] *kene* MS.

2619. *see* MS.

ENT WEDS DESONELL. HIS SONS MADE HEIRS OF KINGS.

(228)

In the Castell of Portyngale 2620
A-Rose trumpes *of* hede vale, [2721]
To mete they went on' hye.
He sent letters ffar and nere;
The lordys, that of valew were,
They come to that gestonye. 2625
The Emperoure of Rome,
To that gestonye he come,
A noble knyght on' hyze.
Whan' all thes lordys com were,
Torrent weddid that lady clere, 2630
A justyng did he crye. [2731]

Torrent holds a great
feast,

and weds Desonell.

2621. *of*] om. MS.

2629. *ware* MS.

(229)

So it ffel vppon a day,
The kyng of Ierusalem' gan say:
'Sir, thy sonne I ffound
Lying in a libertes mouth, 2635
And no good he ne couth,
Dede he was nere hond:
Wold thou, that he dwellid *with* me,
Till that I dede be,
And sith reioyse my lond?' 2640

f. 119a.

(230)

Be fore lordys of gret renown', [2741]
Torent gaue hym' his son'
The kyng of Grece said: 'Sir knyght,
I yeff thy son all my right
To the Grekys flood: 2645
Wouch thou saue, he dwell *with* me?'
'Yea, Lord, so mut I thee,
God yeld you all this good!'
For *sir* Torent was stiff in stoure,
They chose hym ffor Emperoure, 2650
Beste of bone and blood. [2751]

2645. *flood*] *I plight* add. MS.

ENT IS MADE EMPEROR. HE DIES.

(231)

Gret lordys, that there were,
Fourty days dwellith there,
And sith they yode her way;
He yaue his sonnys, as ye may here, 2655
Two swerdys, that were hym' dere,
Ech of hem' one had they.
Sith he did make vp-tyed
Chirchus and abbeyes wyde,
For hym' and his to praye. 2660
In Rome this Romans berith the crown' [2761]
Of all kerpyng of Renown':
He leyth in a feire abbey.

2654. *And sith her way they yode* MS.

2663. *leyth*] *in Rome* add. MS.

(232)

He gives his son
Leobertus as heir to the
King of Jerusalem;

and his son Antony as
heir to the King of
Greece.

Torrent is elected
Emperor.

Torrent gives his 2 Sons
a Sword each.

He lies in a fair Abbey.

Now Iesu Cryst, that althath wrought,
As he on the Rode vs bought, 2665

f. 119b.

He geve hys his blessing,
And as he died for you and me,
He graunt vs in blis to be,

May Christ grant us
Heaven!

Lesse and mare, both old and ying! Amen.

2669. *Oute of this world whan' we shalle wend* MS.

Explicit Torent of Portyngale.

THE FRAGMENTS.

I. [1](#)

[*The King of Portugal plots Torrent's death.*]

[T] est hym vp 462

. . . . chent be for to fle

. . . . ly ivyll he gone 464

The kynge of Nazareth sent hym me,

Torent, I wot-saue hym on the,

For better loue I none!' 467

Desonell gives Torrent a
Horse

which the King of
Nazareth had sent her.

Afterwarde vpon a tyde,

As they walkyd by the ryvers syde,

The kynge and yonge Torent, 470

This lorde wolde fayne, that he dede were

And he wyst nat, on what manere,

Howe he myght hym shent. 473

A fals letter made the kynge

And made a messangere it brynge,

On the ryuer syde as they went, 476

To Torent, that was true as stele,

If he loued Dyssonell wele,

Gete hir a faucon gent. 479

The King

treacherously

asks Torrent to get
Desonell a Falcon

Torent the letter began to rede,

The kynge came nere and lystened,

As thoughe he it neuer had sene. 482

The kynge sayde, 'what may this be?'

'Lorde, it is sent to me

For a faucon shene; 485

I ne wote, so God me spede,
In what londe that they brede.'

The kynge sayde, 'as I herde sayne, 488

.
.

In the forest of Maudelayne 491

from the Forest of
Magdalen.

2. TORRENT GOES TO THE FOREST OF MAUDELAYNE.

II. [2](#)

Than sayde [the] kyn[g] vntrue, 492
'And ye fynde haw[k]es of great value,

Brynge me one with the!' 494

Torent sayd: 'so God me saue,
Yf it betyde, that I any haue,

At your wyll shall they be.' 497

Torrent agrees to do it.

To his squyer bade he thare,
After his armour to fare,

In the felde abode he; 500

They armed hym in his wede,
He bestrode a noble stede

He rides

. 503

Torent toke the way agayne
Unto the forest of Maudelayne,

to the Forest of
Magdalen,

In a wylsome way; 506

Berys and apes there founde he
And wylde bestys great plente

And lyons, where they lay. 509

In a wode, that is tyght,
It drewe towarde the nyght.

By dymmynge of the day 512

Lysten, lordes, of them came wo,
He and his squyer departed in two,
Carefull men then were they. 515

gets separated from his
Squire,

At a shedyng of a rome
 Eyther departed other frome,
 As I vnderstande. 518
 Torent taketh a dolefull way
 Downe into a depe valay,
 521

3. TORRENT IS TO FIGHT THE CALABRIAN GIANT, SLOGUS.

III. [3](#)

[*The King of Portugal sends Torrent to be kild by
 the Giant Slogus.*]

. 819
 And the good squyres after h[ym],
 That knyghtes sholde be. 821
 As they were a-myddes theyr . . .
 The kynge wolde not forgete,
 To Torente than sayd he, 824

 He sayd: ‘so god me saue,
 Fayne thou woldest my dough[ter haue],
 Thou hast loued her many a d[aye].’ 827
 ‘Ye, by my trouthe,’ sayd Torente,
 ‘And I were a ryche man,
 Ryght gladly by my faye.’ 830
 ‘If thou durst for her sake
 A poynte of armes vndertake,
 Thou broke her vp for ay.’ 833

 ‘Ye,’ sayde he, ‘or I go,
 Sykernes thou make me so
 Of thy doughter hende. 836
 Ye and after all my rygthes
 By VII score of hardy knyghtes’
 Al they were Torentes frende. 839
 ‘Now, good lordes, I you praye,

Torrent sits at the head
 of a side table.

The King asks Torrent i
 he’ll

do a deed of arms for
 Desonell.

‘Yes,’ says Torrent.

Bere wytnes of this day
 Agayne yf god me sende!’ 842

Torente sayd, ‘so may I the,
 Wyst I, where my journey shold [be],
 Thyder I wolde me dyghte.’ 845

The kyng gaue hym an sw[e]re,
 ‘In the londe of Caleb[e]re
 There wonneth a gyaunte wygh[h]te] 848

.

Slogus he hyght as I the tolde,
 God sende the that waye ryghte!’ 851

‘Then go to Calabria,

and fight the Giant
 Slogus.’

4. TORRENT WILL NOT GIVE UP HIS GIANT-FIGHT.

IV. 4

[*Torrent is offerd a Princess of Provyns.*]

.

.

For why I wyll the saye, 917

Moche folke of that countre
 Cometh heder for socoure to me,
 Bothe by nyghte and by daye. 920

There is a gyaunte of grete renowne,
 He destroyeth bothe cyte and towne
 And all that he may. 923

As bokes of rome tell,
 He was goten with the deuyll of hell,
 As his moder slepyng lay.’ 926

The kynge sayde, ‘by Saynt Adryan,
 I rede, a nother gentylman
 Be there and haue the degre. 929

I haue a doughter, that me is dere,
 Thou shalte wedde her to thy fere,
 And yf it thy wyll be, 932

The king of Provyns
 warns

him against the terrible
 Giant there,

and offers him his
 Daughter and 2

Two duchyes in honde
 I wyll gyue her in londe.'
 'Gramercy, syr,' sayd he, 935
 'With my tonge I haue so wrought,
 To breke my day wyll I nought,
 Nedes me behoueth there to be.' 938
 'On Goddes name,' the kyng gan sayne,
 'Iesu brynge the saffe agayne,
 Lorde, moche of myght!' 941
 Mynstralsy was them amonge,
 With harpe, fedyll and songe,
 Delycyous notes on hygh[t]e. 944
 Whan it was tyme, to bed they wente,
 And on the morowe rose Torent
 And toke leue of kyng and knyght 947
 And toke a redy way.

Duchies.

Torrent says he must
 keep his troth.

Torrent starts,

5. TORRENT HEARS OF THE CALABRIAN GIANT, SLOGUS.

Fragment V. [5](#)

By the se syde as it lay,
 God sende hym gatys ryght! 950
 An hye waye hath he nome,
 Into Calabre is he come
 Within two dayes or thre. 953
 So he met folke hym agayne,
 Fast comynge with carte and wayne
 Frowarde the se. 956
 'Dere God,' sayd Torent now,
 'Good folke, what eyleth you,
 That ye thus fast fle?' 959
 'There lyeth a gyaunte here besyde,
 For all this londe brode and wyde
 No man on lyue leueth he.' 962

reaches Calabria,

and hears of the Giant.

‘Dere God,’ sayd Torente then,
‘Wher euer be that fendes den?’

They answered hym anone: 965

‘In a castell in the see,
Slogus’ they sayd ‘hyght he,

Many a man he hath slone. 968

We wote full well, where he doth ly
Byfore the cyte of Hungry,’

. 971

The Giant Slogus is in
Hungary.

6. TORRENT FIGHTS A GIANT. DESONELL HAS TWINS.

VI. 6

[*Torrent fights the Giant.*]

The number and configuration of dots corresponds as closely as possible to the printed book.

. all the wrynge, 1014

. lyng

. thou the 1016

. he toke,

. bare a croke

. te longe and thre 1019

. ever so longe were

. had no fere

. yd darste thou come nere 1022

. nte nolengre a-byde

. nte wolde he ryde

. ghte. 1025

. one eye but one,

. neuer none,

. nor by nyght. 1028

. lpe of god of heuen,

The giant says he’ll
wring Torrent’s nose.

His Crook is 13 ft. long

Torrent charges,

. . . . herin euen,
. 1031
. . . . gan to rore,
. . . . the cyte wore,
. . . . ay. 1034
. . . . es eyen were oute
. bote
. 1037

pierces the Giant's eye,

and makes him roar.

7. DESONELL AND HER TWINS ARE SENT TO SEA.

VII. [7](#)

[Desonell bears twins. All are sent out to sea. They reach land.]

Thus the lady dwelled there, 1807
Tyll that she delyuered were
Of men chyldren two. 1809
Of all poyntes were they gent,
Lyke were they to Sir Torent,
For his loue suffred they wo. 1812
The kynge sayd, 'so mote I the,
Thou shalt into the se
Without wordes mo. 1815
Every kynges doughter fer and nere
At the they shall lere,
Agaynst right to do!' 1818
Great ruthe it was to se,
Whan they led that lady fre
Out of hir faders lande. 1821
The quene, hir moder, was nere wode
For hir doughter, that gentyll fode,
Knyghtes stode wepynge. [8](#) 1824

Desonell is delivered of
2 male children

like Torrent.

Her Father says she
shall be sent out to sea.

She is led from his land

The Queen bewails her
daughter's fate.

A clothe of sylke toke they tho,
And departed it bytwene the chyldren two,

Therin they were wonde. 1827
Whan they had shypped that gentyll thyng,
Anone she fell in swownynge
At Peron on the sonde. 1830
Whan that lady was downe fall,
On Iesu Cryste dyd she call.
To defende hir with his honde: 1833

Desonell is sent to sea.

‘Rightfull God, ye me sende
Some good londe on to lende,
That my chyldren may crystened be[n].’ 1836
She sayd, ‘ladyes fayre and gent,
Great well my lorde Sir Torent,
Yf euer ye hym se[n]!’ 1839
The wynde arose on the myght,
Fro the londe it blewe that lady bryght
Into the se so grene. 1842

She prays to Christ for
her children.

7. DESONELL AND HER TWINS REACH LAND.

Wyndes and weders hathe hir dryuen,
That in a forest she is aryuen,
Where wylde bestys were. 1845
The se was ebbe and went hem fro
And left hir and hir chyldren two
[Alo]ne without any fere. 1848
Hir one chylde began to wepe,
The lady awoke out of hir slepe
And sayde, ‘be styll, my dere, 1851
Ihesu Cryste hathe sent vs lande,
Yf there be any Crysten man at hande,
We shall haue socoure here.’ 1854
The carefull lady then was blythe,
To the londe she went full swythe,
As fast as she myght. 1857
Tyll the day began to sprynge,

Desonell and her twin
babes reach land.

She stills her crying
child,

Foules on trees merely gan synge
Delicious notes on hyght. 1860
To a hyll went that lady fre,
Where she was ware of a cyte
With toures fayre and bryght. 1863
Therof I-wys she was fayne,
She set hir downe, as I herd sayne,
Hir chyl dren for to dyght. 1866

goes up a mountain,

and sits down.

Footnotes to Fragments

- [1.](#) In Halliwell's edition III.
 - [2.](#) In Halliwell's edition II.
 - [3.](#) In Halliwell's edition VI.
 - [4.](#) In Halliwell's edition V.
 - [5.](#) In Halliwell's edition IV.
 - [6.](#) Printed in *Englische Studien*, VII. p. 347 f.
 - [7.](#) In Halliwell's edition I.
 - [8.](#) wepande.
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NOTES.

[St. 1](#)

PAGE 1, [line 12](#). Cf. [ll. 118](#), [187](#), [190](#), [198](#), [558](#), [924](#), [1924](#), [2183](#). So in *Eglamour* (Thornton Romances), l. 408:

‘The boke of Rome thus can telle,’

and *The Erl of Tolouse*, ed. Lüdtke, l. 1219:

‘Yn Rome thys geste cronyculyd ys.’

See Halliwell's and Lüdtke's notes to these passages. I agree with both of them, that an expression like that does not earnestly refer the reader to a Latin or Italian source of the story; there is evidently no difference at all between *in Rome* and *in romance*.

St. 2

p. 1, [l. 15](#). *wyght* has been inserted instead of *dowghtty* in order to restore the rhyme with *hyght*, *knyght*, *myght*; cf. *Havelok*, ed. Skeat, l. 344:

‘He was fayr man and wicth.’

p. 1, [l. 17](#) = *Ipomadon*, l. 63. Parallel passages to this hyperbolic expression are collected in Kölbing's note to this line (p. 364).

p. 1, [l. 24](#). We find the same idea as here, viz. that nobody can resist the will of God, who has power over death and life, in *Sir Tristrem*, ll. 236 ff.:

‘Þat leuedi, nouȝt to lain,
For soþe ded is sche!
Who may be ogain?
As god wil, it schal be,
Vnbliþe.’

St. 3

p. 2, [l. 28](#). I have not met with the verb *fesommen* anywhere else, and it is not mentioned in Stratmann and Mätzner. Halliwell, Dictionary, p. 354, explains it by ‘feoffed, gave in fee,’ doubtless regarding this very passage, although he doesn't cite it; might *fesomnyd* not be a corruption from *sesyd*? cf. *Havelok*, ll. 250 f.:

‘Þat he ne dede al Engeland
Sone sayse intil his hond.’

Hall writes to me on this word as follows: *fesomnyd* is, I am convinced, not a word at all, but a scribe's error for *festonyd* or *festnyd* = confirmed, fixed. Comp. ‘And þat ich hym wolde myd trewþe siker faste on honde,’ Robert of Gloucester (Hearne), p. 150. For this use of *fasten*, *fastnen*, comp. ‘But my forwarde with þe I festen on þis wyse,’ Alliterative Poems, p. 47, l. 327: ‘&

folden fayth to þat fre, festned so harde,’ Sir Gawayne, p. 57, l. 1783: ‘*And þis forward, in faith, I festyn with hond,*’ Destruction of Troy, p. 22, l. 636. See also Jamieson’s Scottish Dictionary, ii. p. 216, under *to Fest*.

p. 2, [l. 30](#). I am by no means sure that *fede* is the original reading, but I wasn’t able to find a better word rhyming with *dedde*, *wede*; even the *ne*. ‘feed’ means *pasture*, and that is what we expect here.

p. 2, [l. 31](#). For my correction cf. Lüdtke’s note to *The Erl of Tolouse*, l. 199, sub 2; *Eglam.*, l. 26:

‘That was a maydyn as whyte as fome,’

Ib. l. 683:

‘Crystyabelle as whyte as fome,’

where the *Percy Folio MS.* reads:

‘Christabell that was as faire as sunn;’

Chronicle of England, l. 75 f.:

‘Ant nomeliche to thy lemmon,
That ys wyttore then the fom.’

[St. 5](#)

p. 2, [l. 50](#). The alteration of *And* and *bee* into *An* and *see* seemed necessary; *sayment* is like Fr. *essaïement*, Lat. *exagimentum*.

p. 3, [l. 59](#). Cf. [l. 1216 f.](#) and *The Lyfe of Ipomydon*, ed. Kölbing, l. 1795:

‘If thou hyr haue, thou shalt hyr bye.’

[St. 7](#)

p. 3, [l. 77 f.](#) As half of the stanza is lost, it is impossible to make out to whom *they* refers. Nor do I believe that [l. 78](#) is correct, especially as to *chaunce*.

[St. 8](#)

p. 3, [l. 79](#). Cf. *Ipomadon*, ed. Kölbing, l. 8123:

‘A myle wyth in the Grekes see.’

p. 3, [l. 80](#). *in an yle* is certainly the correct reading; *mauyle* was introduced by a scribe who supposed it to be the giant’s name; but that is mentioned some twenty lines later.

St. 13

p. 5, [l. 136](#). The correction of *lyght* into *ryght* I owe to Hall, who refers me to the legend of *Sancta Maria Egyptiaca*; cf. f. i. Barbour’s *Legends of Saints*, ed. Horstmann, I. p. 143 ff.

St. 14

p. 6, [l. 153](#). *nowyd* = ‘anoyed’ gives a poor sense. Hall suggests *nowtyd*; cf. E. D. S., No. 6, Ray’s *North Country Words*, p. 59, *note*, to push, strike or soar, with the horn, as a bull or ram,’ ab. A.S. *huitan*, ejusdem significationis. The word might then mean ‘spurred.’

St. 16

p. 6, [l. 171](#) = [l. 596](#). This alliterative binding is a very frequent one; cf. *Sir Orfeo*, ed. Zielke, p. 9.

St. 17

p. 7, [l. 188](#). The same rhyme, which I have restored here, occurs [l. 559 f.](#)

p. 7, [l. 190](#). *Yt tellythe* = *Yt is told*; cf. Lüdtkke, note to *The Erl of Tolouse*, l. 1070, and Sarrazin, note to *Octavian*, l. 1749.

St. 22

p. 9, [l. 236](#). I was about to write, *Crystyn men thow they were*, referring this line to the guardians of the lions; but, no doubt, Hall’s reconstruction of the line, which I have put into the text, is far better.

p. 9, [l. 237](#). *Hys browys wexe bla*, i.e. he turned pale, he was struck with fear; cf. *bloo askes*, P. Pl., l. 1553, and the German *aschfahl*. Quite a similar expression occurs in *Perceval*, l. 687 f.:

‘Now sone of that salle wee see,
Whose browes schalle blakke.’

Ib. l. 1056:

‘His browes to blake.’

St. 23

p. 9, [l. 245](#). Though *syghyng* gives no offence, still it may be, that the author has written *syngyng*, and the scribe was wrong in altering it; cf. Zupitza’s note to *Guy*, l. 5424.

p. 9, [l. 251](#). Cf. [l. 802](#), [1204](#), *Ipomadon*, l. 6481 f.:

‘Your nece of Calabyre, that lady clere,
Ys bovnden wyth a fendes fere.’

Reliquiæ Antiquæ, i. p. 241:

‘He seith bi nizte and eke bi day,
That hy beth fendes ifere.’

St. 25

p. 10, [l. 265 f.](#) The reading of these two lines is quite destroyed by the careless scribe. My correction is not more than an attempt to restore the rhyme.

St. 26

p. 10, [l. 277 ff.](#) There is nothing in Torrent’s words which could lead the princess to a conclusion like that. I think that after [l. 276](#) one stanza is wanting.

p. 11, [l. 286-8](#). As to the contents of these lines, Kölbing refers me to *Englische studien*, vol. IV. p. 133 f., where F. Liebrecht mentions a passage in *Sir Beves of Hamtoun*, according to which a king’s daughter,—if she is a pure virgin,—can never be hurt by a lion. Here we have another proof for this remarkable bit of folk-lore.

St. 27

p. 11, [l. 292](#) = [l. 329](#).

St. 28

p. 11, [l. 303](#) = [l. 342](#).

p. 11, [l. 305](#). I am not quite sure whether I was right in substituting the prince's name—which is mentioned once more, the first time, as it were, [l. 341](#)—for the name of his father's kingdom; but I didn't see any other way of restoring the rhyme.

p. 12, [l. 311](#). Cf. [l. 469](#) and Skeat's note to *Sir Thopas*, l. 1927.

St. 30

p. 12, [l. 334](#). Instead of *he* I should prefer to read *they*: Torrent has just admonished the prisoners to cheer up.

St. 31

p. 13, [l. 344](#). There must be something wrong in this line, because the name of the third Earl's son is missing; to write *the third* instead of *of* may not suffice to put the text right; even the names *Torren* and *Berweyne* seem to me very suspicious.

St. 34

p. 14, [l. 379](#). Cf. *Ipomadon*, l. 4245, for *Crystys dede*; *Crystys* was substituted by Kölbing for *mannes*, which is clearly wrong; he could as well have chosen *godes*.

St. 35

p. 15, [l. 393 ff.](#) Cf. Kölbing's note to *Tristrem*, l. 736.

St. 38

p. 16, [l. 427](#). Of this allusion to Veland, Halliwell treats in his edition of *Sir Torrent*, p. vii f. Cf. Zupitza, *Ein zeugnis für die Wieland-sage*, *Zeitschrift für deutsches Alterthum*, Vol. XIX, p. 129 f.

p. 16, [l. 429-31](#). The line which follows l. 429 in the MS. is superfluous; it damages the metre; and the rhyme with l. 430 won't do. The old king wishes to say; 'I have seen the day when, if this sword wielded by me fell on any one, he was considered done for, doomed to death.' Therefore l. 431, *I fawght therfor I told* has been corrected into *Fawe they were I-told*. The scribe did not understand the obsolescent word *fawe* or *faye*, so he wrote the nearest word to it to make sense, *I-told* = 'held, considered.'—[I. Hall](#).

[St. 41](#)

p. 17, [l. 458](#). Cf. Breul's note to *Sir Gowther*, l. 410.

p. 17, [l. 465](#). Cf. [l. 2061 f.](#)

[St. 48](#)

p. 20, [l. 542](#). The scribe, who evidently didn't know the pretty rare word *clow*, has spoilt it to *colod*, or *colvd*; the same rhyme, *clou3*, *drou3*, *anou3* occurs in *Sir Tristrem*, l. 1761 ff. Nor did the scribe know the word *swowe* = 'noise,' and changed it to *swayne*; cf. Hall. Dict., p. 843: *He come to him with a swowe*.

p. 20, [l. 543](#). *Of and on*, off and on, intermittently.

[St. 49](#)

p. 21, [l. 555](#). *schyld* is not to the point here, Torrent having only his sword at hand. The scribe has forgotten what he has said himself, [l. 526](#) and [549](#); cf. [l. 652](#).

[St. 51](#)

p. 21, [l. 582-4](#). We meet with this description twice more in the poem, [ll. 1514-16](#), and [ll. 1858-60](#).

[St. 56](#)

p. 23, [l. 640](#). On the meaning of *theff*, cf. Kölbing's note to *Am. and Amil.*, l. 787.

St. 58

p. 24, [l. 659](#). *of Perowne* is certainly wrong, as it does not agree with the rhymes *stere*, *nere*, *fere*; but I don't know how to amend the line.

p. 24, [l. 662](#). *schere* gives no meaning; I write *stere* and translate, There might nobody move further, *i.e.* the giant was brought to a standstill in the glen.

p. 24, [l. 665](#). Cf. [ll. 434](#), [791](#).

St. 60

p. 25, [l. 688](#). Cf. *Eglam.*, l. 324:

‘And to [the] herte hym bare.’

The weak preterit tense of *berien* is very rare; if *bere* = A.S. *beran* sometimes has the same meaning, *i.e.* ‘to strike,’ the reason is that A.S. *beran* and Icel. *berja* are confounded.

St. 61

p. 25, [l. 696](#). *woo* can hardly stand for *wood*. It seems to me like a last corruption of an old romance phrase, like *worthy inwith wall* (*woze*); possibly the line was simply so: *Thus in II journeys Torrent so*.—Hall.

p. 25, [l. 700](#). On the use of M.E. *fote* as a plural see Zupitza's note to *Guy*, l. 598.

St. 63

p. 26, [l. 722](#). Hall suggests, the original phrase may have been: *pomely whyt and grey*; cf. Chaucer, *C. T.*, Prol., l. 615 f.:

‘This reeve sat vpon a ful good stot,
That was al *pomely gray*, and highte Scot.’

St. 65

p. 27, [l. 744](#). Cf. [l. 788](#). On *St. James* cf. Kölbing's note to *Am. and Amil.*, l. 796.

St. 70

p. 29, [l. 808 f.](#) 'In so dangerous conditions he has been before [and still come back safe], so he will come back even this time.'

St. 71

p. 29, [l. 819](#). On the meaning of the phrase '*the bord beginne*,' cf. Kölbing, *Englische studien*, III. p. 104, and Zupitza, *Anglia*, III. p. 370 f.

St. 73

p. 30, [l. 838](#). This stanza being incomplete, I think, the lacuna is to be put after l. 838. The missing three lines contained the fact, that the king promises Torrent, before his knights, that, when he has done this deed, he will give him his daughter, and grant him one half of his kingdom during his life, and the whole afterwards; cf. [l. 1206 ff.](#) The odd number of XXVII knights is probably due only to the scribe; cf. [F. III](#): *By VII score of hardy knyghtes*.

St. 76

p. 31, [l. 867 f.](#) These two lines are poor, and the rhyme is very bad; l. 868 may have run originally, *Thurrow Pervyns, for sothe, it ley*; cf. [l. 949](#).

St. 78

p. 32, [l. 901](#). *squyere*, although very odd at the first sight, may still be right; Torrent says: 'The only squier that I took with me for this journey, is my sword'; cf. [l. 909](#).

St. 80

p. 33, [l. 922](#). Cf. Kölbing's note to *Ipomadon*, l. 3344.

p. 33, [l. 924-6](#). On the story of a child, begotten by a devil on a sleeping woman, cf. Breul, *Sir Gowther*, p. 119 f.

St. 83

p. 34, [l. 954 ff.](#) Cf. *Tristrem*, l. 1409 ff.:

‘Out of Deuelin toun
þe folk wel fast ran,
In a water to droun,
So ferd were þai þan.’

St. 84

p. 34, [l. 963 f.](#) Cf. *Beves of Hamtoun*, l. 187 f.:

‘Madame, a seide, for loue myn,
Whar mai ich finde þat wilde swin?’

St. 87

p. 36, [l. 1000](#). Instead of *spere* perhaps we ought to read *sworde*.

St. 89

p. 37, [l. 1030 f.](#) If we compare the rests of these lines in [E. VI.](#), this reading or a similar one is to be expected. The reading of l. 1029 ff. in the fragments may be completed so: *[Thourgh the he]lpe of god of heuen Thorough ye and] herin euen God send the spere the right way.*

p. 36, [l. 1033 f.](#) Cf. [ll. 1166](#), [2468 f.](#), and Kölbing’s note to *Sir Tristrem*, l. 69 f.

St. 92

p. 38, [l. 1070](#). ‘I came hither to seek my death,’ *i.e.* this expedition was so dangerous, that I expected to die.

St. 93

p. 38, [l. 1076](#). Cf. *Ipomadon*, l. 239 f.:

‘Tyll vncovth contreys will I wende,
The maner wille I see.’

p. 39, [l. 1081](#). *is* was to be corrected into *it*: ‘Because you slew him that possessed it.’

[St. 94](#)

p. 39, [l. 1086](#). This line, according to Hall’s emendation, means: You owe no homage or feudal due, the manor is yours and your heirs’ for ever; *i.e.* the manor is in fee simple, and free from any feudal obligation.

[St. 95](#)

p. 39, [st. 95](#). The text would be improved by putting [ll. 1104-6](#) before 1101-3, although this transposition is not absolutely necessary.

p. 39, [l. 1105](#). *lefte* may be a mistake for *lost*; cf. *Gower*, I. 207:

‘Contenaunce for a þrowe
He loste.’

[St. 96](#)

p. 40, [l. 1117](#). Cf. Ritson’s *Met. Rom.*, III. p. 341 f., and Zupitza’s note to *Guy*, l. 436.

[St. 97](#)

p. 40, [l. 1121](#). *he bare* looks rather suspicious, but it is supported by [l. 2169](#). The author is about to describe the figures inlaid on the shield. Cf. *Eglamour*, l. 1030 f.:

‘*He bare* in azure [1](#) a grype of golde,
Rychely beton on the molde.’

p. 40, [l. 1124](#). This line is hopelessly spoilt; the scribe, careless as he was, has almost literally repeated [l. 1121](#); l. 1125 directly continues the description begun before.

[St. 98](#)

p. 40, [l. 1132](#). Is *than I haue in tale* right? We expect rather: *than I can telle in tale*.

p. 41, [l. 1138 f.](#) Cf. [l. 1587 f.](#)

[St. 99](#)

p. 41, [l. 1143](#). I thought it necessary to insert *mete*, although Mätzner, *Wörterbuch*, II. p. 274, cites this line as the only instance in the M.E. literature for *glad* as a substantive. But even the sense is very poor without this addition.

p. 41, [l. 1144](#). As to a man riding into the hall, cf. Skeat's note to Chaucer's *Squire's Tale*, l. 80, and Kölbing's note to *Ipomadon*, l. 6253 f.

p. 41, [l. 1150 f.](#) I hope my alterations in l. 1151 are right. It cannot be said that the King of Aragon defends the lady unless somebody has laid claims to her. Torrent wants either three combats or the lady, quite a regular occurrence in mediæval romances.

[St. 100](#)

p. 41, [l. 1154](#). *none*, i.e. *no lady*.

p. 41, [l. 1160](#). Cf. Kölbing's note to *Tristrem*, l. 138.

[St. 101](#)

p. 41, [l. 1165](#). *the gres*, which word is here required by the rhyme, is, in the same way as in this passage, used for 'battle-field,' in *Perceval*, l. 1225 f.:

‘Hedes and helmys ther was,
I telle 3ow withowttene lese,
Many layde *one the gresse*,
And many brode schelde.’

[St. 102](#)

p. 42, [l. 1181](#). *For tynding of his hand* = for fear of (= *for*) the beating (blows) of his hand. Schoolboy slang still keeps the word '*to tund*' = to beat with something flat.—HALL.

St. 103

p. 42, [l. 1193](#). On this expression Skeat treats in *Notes to P. Pl.*, p. 3987, to which note I refer the reader. Cf. *Li B. Disc.*, [l. 130 f.](#) (Ritson, *Rom.* II. p. 6):

‘Hys schon wer with gold ydyght
And *kopeth* as a knyght.’

p. 43, [l. 1198 f.](#): ‘None of them said a single word, But that Torrent had been right to do so as he had done.’

St. 104

p. 43, [l. 1211](#). There is an evident contradiction between this line and [l. 1199](#). I suppose the word *waried* to be wrong; but I am not able to give a fairly certain emendation of it.

St. 106

p. 44, [l. 1228 f.](#): ‘The king had supposed he was dead, and, indeed, foolhardy he was to undertake an adventure like this.’

St. 109

p. 45, [l. 1268 f.](#) This fight between the giant Cate and Torrent reminds us in some points of the combat between Guy and Colbrond. Like the old northern *holmganga*, both fights take place on an island, and in both cases the giant declines to sit on horseback, because he is too heavy; cf. *Guy of Warwike*, Edinburgh, 1840, l. 9940 ff.:

‘When pai had sworn and ostage founde,
Colbrond stirt vp in þat stounde,
To fiȝt he was ful felle.
He was so michel and so vnrede,
That no hors miȝt him lede,
In gest as y you telle.
So mani he hadde of armes gere,
Vnneþe a cart miȝt hem bere,
þe Inglisse for to quelle.’

p. 45, [l. 1270](#). *he* instead of *him* is remarkable; this personal construction, provided that it is right, would offer an analogue to *I am wo* instead of *me is wo*; cf. Kölbing's note to *Tristrem*, l. 245.

p. 45, [l. 1271](#) = [l. 1546](#).

[St. 113](#)

p. 46, [l. 1307](#). This line ought probably to run thus:

'*Sir Torent praid, as was his wonne.*'

[St. 115](#)

p. 47, [l. 1337 f.](#) This is SAINT *Nycholas de Barr*, not sir N., as the copyist has put. He was hardly a cleric, or he would have known the Boy Bishop. An English reference for S. Nicholas is Alban Butler, *Lives of the Fathers, Martyrs, etc.*, vol. vii. p. 989, Dublin, 1833. His day is Dec. 6th, consequently he is not in *Acta Sanctorum*; see besides *Altenglische legenden, Neue folge*, ed. Horstmann, Heilbronn, 1881, p. 11-16, and Barbour's *Legendensammlung*, ed. Horstmann, I. p. 229-245. *Barr* is *Bari* in Italy, and Barbour, I. p. 238, l. 601 f., knew it was two syllables (cf. the rhyme *pame be: Barre*). Nicholas was the patron of sailors, and churches on the sea-coast in all parts of Europe were dedicated to him. Now as Sir Torrent had been in peril at sea, he offers to him. It was customary to offer garments at such shrines. See Hampson, *Medii Ævi Kalendarium*, I. p. 72. Hence I propose for l. 1338: *A grett Erldome and a simarr. Simarr* is not a common word, which makes it all the more probable here, since the uncommon words are those which are corrupted and lost. See *Prompt. Parv.*, I. p. 75: '*chymer, abella*,' that is 'abolla, cloak.' M.E. *simar*, Fr. *simarre*.—HALL. I have not hesitated for a moment to introduce this sagacious conjecture into the text; also the correction of *redith* into *tas* I owe to Mr. Hall.

[St. 116](#)

p. 48, [l. 1353](#). Cf. Kölbing's note to *Sir Tristrem*, l. 2508.

St. 117

p. 48, [l. 1364](#). We ought probably to read *she* instead of *he*.

St. 118

p. 48, [l. 1367 f.](#) Cf. [l. 1756 f.](#)

p. 48, [l. 1378](#). Cf. *Sir Tristrem*, l. 2458:

‘Bi holtes and bi hille.’

St. 119

p. 49, [l. 1385 ff.](#) Here he addresses the King of Portugal. In l. 1385 *the* is superfluous, and should perhaps be struck out.

St. 120

p. 49, [l. 1395](#). *fend* = *defend*; cf. Zupitza’s note to *Guy*, l. 576.

St. 124

p. 51, [l. 1443 f.](#) As the existence of *fede* = *fode*, ‘fellow’ is proved by no other passage, we ought perhaps to write *As spede me god: ffode*, or *As g. me save: knave*, instead of *As god me spede: ffede*.

p. 51, [l. 1445](#). The alteration of *fleand*, which is absurd here, into *failand* is supported by [l. 1280](#).

p. 51, [l. 1446](#). As to *make* instead of *made*, cf. [l. 332](#).

St. 126

p. 51, [l. 1463](#). Cf. [l. 2090 f.](#) I am afraid neither of these passages is quite right.

St. 131

p. 53, [l. 1518](#). Perhaps we ought to read:

‘And out of the valey he hyd swith.’

St. 132

p. 54, [l. 1531](#). I don't believe that the poet used the word *tree* thrice within these four lines; perhaps he wrote for l. 1531: *Shold not drawe it, parde*.

St. 134

p. 54, [l. 1551](#). Cf. Guy, ed. Zupitza, l. 5430:

‘To reste per horsys a lytull wyght,’

and Zupitza's note to l. 419.

St. 135

p. 55, [l. 1570](#). Cf. Stratmann's note to *Havelok*, l. 1129 (*Englische studien*, I. p. 424).

St. 137

p. 56, [l. 1592](#). *To the I haue full good gate* means, ‘I am fully entitled to kill you.’ I don't recollect to have met with any parallel passage.

St. 138

p. 56, [l. 1600](#). That *dynt* is wrong, the rhyme shows as well as the meaning. But whether my alteration is right, seems very doubtful, especially as [l. 1609](#) offers the same rhyming word.

St. 142

p. 58, [st. 142](#). Rhymes like *dight*, *be-taught*, *draught*, *right* can by no means be admitted. Now, instead of *be-taught* we may be allowed to write *be-teichte* (cf. *Beket*, l. 1827), and [l. 1654](#) may have run:

‘He wold haue a draught, apleight.’

St. 144

p. 59, [l. 1676](#). After *was*, *sent* may have been dropped.

St. 145

p. 59, [l. 1692](#). *For his love*, i.e. ‘As his sweetheart.’

St. 148

p. 60, [l. 1714](#). Cf. *Ipomadon*, l. 52:

‘Begge he wex of bonne and blode.’

Ib. l. 1763:

‘Ryghtte bygge of bone and blode.’

p. 60, [l. 1722](#): ‘All his men agreed with him,’ viz. that this was the knight whom he came to seek.

St. 152

p. 62, [l. 1774](#). Is *her day* = A.S. *aerdagas*, cf. *Havelok*, l. 27? The word is very rare, and in this meaning occurs only in the plural.

p. 62, [l. 1777](#). After *king*, *on kne* may have dropped out.

St. 155

p. 63, [l. 1799](#). Cf. Chaucer, *C. T.*, the Millere’s Tale, l. 325:

‘Say what thou wolt, I schal it never telle
To child no wyf, by him that harwed helle.’

Ib., The Sompnoure’s Tale, l. 407:

‘Now help, Thomas, for him that harewed helle.’

Perhaps even here, [l. 1702](#), *Iesu, that made hell*, ought to be altered into *I. that harowde hell*.

St. 159

p. 64, [l. 1846](#). Perhaps we ought to read *ebbyng* instead of *eb*, according to [l. 223](#); one can hardly say, that ‘the sea is eb.’

St. 169

p. 68, [l. 1961](#). Instead of A I should prefer to read *The*, because this griffon is the same which robbed the child before.

St. 171

p. 69, [l. 1982](#). *Of what lond that he is left*, i.e. 'Wherever he may be born.'

St. 172

p. 69, [l. 1991 f.](#) Cf. *Ipomadon*, l. 50 f.:

'He sayd: Fro tyme he kepe tham con,
My landes I shall hym take.'

St. 173

p. 70, [l. 2002](#). *It is good in euery fight*, i.e. there is a stone in the ring which heals wounds, if they are touched with it; cf. Kölbing's note to *Ipomadon*, l. 8018.

p. 70, [l. 2010](#). Halliwell, p. 306, explains *disparlid* by 'beaten down, destroyed,' a meaning which is not fit for this passage. I read with a slight addition *disparplid* = 'dispersed,' a rare word; cf. *Stratmann*, p. 156.

St. 175

p. 71, [l. 2026](#). *But* is probably to be altered into *And*.

St. 178

p. 72, [l. 2053](#). Cf. Kölbing's note to *Tristrem*, l. 3068.

St. 180

p. 72, [l. 2075](#). One might be inclined to write:

'That my two children vncrystonyd ware,'

but I don't think that we are obliged to change: 'I cared only for that one thing, That my two children might be christened.'

St. 184

p. 74, [l. 2126](#). For *hing* instead of *heng* cf. Mätzner, *Sprachproben*, I. 1, p. 292, note to line 675, where *hynges* rhymes with *springes*.

St. 185

p. 74, [l. 2135](#). *hede vale*, i.e. principal, best choice; *vale* = *wale*, or perhaps aphetic for *avale* = value.—HALL.

p. 74, [l. 2138](#). *born* seems to me somewhat suspicious, though I cannot propose a better reading; *and torn* instead of *born* wouldn't do.

St. 186

p. 75, [l. 2152](#). The imperfect rhyme shows that there is something wrong in this line; it may be restored thus:

‘Loo, lordys good and hende.’

p. 75, [l. 2153](#). *wyll haue* has probably been inserted here from the following line; we ought to read *has*.

St. 187

p. 75, [l. 2157](#). *Season for to hold*, i.e. ‘in order to hold court.’ But I don't know another instance of *season* with this meaning.

St. 188

p. 76, [l. 2174](#). This line involves a contradiction to [l. 2158 f.](#)

St. 189

p. 76, [l. 2185](#). *smote* means the same as *caste*; cf. *King Horn*, ed. Wissmann, l. 1038:

‘And ankere gunne caste.’

The only question is, whether *ankere* is allowed to be supplied or must be added; cf. [l. 2203](#).

St. 191

p. 77, [l. 2209-2214](#). The Sultan informs Torrent by messengers, that the inhabitants of the town are starving, evidently appealing to his generosity. Torrent answers him, that if they will lie here, *i.e.* leave the town, they are to have victuals enough. But the Sultan doesn't accept this condition, and so the siege is continued. That seems to me to be the meaning of this half of the stanza.

St. 192

p. 77, [l. 2216 f.](#) *dede* means here, and [l. 2400](#), 'exploit, battle.' In the same way Saber, Beves's uncle, once a year on a certain day fights against the Emperor; cf. *Sir Beues*, l. 2917 ff.:

'& eueri 3er on a dai certaine
Vpon þemperur of Almaine
He ginneþ gret bataile take,
Beues, al for þine sake.'

It agrees very well with the religious feelings of the Middle Ages, when they thought it a merit to fight against the heathens on Good Friday; cf. here [l. 2230 ff.](#)

p. 77, [l. 2224 ff.](#) I am afraid there is something wrong in these lines; the copyist seems to mean, that Torrent didn't bereave the inhabitants of their worldly goods, their treasures; then we must write *them* for *it*. But what we really expect here is, that he leaves in the town some trustworthy men to keep it. Accordingly, the fault lies in *Worldely goodis*. Besides, l. 2224, *did wyn*, instead of *was yn*, would improve the rhyme.

St. 193

p. 77, [l. 2232](#). *bryght* is a rather odd epithet to *Sar3ins*.

p. 78, [l. 2233 ff.](#) Fifteen years have past since Torrent began to fight against the infidels: he besieges the first town two years (cf. [l. 2189](#)), the second, six years (cf. [l. 2206](#)), the third, seven years (cf. [l. 2230](#)). Meanwhile, the education of a young man being finished at the age of fifteen (cf. Kölbing's

note to *Tristrem*, l. 287), his son had become just old enough to win his spurs.

St. 194

p. 78, [l. 2240](#). I doubt whether *ordeyn* can be allowed to stand without an object, such as *your folk*, or *your ships*; cf. *Robert of Glo'ster*, ed. Hearne, p. 139, l. 19:

‘He bigan to ordeyne ys folk, & to batail azen drow.’

St. 195

p. 78, [l. 2256](#): ‘Woebegone was she, that must see that,’ viz. that ‘le leopard took away her sone.’

St. 196

p. 78, [l. 2259 f.](#) The meaning of these two lines is not quite perspicuous, and they may be corrupt; only this one thing is clear, that these two knights are Torrent and his son, who belong to different parties.

St. 197

p. 79, [l. 2269 ff.](#) It may be that ll. 2269-71 and ll. 2272-74 are to be transposed, but I don't think it necessary: Torrent's men flee when they see that their chief has surrendered.

St. 199

p. 80, [l. 2302](#). *wekid* = wicked, mischievous. But I don't recollect to have met with this adj. as an epithet to *land* or *country*.

p. 80, [l. 2304](#). Cf. *Tristrem*, l. 88, Kölbing's note to that passage, and *York Plays*, p. 438, l. 155:

‘For, certys, my lyf days are nere done.’

St. 200

p. 80, [l. 2316](#). The alteration of this line is rather a radical one; but there was no other way to restore the rhyme; I think that first, *day* and *nyzt* had changed their places in line 2313, and then the copyist, in order to get a rhyme to *nyzt*, spoilt the latter line.

[St. 202](#)

p. 81, [l. 2335](#). *be my ffaye* and *parmaffay* in the same stanza, and both in the rhyme, are rather poor; one of these lines may have run thus:

‘Be god of heven, the king gan say.’

[St. 204](#)

p. 82, [l. 2357](#). The same confusion between *turment* and *turnament* occurs in *Ipomadon*, l. 2868; cf. Kölbing’s note to this line.

[St. 207](#)

p. 83, [l. 2392](#). Cf. *Ipomadon*, l. 3958:

‘A mercy, syr, for Crystes pitte,’

and Kölbing’s note to this line.

p. 83, [l. 2395 f.](#) Cf. Kölbing’s note to *Tristrem*, l. 3064, where he cites an interesting parallel passage to this line from *Guy of Warwick*, ed. Zupitza, l. 4707 f.:

‘Ȝyt þou art the trewest knyght,
That euer slepyd in wynturs nyght.’

[St. 208](#)

p. 83, [l. 2405](#). *and* is perhaps miswritten for *an* or *on*.

p. 83, [l. 2407](#). This line, as it stands, is rather odd; perhaps it ought to be identical with [l. 1128](#).

[St. 209](#)

p. 84, [l. 2420](#). *juster, jouter*, means here a knight who joins in a joust or tournament: in the only other passage where it is known to occur, *Alis.*, l. 1400, it is a horse for tourneying.

[St. 210](#)

p. 84, [l. 2433](#) = [l. 2456](#); cf. *Ipomadon*, l. 8830:

'Euery man in there degre.'

[St. 212](#)

p. 85, [l. 2450](#). On *roial*, cf. Kölbing's note to *Ipomadon*, l. 64. To a *roall ffyght* may be compared Shakespeare's *A royal battle* (*Rich. III.*, IV. iv.).

[St. 213](#)

p. 85, [l. 2461](#). *with oute lent* = 'without fasting'? I have not met with this expletive phrase anywhere else.

[St. 216](#)

p. 86, [l. 2493](#). It was not superfluous to mention this fact, because knights were very often killed in tournaments; cf. Niedner, *Das deutsche turnier im XII. und XIII. Jahrhundert*, Berlin, 1881, p. 24. See also R. Brunne's *Handlyng-Synne*, ed. Furnivall, 1862, p. 144-6.

[St. 218](#)

p. 87, [l. 2518-20](#). As to the meaning of *couplid*, cf. Mätzner, *Wörterbuch*, I. p. 491. These lines evidently mean that gentlemen and ladies sit alternately, what one calls in German, *bunte reihe machen*. Cf. A. Schultz, *Das höfische Leben Zur Zeit der Minnesinger*, I. p. 330, and P. Pietsch, *Bunte Reihe*, *Zeitschrift für deutsche Philologie*, vol. xvi. Halle, 1884, p. 231, who cites from *Biterolf*, l. 7399 ff.:

'Do hiezens under mîne man
Ir ingesinde wol getân
Sich teilen in dem palas,
Daz kein mîn recke dâ was,

Ern sæze zwischen magedîn.’

St. 219

p. 87, [l. 2526](#). *emell* was added by Hall in order to restore the rhyme with *Desonell*.

St. 220

p. 88, [l. 2535](#). For this correction, cf. Zupitza’s note to *Guy*, l. 600.

St. 225

p. 90, [l. 2593](#). After *marked*, *them* may have dropped; cf. *Layamon*, l. 5642 f.:

‘And heom markede ford,
Touward Munt-giu heo ferden,’

instead of which lines the later MSS. writes:

‘Hii nome riht hire way
Touward Muntageu.’

St. 226

p. 90, [l. 2597](#). On *castelletoure* cf. Kölbing’s note to *Tristrem*, l. 158.

St. 229

p. 91, [l. 2636](#). Cf. Kölbing’s notes to *Amis and Amiloun*, l. 1019, and to *The lyfe of Ipomadon*, l. 506. Here the expression, *no good he ne couth* means, he was quite feeble and strengthless.

St. 231

p. 92, [l. 2658](#). *up-tyed* = so limited by the deed of foundation that they (the churches and abbeys) could not be diverted to any other purpose.—HALL.

p. 92, [l. 2661](#). Cf. *Eglamour*, l. 1339, Lincoln MS.:

‘In Rome this romance crouned es.’

The Cambridge MS. reads instead:

‘In Rome thys geste cronyculd ys.’

I am inclined to think that *crouned* is nothing else but a misreading for *cronyculd*. Afterwards, considered to be correct, it has originated expressions like those we find here.

Footnote to Notes

[1.](#) So *Percy Fol. MS.*; *aserre* Thornt.

GLOSSARY.

Commas at the end of some entries are not errors. The letters I and J are alphabetized together. Initial U is written and alphabetized as V.

Asterisks* are not explained. They seem to indicate words that did not appear in the original MS but are the result of editorial emendation. They may or may not occur elsewhere in the text.

A B C D E F G H IJ K L
M N O P R S T UV W Y

abydde, 2/[41](#), vb. to endure.

a-bye, 21/[569](#), vb. to pay for.

actone, 79/[2276](#), sb. a jacket of quilted cotton. Cf. Skeat's Glossary to *Wars of Al.*, s.v.

ago, 3/[65](#), pp. gone.

a-right, 48/[1364](#), pt. s. prepared, served up.

assent, 48/[1357](#), sb. proposal.

assttyt, 23/[640](#), adv. at once.

auter, 68/[1952](#), sb. altar.

avented, 54/[1554](#), *pt. s. refl.* recovered his breath.

aventorres, 2/[39](#), *sb. pl.* adventures.

aventurly, 44/[1229](#), *adv.* boldly.

axithe, 10/[260](#), *pr. 3 sg.* asks.

balle, 15/[400](#), *sb.* bale.

bane, * 29/[794](#), *sb.* bone;

52/[1478](#), *sb.* destruction, death;

59/[1678](#), *sb.* over-comer.

bare, 53/[1502](#), *pr. s.* stabbed.

barys, 35/[978](#), *sb. pl.* bars.

bayte, 54/[1553](#), *vb.* to pasture.

bed, 29/[793](#), *pp.* offered.

bent, 25/[701](#), 86/[2487](#), *sb.* battle-field.

berdles, 36/[1015](#), *adj.* beardless.

bere, 37/[1045](#), *vb.* to stab.

be-stad, 29/[808](#), *pp.* sore bestad = distressed.

bet, 57/[1622](#), *pt. s.* beat.

be-taught, 58/[1651](#), *pp.* surrendered, delivered.

bett, 55/[1585](#), *pp.* beaten;

40/[1123](#), *pp.* ornamented.

be-tyde, 45/[1270](#), *vb.* to befall;

cf. the [note to this line](#).

beytyng, 36/[1008](#), *vb. sb.*, baiting.?

bla, * 9/[237](#), *adj.* pale, wan;

cf. [the note](#).

blo, * 13/[351](#), *adj.* blue.

blynd, 4/[87](#), *pr. s. conj.* blind.

bode, 18/[498](#), *pr. s.* ordered.

boffettes, 85/[2472](#);

buffettes, 56/[1596](#), *sb. pl.* blow, dint.

bone, 55/[1565](#), *sb.* prayer.
bord, 29/[819](#), 42/[1194](#), *sb.* table.
bowes, 51/[1451](#), *sb. pl.* bough, branch.
bowght, 21/[556](#), *sb.* bend.
brayd, 56/[1598](#), *sb.* sudden attack.
broke, 30/[833](#), 48/[1354](#), *vb.* to enjoy.
brow3, 24/[654](#), *sb.* rising ground, hill.
byddythe, 18/[500](#), *pr. s.* waited, remained.
bygght, 22/[605](#), *vb.* to bite.
byne, 2/[46](#), *vb.* to be.
byrlyd, 11/[292](#), 12/[329](#), *pr. s.* to pour out.

[castell toure](#), 90/[2597](#), *sb.* castle tower.
chaffare, 35/[986](#), *sb.* bargain.
challenge, 41/[1150](#);
 pr. s. 41/[1163](#);
 pr. s. conj. challenge.
cheff-foster, 21/[574](#), *sb.* chief-foster.
ches, 26/[718](#), *pr. s.* chose.
chyrge, 29/[814](#), *sb.* church.
clarkys, 1/[12](#), *sb. pl.* clerks.
clere, 3/[62](#), *adj.* *clere of*, renowned for.
clow,* 20/[542](#), *sb.* clough.
cobled, 46/[1298](#), *adj.* cobled stones = cobblestones.
comely, 26/[722](#), *adv.* in a comely manner;
 cf. [the note](#).
countenance,* 3/[75](#), *sb.* countenance, presence of mind.
cord, 48/[1357](#), *pr. s.* accord.
coueryd, 87/[2506](#), *pr. pl.* *Vp they coueryd* = They recovered.?
countenance, 39/[1105](#), *sb.* countenance.
couped, 42/[1193](#), *pp.*;

cf. [the note](#).
coupled, 87/[2520](#), *pp.* coupled;
 cf. [the note](#).
coursus, 41/[1150](#), 42/[1177](#), *sb. pl.* courses.
couth, 46/[1295](#), 91/[2636](#), *pr. s.* knew.
craftely, 54/[1527](#), *adv.* skilfully.
crest, 40/[1128](#);
creste, 83/[2407](#), *sb.* crest.
croke, 36/[1018](#), 37/[1042](#), 55/[1577](#), 56/[1607](#), 58/[1652](#), *sb.* crook.

[dalle](#), 21/[562](#), *sb.* valley.
delyuer, 41/[1154](#), *vb.*;
 41/[1151](#), *imp.* to deliver up;
delyuerd, 63/[1806](#), 1808, *pp.* delivered of a child;
delyuerd, 82/[2372](#), *pp.* released?
dent, 2/[41](#), *sb.* blow.
departid, 47/[1329](#), *pr. pl.* divorced.
dewe, 4/[88](#), *sb.* dieu.
deyr, 2/[37](#), *adj.* dear.
deyse, 38/[1067](#), 42/[1192](#), *sb.* dais.
dight, 39/[1081](#), *pr. s.* built.
disparplid,* 70/[2010](#), *pp.* dispersed;
 cf. [the note](#).
dong, 61/[1754](#), *pr. pl.* dung, beat.
dourst, 3/[81](#), *prs. sg.* darest.
draught, 58/[1654](#), *sb.* draught.
dryee, 36/[994](#), *vb.* endure.
duchyes, 33/[933](#), *sb. pl.* duchies.
dulful, 19/[519](#), *adj.* troublesome.
dynnyng, 52/[1487](#), *sb.* roaring.
dyspysyst, 2/[47](#), *prs. 2 sg.* despisest.

eb, 64/[1846](#), *sb.* ebb;

cf. [the note](#).

ebbyd, 8/[223](#), *pp.* ebbing.

ech, 92/[2657](#), *pron.* each.

eche, 24/[649](#), *sb.* oak.

endentyd, 9/[227](#), *pp.* indented, adorned.

erber, 65/[1868](#), *sb.* garden of pleasure.

ermyght, 36/[1008](#), *sb.*?

eyllythe, 34/[958](#), *prs.* 3 *sg.* ails.

fall, 47/[1331](#), *vb.* to fell, kill.

fame, 2/[31](#), *sb.* foam.

fare, 44/[1234](#), *sb.* at that fare = under these circumstances.

farly, 2/[44](#);

ferly, 69/[1974](#), 71/[2035](#), *sb.* wonder.

fawe,* 16/[431](#), *adj.* destined to death.

fede,* 2/[30](#), *sb.* feed, pasture ground;

cf. [the note](#).

ffede, 51/[1444](#), *sb.*;

cf. [the note](#).

fell, 85/[2444](#), *adj.* strong, able.

fell, 1/[21](#), 4/[90](#), *vb.* to fell, kill;

fellythe, 3/[82](#), *pr.* 3 *sg.* fells.

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fesomnyd, 2/[28](#), *pr.* s.;

cf. [the note](#).

fet, 12/[309](#), *pp.* fetched.

ffettouris, 81/[2333](#), *sb.* *pl.* fetters.

flyng, 67/[1927](#), *vb.* to hasten.

flyngyng, 14/[378](#), *p.* *prs.* hastening.

fode, 36/[1012](#), *sb.* food;

ffode, 64/[1823](#), *sb.* child, wight.
ffont, 69/[1993](#), *sb.* font.
forsake, 26/[724](#), *vb.* to leave behind.
fforward, 41/[1743](#), *sb.* agreement.
fraye, 23/[638](#), *sb.* attack.
freke, 58/[1661](#), *sb.* warrior.
frethe, 6/[161](#), *sb.* forest.
fyle, 33/[911](#), *sb.* fill.
ffyne, 39/[1086](#), *sb.* fine.
fytte, 17/[458](#), *sb. pl.* feet.
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gale, 46/[1313](#), *sb.* galley.
gas, 4/[103](#), *prs. 3 sg.* goes.
gestonye, 82/[2374](#), 91/[2625](#), 91/[2627](#), *sb.* banquet, feast.
gethe, 71/[2042](#), *prs. 3 sg.* goes.
glemyrryng, 16/[426](#), *p. prs.* glimmering.
governe, 28/[779](#), *vb. refl.* to behave.
greme,* 67/[1929](#), *sb.* grief, sorrow.
grennyng, 40/[1126](#), *p. prs.* distorting, gaping.
gryffon, 69/[1971](#);
 greffon, 69/[1981](#), *sb.* griffin.
grype, 68/[1961](#), *sb.* griffin.

[harood](#), 60/[1711](#), *sb.* herald;
 82/[2365](#), *harroldys*, *sb. pl.* heralds.
harood, 63/[1799](#), *pr. s.* distracted.
hed, 17/[444](#), *sb.* heed.
hede, 74/[2126](#), *vb.* to behead.
hede-vale, 74/[2135](#), 91/[2621](#), *sb.* principal value;

cf. the [note to l. 2135](#).

hedles, 25/[702](#), *adj.* headless.

hende, 4/[106](#), *adj.* courteous.

herne,* 37/[1030](#), *sb.* brains.

heved,* 14/[371](#), *sb.* head.

hight, 65/[1860](#), *sb.* height.

housell, 45/[1272](#);

howsell, 74/[2139](#), *sb.* housel.

howge, 20/[548](#), *adj.* huge, enormous.

howt, 25/[703](#), *adv.* out.

hurt, 57/[1625](#), *sb.* hurt.

i-bye, 43/[1222](#), *vb.* to pay for.

i-wysse, 15/[391](#), *adv.* surely.

juster, 84/[2420](#), *sb.* jousting knight.

kene, 2/[47](#), *adj.* brave.

kerpyng, 92/[2662](#), *vb. sb.* talking.

lade, 58/[1663](#), *sb.* load, i.e. a lot of blows.

lay, 6/[165](#), 52/[1492](#), *sb.* grass land, bank.

lede, 2/[36](#), *sb.* country.

lemyred, 11/[291](#), *pr. s.* glimmered.

lenage, 18/[491](#), *sb.* lineage, family.

lende, 1/[9](#), *prs. pl.* go.

leng, 32/[899](#), *vb.* to stay.

lent, 85/[2461](#), *sb.* lent?

leryd, 40/[1110](#), *pp.* informed.

lifte, 45/[1273](#), *vb.* to lift.

lothly, 34/[964](#), 35/[991](#);

lothely, 53/[1508](#), 54/[1534](#), *adj.* loathsome.

love, 59/[1692](#), *sb.* love, sweet-heart.

lyst, 1/[7](#), vb. to listen.

lythe, 13/[337](#), vb. to listen.

lyvelode, 83/[2384](#), sb. livelihood.

[maistershipmon](#), 50/[1425](#), sb. captain.

mall, 12/[322](#), sb. hammer, club.

markyd, 90/[2592](#), pr. s. directed.

mate, 25/[678](#), adj. faint, exhausted.

maynerey, 16/[435](#), sb. banquet, feast.

maystry, 8/[212](#), sb. mastery;

 maystres, 28/[789](#), sb. pl. = maystries, exploits?

meche, 10/[270](#), 20/[531](#), 26/[713](#), 37/[1040](#), adj. much, great.

met, 25/[700](#), pr. s. measured.

moche, 49/[1399](#), 76/[2195](#), adj. much, great.

myd mete, 41/[1141](#), 42/[1189](#), sb. the middle of the dinner.

mylle, 3/[79](#), sb. mile.

myrre, 11/[293](#), 34/[943](#), adj. merry.

myster, 21/[581](#), sb. need, want.

[nonys](#), 46/[1299](#), in phr. *for þe nones*, for the once, for the occasion.

noryse, 67/[1928](#), sb. nurse.

not,* 54/[1535](#), prs. *ne wot*, don't know.

nowyd, 6/[153](#), pp. annoyed? cf. [the note](#).

[of-smyght](#), 25/[691](#), vb. to cut off.

omage, 39/[1086](#), sb. homage.

onfre,* 53/[1499](#), adj. unnoble.

on-harnes, 11/[302](#), vb. to unharness.

ordor, 2/[51](#), sb. order.

ordurres, 2/[48](#), sb. pl. knighthood, dub.

ovyr-ryde, 2/[40](#), vb. to ride over, to overcome?

payn, 44/[1252](#), *sb.* fine, mulct.
persewyd,* 17/[462](#), *pp.* pursued.
pertely, 53/[1501](#), *adv.* openly, plainly.
pluckys, 56/[1611](#), *sb.* strokes;
 cf. Halliwell, Dict., p. 633.
pomell, 26/[714](#), *sb.* pommel.
poynt, 17/[445](#), 88/[2540](#), = *poynt of armys*, 3/[68](#), 30/[832](#), 49/[1383](#), *sb.* exploit.
prekand, 45/[1263](#), *prs. p.* pricking.
preste, 50/[1418](#), *adj.* ready.
preve, 10/[275](#), *adj.* privy.
pyll, 21/[573](#), *sb.* rock?

ragyd, 7/[194](#), *adj.* ragged.
rawght, 24/[645](#), *pr. s.* gave.
red, 7/[178](#), *sb.* counsel.
reioyse, 75/[2151](#), 80/[2309](#), 91/[2640](#), *vb.* to enjoy.
rerid, 55/[1561](#), *pr. pl.* reared, tried to bring on.
reue, 35/[986](#), *vb.* to bereave, to rob.
reuelid, 85/[2467](#), *pr. pl.* revelled, feasted.
revid, 88/[2546](#), *pp.* robbed.
rewe, 31/[860](#), *vb.* to rue, to pity.
reysed, 46/[1313](#), *pr. pl.* raised, made ready;
 reysing, 51/[1454](#), *prs. p.* rising, starting up.
rially, 87/[2516](#), *adv.* royally.
rialte, 85/[2455](#), *sb.* royal state.
rightfull, 64/[1834](#), *adj.* rightfull.
roall, 85/[2450](#), *adj.* royal.
rome, 19/[516](#), *sb.* cross-way?
rore, 37/[132](#), *vb.* to roar.
rough, 66/[1879](#), *sb.* wood, copse.
rowe, 50/[1426](#), *prs. pl.* row.

rowght, 24/[645](#), *sb.* stroke, blow?
rude, 58/[1666](#), *adj.* rude.
ryd, 2/[44](#), *pr. s.* rode.
ryde-wey, 22/[598](#), *sb.* spur-way, horse-way.
ryngis, 82/[2354](#), *sb.* ring, arena.
ryved, 73/[2090](#), *pr. s.* ryved up, landed, disembarked;
ryven, 50/[1435](#), *pr. p.* landed.

[sare](#), 4/[97](#), *adv.* sorely.
sarten, 26/[717](#), *adj. sb.* the sarten = the truth.
sayment, 2/[50](#), *sb.* trial, exploit.
scape, 81/[2327](#), *prs. subj.* escape.
schedyng, 19/[516](#), *sb.* separation.
scheff-chambyr, 26/[718](#), *sb.* chief-chamber, first rank-chamber.
scheld, 21/[578](#), *vb.* to shelter.
schere, 21/[556](#), *vb.* to shear, to cut.
schope, 21/[567](#), *pr. s.* created.
schowt, 21/[570](#),
schoute, 61/[1751](#), 65/[1877](#), *s.*;
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season, 75/[2157](#), *sb.* court.
see-fome, 75/[2165](#), *sb.* sea-foam.
sege, 77/[2204](#), *sb.* siege.
sekyrnes, 30/[835](#), *sb.* surety.
semled, 85/[2445](#), *pr. pl.* assembled.
sete, 33/[922](#), *sb.* city.
seth, 74/[2141](#), *conj.* since.
sett, 41/[1152](#), *pr. s.* sat.
sewe, 4/[89](#), *vb.* to look at.
shipped, 45/[1260](#), *pr. s.* 46/[1318](#), *pr. pl.* shypped, *pp.* embarked.
shone, 40/[1117](#), *sb. pl.* shoes.

side lokyng, 57/[1637](#), *sb.* side-glance.
sized, 79/[2288](#), *pr. s.* sighed.
simarr,* 47/[1338](#), *sb.* cloak;
 see [the note](#).
slade, 58/[1660](#), *sb.* slade.
slon,* 16/[458](#), *sb.* sloe.
smote, 76/[2185](#);
 smote adown, 77/[2203](#), *pr. s.* cast anchor.
solasyd, 24/[657](#), *pr. s.* solaced, comforted.
solemnite, 56/[1591](#), *sb.* pride.
sotell, 61/[1761](#), *adj.* subtle, sly.
sownyng, 49/[1400](#), 62/[1782](#), 90/[2615](#), *sb.* swooning.
sparid, 73/[2096](#), *pr. pl.* barred, blocked up.
sped, 3/[70](#), *prs. conj.* speed.
spent, 67/[1910](#), *pp.* lost.
sperryd, 14/[364](#), *pr. s.* barred, shut up.
sperrys, 5/[127](#), *sb.* spire, tree.
spousage, 62/[1791](#), *sb.* spousage.
sprent, 7/[181](#), *pr. s.* lept.
spryt, 7/[181](#), *sb.* pole.
stad,* 55/[1566](#), *sb.* stead.
state, 60/[1729](#), *sb.* chair of state.
stere,* 24/[662](#), *vb. refl.* move.
steryng, 62/[1785](#), *p. prs.* stirring, moving.
stomlyng, 24/[660](#), *p. prs.* stumbling.
storrope, 35/[987](#), *sb.* stirrup.
strake, 2/[42](#), *pr. s.* struck.
styll, 18/[477](#), *sb.* steel.
swathing band, 67/[1917](#), *sb.* swath.
swowe,* 20/[548](#), *sb.* noise;

cf. [the note](#).

sybbe,* 27/[739](#), *sb.* kinsman.

takyll, 49/[1402](#), *sb.* tackling.

tall, 26/[734](#), *sb.* tale.

tene, 3/[73](#), *sb.* grief, sorrow.

the, 2/[49](#), *vb.* to thrive.

thede,* 60/[1728](#), *sb.* people.

thefe, 46/[1292](#);

theffe, 58/[1659](#), *sb.* villain.

theves, 61/[1760](#), *sb. pl.* villains.

thole,* 17/[460](#), *vb.* to suffer.

throng, 38/[1057](#), *sb.* crowd, troop.

thronge, 79/[2283](#), *pr. pl.* thronged, pressed.

tombelyd, 42/[1173](#), *pr. pl.* tumbled.

to-sheverd, 42/[1172](#), *pr. s.* shivered in pieces.

trast,* 17/[455](#),? *vb.* to trust.

trayll, 46/[1314](#), *vb.* to trail.

trayn, 29/[803](#), 51/[1455](#), *sb.* treachery, deceit.

trompettys, 29/[816](#), 34/[443](#),

trumpettes, 41/[1164](#), *sb. pl.* trumpets.

trovyll, 17/[452](#), *pr. s.* travailed, exerted himself.

trow, 21/[572](#), *pr. s.* believe.

trusse, 13/[354](#), *vb.* to truss.

trussyd, 14/[371](#), *pr. pl.* trussed.

tyed, 92/[2658](#), *pp.*;

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tyght, 22/[589](#), *adj.* tight.

tyght, 25/[690](#), *adv.* in phr. *ase tyght*, at once.

tymbyr, 2/[40](#), 81/[2349](#), 86/[2483](#), *sb.* lance.

tynding, 42/[1181](#), *sb.* beating;

cf. [the note](#).

[vale](#), s. *hede*.

venturus, 55/[1566](#), *adj.* adventurous, dangerous.

vetelid, 76/[2188](#), *pp.* supplied with provisions.

victoure, 83/[2411](#), *sb.* victor.

vnbrydeled, 54/[1552](#), *pr. s.* unbridled.

vnder, 71/[2029](#), *sb.* noon.

vndyr-nethe, 20/[542](#), *prep.* underneath.

vndertane, 61/[1733](#), *vb.* to undertake.

[walloyng](#), 7/[189](#), *prs. p.* wallowing.

wanne, 62/[1767](#), *adj.* wan, dark.

ward, 48/[1351](#), *sb.* warden.

waried, 43/[1211](#), 88/[2544](#), *pr. pl.* cursed;

waried, 54/[1537](#), *pp.* cursed.

warne, 29/[795](#), *prs. s.* deny, refuse.

water fflood, 65/[1872](#), *sb.* water-flood.

watt, 44/[1247](#), *prs. 3 sg.* knows.

wax, 3/[73](#), *pr. s.* became.

wede, 2/[33](#), *sb.* garment, dress.

wekid, 80/[2302](#), *adj.* wicked;

see [the note](#).

were, 57/[1623](#), *vb.* to get tired.

were, 28/[773](#), *adj.* aware.

wet-saffe, 17/[466](#), *pr. s.* vouchsafe.

wexe, * 9/[237](#), *pr. pl.* became.

wight, 54/[1551](#), *sb.* white.

wilsom, 71/[2030](#);

wyld-som, 20/[535](#);

wyldsom, 19/[506](#), *adj.* wild, desert.

wis, 53/[1525](#), *vb.* to show.
wod, 14/[377](#), *adj.* mad.
won, 4/[94](#), *adj.* one.
wonande, 1/[14](#), *p. prs.* living.
wondyr-thyng, 2/[53](#), *sb.* wondrous thing.
wonne, 46/[1295](#), *sb.* custom, expedient.
wonne, 46/[1307](#), *pp.* wont? cf. [the note](#).
wonne, 65/[1870](#), *p.* dwelling, living?
wonne, 69/[1995](#), *pp.* won.
wrought vp, 54/[1532](#), *pr. s.* built up, raised.
wyght, * 1/[15](#), 3/[60](#).
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wyhte, 30/[848](#), *adj.* wight.

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Myhelle, [753](#), St. Michael.

Nazareth, [465](#), [2032](#), [2041](#), [2389](#), [2437](#), [2528](#).

Norway, [1370](#), [1377](#), [1412](#), [1417](#), [1759](#), [1781](#), [2083](#).

Nycholas de Barr, [1337](#), St. Nicholas de Bari;
see [the note](#).

Peron, [1776](#), [1830](#);

Perowne, [659](#);

Perrown, [412](#), a town in Portugal.

Pervens, [420](#), [1095](#), [1320](#);

Pervyns, [868](#), [2113](#), Provence;

Provyns, [397](#), [413](#).

Portingale, [1069](#), [1346](#), [2090](#), [2095](#), [2593](#);

Portyngale, [1772](#), [2134](#), [2176](#), [2413](#), [2620](#);

Portynggalle, [13](#), [25](#), [374](#), [399](#), [727](#), [763](#), [877](#), [883](#), [1255](#), Portugal.

Quarelle, [2182](#), [2415](#), a town in Syria.

Raynes, [2414](#), a town in Syria.

Rochense, [637](#), a giant.

Rome, [12](#), [118](#), [187](#), [190](#), [198](#), [558](#), [924](#), [1224](#), [1282](#), [1319](#), [1924](#), [2183](#),
[2626](#), [2661](#).

Samson, [95](#), Samson.

Sar3ins, [2232](#), Saracens.

Sathanas, [1237](#), Satan.

Slochys, [850](#);

Slogus, [748](#);

Slonges, [1005](#);

Slongus, [967](#), a giant.

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Terrant, [142](#);

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[2482](#), [2489](#), [2495](#), [2501](#), [2503](#), [2511](#), [2534](#), [2567](#), [2575](#), [2603](#), [2611](#),
[2617](#), [2642](#), [2649](#);

Torrant, [70](#), [76](#), [103](#), [241](#), [253](#), [364](#), [380](#), [657](#), [760](#), [840](#), [963](#);

Tyrrant, [18](#).

Velond, [427](#), Veland the smith.

Verdownys, [305](#), [341](#), [410](#), son of the King of Provence.

Weraunt, [1650](#), a giant.

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Typographic Details

In the Notes and Introduction, long vowels were printed with circumflex â rather than macron ā. This usage has been retained; the circumflex accent in its own right does not occur.

In the Introduction, emphasis within italicized passages was shown either by reverting to Roman type or by printing the words as g e s p e r r t (extended). In this e-text, both kinds of emphasis are shown as ***bold italics***.

Loops or flourishes attached to final letters are shown as › (small raised parenthesis).

The letter “n” with overline is shown as ñ (n-tilde) for better font support.

Double “l” in the main text was printed as two l’s with a single connecting line. They are shown in this e-text as ll (simple l followed by l with tilde overlay). Note that the printers do not seem to have had an italic version of this letter pair; in the e-text it is shown as italic or roman based on the surrounding text.

Hyphenization of prefixes in the modern material (introduction, linenotes, endnotes) does not always match the body text; words are printed as shown. In citations, capitalization of German is unchanged.

Commas at the end of some [Glossary](#) entries are not errors. The letters I and J are alphabetized together. Initial U is written and alphabetized as V.

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